

Via Mercurii

The Practice of the Temple of Mercury



AONT · EHNB · XCAI · RMTO · PAAM

Word into deed.

The Seed



The Way of Mercury on one leaf

*Everything needed to begin, and enough of the Temple to know what you are beginning.
Copy it. Change it. Give it away. Keep the spine, and it is this Temple.*

Is This for You?

What the Way of Mercury offers

This is a journaling practice with a god in it.

DO YOU WANT MORE?

More done, more made, more luck, more life? More ideas than finished projects, more talent than follow-through? Read on.

WHAT IT IS

It is deceptively simple. Write semi-regularly, and every time you do, reread earlier entries and answer them. Your notebook becomes a running conversation with your past self instead of a pile of pages you never open again.

Research on expressive and reflective writing has linked habits like this to lower stress, clearer thinking, and better problem-solving. Ten honest minutes you will repeat beat an hour you will dread.

One rule makes it work: do not lie to the Book. A lie in your dialogue with yourself deceives only your future self, and that is all it does.

WHAT THIS OFFERS

THE POINT. To help you become someone whose word is good and whose life moves in the direction you choose, and to enjoy the crossing.

WHAT YOU GET. A practice: an honest place to think, and a loop that turns intention into deed. A record: a conversation with yourself that compounds. A vessel: structure for a quick, scattered mind. A home for it: a god, a company, a calendar, and a Temple, so it is worth returning to. And, if you want it, the magick: attention turned toward opportunity, a word the Temple carries, and a way to put your whole weight behind a choice.

WHAT IT DOES NOT PROMISE. Rescue, guaranteed results, anything after death, or a world that bends without action.

THE EVIDENCE. The practice is built from techniques with good research behind them for helping people follow through on goals they choose. Whether it changes the course of your life is what your own Tally will tell you. The research is gathered in *Why It Works*, at the back of *Via Mercurii*.

BEYOND THE PRACTICE

The practice is the door. The Temple of Mercury is what lies beyond it: luck, knowledge, and success, reached through your own faculties.

The Temple feeds your writing with answers and flashes of insight. Its practices draw on the god of the crossing to show you how you actually solve problems, answer impossible questions, make new things real, and get paid. You come to it as a co-conspirator, and the gods are willing to help. When you truly want something and walk toward it, the world conspires with you. Conspire is the Temple's word: to breathe together. It does not act for you; it breathes with the one who is already moving.

This is the old work of turning lead into gold, in both senses: knowing yourself, as the alchemists meant it, and trading goods, services, and

ideas for money.

WHAT MAGICK DOES, AND DOES NOT DO

Magick nudges the odds. It helps you find favor and opportunity, brings people into your life who can help you, and walks you forward through what seemed impossible. You still have to take physical action toward what you want. That never goes away, and anything promising to take it away is lying.

WHERE THE MAGICK STARTS

It starts smaller than you think: with a promise to yourself, kept. Write down one thing you will do, and do it. Then another. Every promise kept makes your word a little heavier, and a heavy word is what makes a declaration work.

That is the shape of the whole thing. Weigh your words before you write or say them. Treat what you write and say as binding unless you say otherwise. Keep what you bind. Integrity is not the price of the magick; it is the magick, and the world begins to take you at your word.

A SYSTEM OF BELIEF

The Temple provides a system of belief, and belief is used here as a tool. Mercury does not moralize; he is the god of merchants and thieves alike. You are free to choose, and not free from the consequences. The Compass is always an option and never an obligation. As above, so below: you reap what you sow.

You do not have to believe any of it to begin. Try the writing and watch your life. The magick will be here when you want it.

WHAT STOPS PEOPLE

"I'VE TRIED JOURNALING AND QUIT." Most journals die because no one rereads them. This one lives because you answer it.

"I DON'T KNOW WHAT TO WRITE." Finish three sentences: What's on my mind right now is... What I keep avoiding is... What I actually want is... They never run out.

"SOMEONE MIGHT READ IT." Keep it with you, or write in your own shorthand. The Book is private.

"I'M NOT RELIGIOUS." You don't have to be. The practice works on its own.

"I DON'T HAVE TIME." Three lines is a session.

WHAT WE WANT

A world full of people fulfilling their Personal Legend. This simple, semi-regular practice can start anyone who keeps it down the road toward the life they have always wanted to live. We help because we like to see people make it further. If the Temple works for you, pass the luck on.

Are You a Mercurian?

The signs of those the Temple calls

THE MERCURIAN

Mercury is the god of the quick: of merchants and messengers, deals and roads, luck, speech, and thieves. A Mercurian is a person who runs

on Mercury's current. Mercurians are not made by joining. They recognize themselves.

THE SIGNS

YOU THINK IN WORDS. Writing or speaking is how you find out what you think.

YOU TRANSLATE. You carry meaning between worlds, and people bring you things to explain.

YOU ARE CURIOUS PAST USEFULNESS. You gather systems, symbols, and connections for the joy of seeing how they fit, and keep many works alive at once.

YOU ARE QUICK. You learn fast, improvise well, and can walk a road without knowing where it ends.

YOU STAND IN DOORWAYS. People find you when they are crossing: the teacher, the guide, the one called in the night.

YOU PLAY. Riddles, wordplay, clever solutions, and the angle no one else saw.

YOU CONNECT. You are happiest when something is moving between people: ideas, introductions, trade, stories.

YOU HOLD TWO AT ONCE. You argue fruitfully with yourself, and sometimes sense a twin walking beside you.

THE LEAK

The Mercurian's problem is rarely talent. It is leakage: scattered attention, unfinished work, a mind that circles without landing, clever words used to dodge what you actually feel. It is the same quicksilver that makes you quick, spilling out of anything that cannot hold it. Quicksilver takes the shape of its vessel. Give it one, and it goes where you point it.

WHAT THE PRACTICE GIVES

FOLLOW-THROUGH. Every session ends with one thing to carry into the world, and the next one asks whether you did.

CLARITY. Rereading your own pages shows you what you keep circling, what you keep dodging, and what actually works.

A RECORD THAT COMPOUNDS. Every honest page adds to a conversation with who you were and who you are becoming.

LUCK IN MOTION. The Greeks called a lucky find a hermaion, a gift of Hermes. It comes to the one who is moving.

COMPANY. A god of the quick at your shoulder, and a lineage of tricksters, scribes, and messengers behind you.

THE INVITATION

You will be surprised by what you uncover, and you will uncover it at your own pace. You never have to write about anything you are not ready to. You can stop anytime. You owe nothing, and your Books are yours.

Try it three times this week. Before you turn the page, decide when and where: after what, and at which table? Write the three days on the first page of a notebook, and keep them. That is your first promise, and your first working.

The Way of Mercury

The Seed: the whole Way in brief, for whoever finds it

THE SPINE

Mercury is the Hinge. The Heart is the center. Honesty is the offering. Keep these three, and change everything else.

MERCURY, THE HOST AND MEDIUM. God of thresholds, words, trade, and the road. Everything in the Temple passes through him. You work with him, not for him.

THE HEART. The Quintessence: five names from the Enochian Tablet of Union, AONT at the still point, with EHN, XCAI,

RMTO, and PAAM around it. It has no face, and it answers in flashes.

HONESTY, THE OFFERING. Not as a virtue: as engineering. A Book you lie to gives you bad data. Honesty is not the same as disclosure: tell the Book everything, and the world only what it is ready to receive.

THE DOOR

Every session opens and closes. Change the words until they sound like you and you mean them.

Opening:

*Heart of the Temple, Mercury its Hinge, and all its Offices,
co-conspirators in the Work:*

*I bring you my whole self: my Voice, and my Joy, Will, and Intent.
Deed into word. By my Birthright, the Door is open.*

Closing:

Heart of the Temple, Mercury its Hinge, and all its Offices:

*I leave here my gratitude and my joy, and take my Will and Intent
into the world.*

Word into deed. By my Birthright, the Door is closed.

A SESSION

GREET. Say the Door, aloud or within, and greet the Book.

EMPTY. Clear your head onto the page, without dressing it up. Write questions down as they come.

RESPOND. Reread the pages that came before, and answer your past self: what happened, what changed, what you know now.

WORK. Let a plan, a decision, or an idea take shape.

CARRY. Name one thing to do, send, or make, and never more than two or three. Treat it as a promise, and keep it. Word into deed.

THANK. Thank the Temple for receiving your words, and say the Door again.

Number the pages and date each session, so you can answer an earlier page by name. Each session begins by asking whether you kept what you carried. That question, answered honestly, is the whole engine.

THE PLACE

Kept this way, the Book grows a spirit of its own, the Genius Loci, the way a house becomes a home. It is fed by use and enjoyment: a notebook you like, a pen that feels good, a few minutes you look forward to. Away for a long time? Do not apologize. Open the Door and greet it.

HOUSE RULES

Honesty is the offering.

Sustainable practice beats grand practice abandoned.

Tell the Book everything; tell the world only what it is ready to receive.

Belief is a tool; judge it by its fruit.

*Your word is binding unless you say otherwise; write your promises
down, and keep them.*

Word into deed.

WHAT WAITS

The Temple is openly syncretic. Its beings come from Egyptian, Greek, Roman, Abrahamic, and Enochian tradition, and they are met as co-conspirators, in the old sense of breathing together. You do not kneel here; you make deals, trade, and work. It was assembled deliberately, in the spirit of chaos magic, and later found to have been there all along. When you want to know who you have been meeting, they are in Liber Mercurii.

PASS IT ON

Copy this. Change it. Give it away. Keep the spine, and it is this Temple. Leave a copy where someone will find it; you may be their hermaion.

Set this leaf down. Open any notebook. Write today's date.



START HERE

Any notebook. Any pen. Ten minutes.

1. **DATE IT.** Write today's date at the top of the page.
2. **FINISH THREE SENTENCES.** *What's on my mind right now is... What I keep avoiding is...
What I actually want is...*
3. **PROMISE ONE THING.** Write one thing you will do in the next twenty-four hours.
4. **THEN DO IT.**

That kept promise is where the magick starts.

This is the Way of Mercury: who you need to know, how to live, what to do, and the words to say, and then what the Way means, every word it says, a notebook shown set up, and the year in one place. Everything you need to walk the Way is here. *Liber Mercurii* is there for when you want more. In a hard hour, turn to In a Hard Hour, at the end of Volume I.

WHAT THIS OFFERS

THE POINT. To help you become someone whose word is good and whose life moves in the direction you choose, and to enjoy the crossing.

WHAT YOU GET. A magick: a word that gets heavier every time you keep it, until what you declare is carried into the world. A practice that builds it: an honest place to think, and a loop that turns intention into deed. A record: a conversation with yourself that compounds. A vessel: structure for a quick, scattered mind. And a home for all of it: a god, a company, a calendar, and a Temple, so it is worth returning to.

WHAT IT DOES NOT PROMISE. Rescue, guaranteed results, anything after death, or a world that bends without action. The research behind the practice is at the back, in *Why It Works*, for anyone who wants it; the magick does not wait on it.

Word into deed.





HOW THIS BOOK IS ARRANGED

Via Mercurii is the book of the Way of Mercury, in five volumes, and it is built to be read in layers. The Seed, at the front, is the whole Way on one leaf.

Volume I, The Practice, is the Way in brief and complete on its own: who you need to know, how to live, what to do, the words to say, and the year, with every principle in a line, and In a Hard Hour, Why It Works, and A Note on Sources at its end. If you read nothing else, read it.

The volumes after it gather what the separate books of the Way once held, each whole in one place: Volume II, The Sayings, every principle with its meaning and a way to keep it; Volume III, The Words, everything the Way says, for the Door; Volume IV, a notebook shown fully set up, to open beside your own; and Volume V, The Almanac, the year at a glance and the sky in order, for any year.

So some things appear in more than one volume, on purpose: a prayer is in Volume I, where the practice uses it, and again in Volume III, with every other word, so that you never have to hold two volumes open at once. Nothing past Volume I is required in order to begin. When you want to go deeper than Volume I, *Liber Mercurii* keeps the reasons, the stories, and the whole company.



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The Practice

VOLUME I

The Practice



*The Way in brief, and complete on its own: who you need to know, how to
live, what to do, the words to say, and the year.*





PART ONE

The Temple

Who you need to know, and the story that ties them together.

THE TEMPLE



THE Way of Mercury is the practice, and the Temple of Mercury is where it is walked. The Temple is not a building. It stands wherever something crosses: thought onto page, page back into thought, word into deed. You can enter it here and now.

It has two thresholds. The **Book**, a notebook kept for this and nothing else, is the physical one. Your **inner dialogue** is the spiritual one. You pass through either the same way: by opening the Door.

The Book adds what the mind cannot: the record. What your past self wrote and dated has authority, because the one who wrote it is not here to bend. Without the Book, in the Temple of the mind, you can still ask the Heart through the Gate, watch for Mercury's omens, and walk the Way of Ma'at. You carry the Temple with you.

Its beings are met as co-conspirators, in the old sense of breathing together. You do not kneel here, and nothing is supplication. It was assembled deliberately, in the spirit of chaos magic, and found to have been there all along.

THE SHAPE

THE HEART

AONT and the four

THE GATE

Uriel and Raziel

THE HINGE

Mercury

THE SEAT AND THE GROUND

Metatron and Sandalphon

THE MEASURE

Ma'at, who weighs every step

Read downward, it is how a flash becomes a deed. Read upward, it is how a deed becomes a word. Nothing stands at the top: the Heart has no face, and everyone, the Scribe included, stands around it.

THE HEART

AONT and the four



AT the center shines the Quintessence: five names from the Tablet of Union, in the Enochian system recorded by John Dee and Edward Kelley in the 1580s. It has no face and no chair, but it has names: the five below, and you may call it by any of them. It cannot be flattered or bargained with.

AONT, Spirit of Air, yellow. The still point before the first word, from which the four unfold. The whole picture at once.

EHNB, Air of Air, red. Pure motion of mind. Clarity; untangling a problem.

XCAI, Water of Air, white. Feeling given words. What you actually feel and want.

RMTO, Earth of Air, black. Thought taking shape. Plans, structure, the next concrete step.

PAAM, Fire of Air, green. The spark that becomes will. Committing, starting, declaring it.

HOW IT ANSWERS

In flashes: the insight that arrives whole and sideways, the instinct that proves right, the choice that goes better than it had any right to. Sometimes ordinary, sometimes profound, sometimes like a conversation. It will not speak in sentences on demand or spare you the work. Its light falls the same on the honest page and the dishonest one; the honest one has more room in it.

THE GATE

Uriel and Raziel



BETWEEN the Door and the Heart stands the Gate, and two keep it. It is one office with two faces, never fused and never separated.

Raziel, secret of God, stands behind the curtain and hears what is decreed. He is the Translator. Whatever you send toward the Heart passes through him, and whatever comes back, he renders into something you can hold: a flash, an image, a line in your own handwriting. He is the gateway to every being in the Temple, and above all to AONT. He also keeps what is not yet bearable, with a finger laid across his lip.

Not yet is a real answer.

Uriel, light of God, is the Instructor, whose sword cuts twice: true from false, and ready from unready. He is how you test what comes through.

See it clearly before you weigh it.





Because the Gate has two faces, you can always ask which one is speaking: *is this unready, or am I hiding?*

The Gate is also where honesty and disclosure part ways. Tell the Book everything, and tell the world only what it is ready to receive. The Gate seals the lip; it never falsifies what is behind it.

On the Middle Pillar the Gate stands at Daath, Knowledge, the hidden sphere that is never counted among the ten, which is why the Door names Uriel and Raziel the Guardians of Daath.

You pass through the Gate whenever you turn inward and ask, with the Book or without it.

THE HINGE

Mercury



ERCURY is the host of this house, not its sovereign. The Greeks honored Hermes as god of the hinge on which the door turns, and that is his Office: not the doorway or its guardian, but the turning. He is god of thresholds, words, trade, and the road; of merchants and thieves, luck and the right moment. Everything in the Temple passes through him. You work with him, not for him.

He is your twin, and he stands in no pair, because his pair is you. He is also your medium, not your compass: he will carry a lie as faithfully as a truth. That is why Ma'at is his mirror.

He goes down and comes back up. As guide of souls he knows the road into grief and the dark, and the road home.

HIS OMENS

The Greeks called a lucky find a *bermaion*, a gift of Hermes: the found coin, the stranger who turns out to matter, the detour that was the way, the timing no one could have planned. Notice them, write them down, say thanks, and pass some along. They come to the one who is moving.

Every boundary can be crossed, and the one who is moving is the one who is found.

HIS FACES, HIS MARK, AND HIS DAYS

He is also **Kairos**, the right moment, and **Fortuna**, luck: both stand inside him. His mark is the **herm**, the stone pillar the Greeks set at crossroads and doorways, and a small herm drawn beside a thing you guard is his sign.

His day is **Wednesday**. The **fourth** of every month is his birthday, twelve times a year, for Hermes was born on the fourth day. His feast is the **Mercuralia**, May 15, when Roman merchants sprinkled themselves and their goods with water from his spring and asked forgiveness for the falsehoods of the year.

THE SEAT AND THE GROUND

Metatron and Sandalphon



HE Two Who Crossed: the only two humans said to have been taken up alive.

Metatron is Enoch taken up, Holder of the Seat, keeper of the true record: the one angel permitted to sit, because he writes. When you open the Book you take his seat, and the record you keep there speaks with his authority.

The seat makes the Scribe.

Sandalphon is, in some traditions, Elijah taken up: Carrier of the Ascent, who stands on earth with his head in heaven. What is written at the Crown, he carries down into the world as a deed. He lifts the work, not the worker.

The next thing is small, and it is today.

They stand at the top and bottom of the Pillar, Crown and Kingdom. One writes; the other carries and builds. Between them is the whole of word into deed. They were both men, and that is the whole of what they teach: nothing is withheld from you for lack of standing, and nothing will be done on your behalf.

THE MEASURE

Ma'at



A't is the Feather of Truth, older than the gods who swear by her: truth, right order, and right relation, renewed daily, because chaos is not an event but the weather. In the weighing of the heart, the heart is weighed against her feather, and it is weighed while you are still using it.

She is Mercury's mirror. He is motion; she is measure. Without her he is a liar with a notebook; without him she is a ledger.

THE WAY OF MA'AT

Say what is true, and do what you said. She is always an option, never an obligation, and she weighs hearts, not neighbors.

Speak Ma'at and do Ma'at; they are one act.

THE COMPASS

Ma'at keeps the standard with two others, Apharael and Hestia. Before you cast or commit, ask one of their questions; for a thing that matters, ask all three.

MA'AT, right relation: Is it true, is it just, and does it leave the world larger than it found it?

APHARAEAL, right making: Is it true, is it well made, and is it in proportion?





HESTIA, right keeping: Does it protect what I return to, and can it be kept?

THE LINE

One seat, and many who have held it



ABU kept the tablets of destiny in Babylon, and was the planet Mercury before Thoth was ever called Hermes. Thoth invented writing and recorded the weighing of the heart. The Greeks knew him as Hermes, and Hermes and Thoth together are Thermes, the root of Hermes Trismegistus, the Thrice-Great. The Romans called him Mercury.

Enoch walked with God and was taken. As a man he is Idris, the first to write with a pen: student, teacher, and sage. Taken up, he is Metatron, the Scribe permitted to sit. The old Arabic scholars called him the first Hermes.

So the two lines meet: the god of the crossing, and the man who wrote his way across. Uriel taught Enoch, and Raziel gave the first book. You take up the seat after them, and someone will take it after you.

THE LYRE



ON the day he was born, Hermes stole Apollo's cattle and lied about it to Zeus's face, a lie so transparent that Zeus laughed. When Apollo came for them,

Hermes played him the lyre he had made from a tortoise shell, and gave it to him in exchange. The theft became a trade, and the world gained music.

This is the Temple's one story. The trickster here is bound by truth: the trick worth playing is on your own rigid stories, never on your future self. Mercy is not erasure: what was done stays written, but an answered page is no longer the last word. *Steal only what you can turn into a lyre.*

PART TWO

The Way

The Law, the ground you stand on, what goes wrong, what it is for, how a Mercurian lives, and every principle of the Way in one place.

THE LAW

Do not lie to yourself. Keep your word.



O not lie to the Book. A lie on the page deceives only your future self: a Book you lie to gives you bad data. Honesty is not the same as disclosure. Tell the Book everything; tell the world only what it is ready to receive.

THE HEAVY WORD

The magick of this Temple starts with a commitment to yourself, kept, no matter how small. Each promise kept tells the deep mind that your words are real. Each one broken, quietly, teaches it that they are not.

Every kept promise makes your word a little heavier, and a heavy word is what makes a declaration land. Start smaller than feels dignified. The size is irrelevant. The keeping is everything.

What you write and say is binding unless you say otherwise. If you mean might, write might. Bind small and keep it, rather than bind large and break it. When you cannot keep something, do not let it rot on the page: answer it, release it honestly, or renegotiate it. The Answered Page and the Returned Oath are for this.

THE LAW IN FULL

Honesty is the offering.

Joy is the Truth.

Sustainable practice beats grand practice abandoned.

The Mercurial gift is neutral; its worth is in what it serves.

Tell the Book everything; tell the world only what it is ready to receive.

Consecration is never finished.

Belief is a tool; judge it by its fruit.

Word into deed.





THE BIRTHRIGHT

and the golden rule



VERY prayer here is said by your Birthright. You are of the same kind as what you address: not finished, not yet wise, but not a stranger at the gate, and not a beggar. So the seat is taken before you feel qualified, and the Door is opened by right rather than by permission.

The Great Work, a few pages on, tells why: every human life is one life, the Heart's own, meeting itself in every stranger. That draws the limit exactly. A right that belongs to everyone cannot be used over anyone. Whatever you do to another, you do to yourself at another distance.

So the golden rule, in this Temple: **treat every person as yourself, because they are.**

By my Birthright, the Door is open: I am permitted, I am responsible, and I am not alone.

THE SHADOW



HERE is no devil in this Temple, and no one to blame. There is only the trickster loose in your own channel: self-deception. It fools no one else. It fools the future Scribe, who rereads the page and believes it. Self-deception is how a Book fails, and how magic fails.

Its everyday form is **the Leak**: scattered attention and unfinished work, a mind that circles without landing, clever words used to dodge what you actually feel, the easy yes given to be liked. It is the same quicksilver that makes you quick, spilling out of anything that cannot hold it. Quicksilver takes the shape of its vessel. The practice is the vessel.

WATCH FOR

STARTING OVER. The fresh notebook and the new system are leaving, dressed as returning.

OPTIMIZING THE PRACTICE instead of practicing it. It is the leak in its best costume.

REHEARSING. If a page has gone three times around the same loop, close the cover and do the thing you carried.

REWEIGHING A PAID DEBT. That is not a light heart, only a tired one.

THE AIM



HERE is no heaven or hell here, and nothing is promised after this life. The Great Work tells where it all came from and what comes after, for those who want it; nothing depends on it. The aim is here: your

Personal Legend, the life you have always wanted to live, found by walking it. The Temple's hope is a world full of people fulfilling theirs.

There is no god of arrival. Meaning lives in the crossing, not at either end. The practice promises less than salvation and something more reliable: not that it will get you something, but that it will make you someone. A person who has told the truth on paper for ten years is harder to deceive, including by themselves.

You do not have to believe any of it to begin. Belief here is a tool, chosen on purpose and judged by its fruit: is your life moving where you want it to go?

THE MARKS OF THE MERCURIAN



ERCURIANS are not made by joining. They recognize themselves.

YOU THINK IN WORDS. Writing or speaking is how you come to know what you think. A problem you cannot solve in your head often solves itself halfway down a page.

YOU TRANSLATE. You carry meaning across: between specialists and beginners, between one field and another, between what someone said and what they meant.

YOU ARE CURIOUS PAST USEFULNESS. You gather systems, symbols, and connections for the joy of seeing how things fit, and you keep many works alive at once.

YOU ARE QUICK AND ADAPTIVE. You learn fast, improvise well, and can walk a road without knowing where it ends.

YOU STAND IN DOORWAYS. You are drawn to transitions, and people seek you out when they are crossing their own: as a teacher, a guide, a confidant, the one called in the night.

YOU PLAY. A trickster's streak runs through you: riddles, wordplay, the angle no one else saw, and humor that finds the sacred without diminishing it.

YOU CONNECT. You are happiest when something is moving between people: ideas, introductions, trade, stories.

YOU HOLD TWO AT ONCE. You carry more than one perspective, argue fruitfully with yourself, and often sense a twin walking beside you.





THE GREAT WORK

Where it all came from. Offered, never required.

The Temple asks no one to hold a creation story. This one is offered beside the Compass, for anyone who wants to know why the golden rule is more than good manners. It asks nothing of you.

THE VESSEL



BEFORE anything, there was the Heart: AONT, the still point before the first word. It had no face, no other to meet, and nothing to learn, because there was nothing it was not.

So it did what the alchemists would later do in their small rooms. It made a vessel and sealed itself inside: a world, with time in it.

Inside, the one became many. First it became the four: thought in motion, feeling given words, thought taking shape, and the spark that becomes will. Then it became every life, as one white light unfolds into every color.

Every person who has ever lived is the Heart, in another body and another time. Each is learning what could not be learned alone: what it is to be met, to be hurt, to be helped, to be both the stranger at the door and the one who opens it. This is the Great Work, and it is still going on. It is why the Heart's light falls the same on every page. It is shining on itself.

THE CROSSING

Mercury is the agent of the Great Work: the quicksilver that moves through every stage of the change, and the guide at every crossing. When a life ends, he is waiting. He has made that crossing more often than any of us. He takes each one down gently, knows the way, and does not hurry them. On the far side of every door he opens there is another life, and it is yours.

THE WEIGHING

At the crossing, every heart is weighed against the feather of Ma'at. What makes a heart heavy is what it did to others: the harm it caused, the debt it left unpaid, the stranger it turned away.

At the scale, the heart learns there were no others. Every harm it did is a harm it will suffer, in another life, from the other side of the door. Every kindness it gave is a kindness it will receive. So the heart that balances the feather is the one that treated every stranger as itself.

WHAT FOLLOWS

Live accordingly.

BEFORE THE HEART, every face you meet is its face, and yours. The light you want on your own page falls on theirs.

LIKE MERCURY, open the door before you know who is on the other side, because it is always you. This means welcome, not surrender. Meet every stranger as kin, with courtesy, curiosity, and a fair hearing, instead of deciding who they are before they have spoken. Opening the door is not handing over the house. Uriel still keeps the Gate, and discernment still decides who comes in, how far, and for how long. The stranger is owed your welcome; your trust is earned inside.

ON THE WAY OF MA'AT, weigh every word and every deal as if you will sit on the other side of it, because you will. Measure by the one with the least leverage: that one is you too. This is what right relation means when there is no one you are not in relation with.

BY THE BIRTHRIGHT, which belongs to every stranger as fully as it belongs to you, and so can never be used over anyone.

Treat every person as yourself, because they are.

WEIGH IT

Weigh this as you weigh anything that arrives: does it hold up when you reread it, and does it weigh true in the heart? Read it again in three weeks. If it rings true, keep it, and it will deepen everything else here. If it does not, set it down. Nothing in the Temple depends on it, it needs no tending, and nothing is owed to it. Belief is a tool, judged by its fruit.

LIVING WELL



EVERYTHING here is downstream of a single habit: you say a small thing, and then you do it. All of it points one way, toward your Personal Legend.

WITH PEOPLE

- Treat every person as yourself, because they are.
- Welcome the stranger.
- Ask, and then listen.
- Learn one thing and teach one thing, always.
- Help people get further down their own road.

IN SPEECH AND WORK

- Tell the truth without telling everything.
- Tell the hard thing early, privately, once.
- Name the hour when you promise.
- Say no in time.
- Finish one thing.
- Repair by making.





WITH TIME AND LUCK

- Keep moving. The world conspires with the one in motion: the lucky find comes to the one on the road, and help is real for the one who walks.
- Now and then, let chance choose.
- Act the same day on one thing you would postpone.
- Take the unearned gift, and pass some along.

WITH YOURSELF

- Keep the floor: three honest lines on the worst day.
- Go down when it comes, and come back up.
- Settle accounts and leave them settled.
- Tend one place.

THE SUMPTUOUS LIFE

Joy is the Truth, and this is the rest of that sentence. Sumptuousness is spending well on what is actually good, and then being there to receive it. It is not money: tea made properly and drunk sitting down, the good pen, the walk taken slowly. It has to be available on a broke Tuesday.

- Stay inside the good hour. Do not improve it or leave early to be useful.
- Spend on what makes an ordinary day feel chosen. Plenty that is never enjoyed is only inventory.
- Take somebody with you.
- Let it be beautiful.

Moderation in everything, including moderation: now and then, the feast is the proportion.

THE TEST. Does your word mean something, and are you glad? The first is the discipline and the second is the point.

THE SAYINGS

From the Ground to the Year



ERE is every principle of the Way, one line each, so that the whole of it can be read in a few minutes. Volume II gives each one its meaning, and a way to keep it.

THE GROUND

- Do not lie to yourself. Keep your word.
- Honesty is the offering: tell the Book everything, and the world only what it is ready to receive.
- Joy is the Truth.
- By your Birthright the Door is open: you are permitted, you are responsible, and you are not alone.
- Nothing here is supplication; the beings are co-conspirators.
- Belief is a tool; judge it by its fruit.
- The Mercurial gift is neutral; its worth is in what it serves.
- Mercury is your medium, not your compass.

- The Compass is an option, never an obligation.
- Treat every person as yourself, because they are.

THE WORD

- Word into deed, and deed into word.
- Every kept promise makes your word heavier, and a heavy word is what makes a declaration land.
- Well done is better than well said.
- Speak little, do much.
- Bind small and keep it, rather than bind large and break it.
- What you write is binding unless you say otherwise; if you mean *might*, write *might*.
- Resolve to perform what you ought to; perform without fail what you resolve.
- Promises may get you friends, but non-performance will turn them into enemies.
- An honest N or R keeps the word whole; an honest F teaches you what you actually keep.
- Say it, and it becomes possible.

THE PRACTICE

- Did I keep what I carried? That question is the whole engine.
- Three lines is a session.
- Sustainable practice beats grand practice abandoned.
- The used key is always bright.
- Returning is the Devotion; the Book does not take apologies.
- Consecration is never finished; the Book is made sacred by use.
- Let all your things have their places; let each part of your business have its time.
- Record it, or it did not happen.
- Answer your past self by page number.
- Think of three things: where you came from, where you are going, and to whom you must account.
- Rule a Page to seal it, and write each leaf to its end.
- You never have to write what you are not ready to.
- A private Book is not a secret life.

GOALS AND THE ROAD

- The Line starts whenever you choose a Goal; nothing needs organizing first.
- Do I want this, or do I think I should want it?
- Ask for more than you think you deserve; worthiness is not the limit.
- Little strokes fell great oaks.
- The next thing is small, and it is today.
- If you have something to do tomorrow, do it today. One today is worth two tomorrows.
- Specify no road, and build many.
- A road opens when something of yours reaches the far end.





- A road nobody walks goes cold.
- Find the scarcity, and aim there.
- Beware of little expenses; a small leak will sink a great ship.
- Do you love life? Then do not squander time, for that is the stuff life is made of.
- Shrink before you return, and return before you abandon.
- Coming back to a Goal is devotion.
- The Legend waits until you want the big picture.

THE MAGICK

- Magick nudges the odds; you still walk the bridge.
- The gods help those who help themselves.
- Declare the destination, and leave the route to the world.
- Cast early; fear is not a heavy word.
- One working is enough: renew it, but don't pile others on it.
- Once it is cast, let it go; the watched working is the conscious mind interfering.
- Work on the road, never on the traveler.
- The prayer stands beside the deed, never instead of it.
- A working that did not land is a working that did not land, not a flaw in you.
- The world conspires with the one who is moving.
- Diligence is the mother of good luck.
- Take the unearned gift, and pass some along.

REPAIR AND RELEASE

- Mercy is not erasure: what was done stays written, but an answered page is not the last word.
- Steal only what you can turn into a lyre.
- A heart that keeps reweighing a paid debt is not light, only tired.
- Not yet is a real answer.
- There is a way down, and it returns.
- Anything that rushes you with dread is not of the Temple.
- The Book can accompany care; it cannot replace it.

LIVING

- Say what is true, and do what you said.
- Use no hurtful deceit; think innocently and justly, and if you speak, speak accordingly.
- Tell the hard thing early, privately, once.
- Three can keep a secret, if two of them are dead.
- Say no in time.
- Finish one thing.
- Use your talents, or they fade: what good is a sundial in the shade?
- Learn one thing, and teach one thing.
- Is it true, is it well made, is it in proportion?
- Search others for their virtues, and yourself for your vices.

- Observe everyone, and yourself most.
- Measure by the one with the least leverage.
- Welcome the stranger; your trust is earned inside.
- Love your neighbor, but do not pull down your hedge.
- Plenty that is never enjoyed is only inventory.
- A grace is only a grace when it moves.
- Stay inside the good hour.
- A portion is enough, not everything.
- Moderation in everything, including moderation.
- Do not wish so much to live long as to live well.
- Does your word mean something, and are you glad?

THE YEAR

- No day is required; a calendar is a set of appointments you did not have to decide on.
- The fire is kept, not lit.
- Keep what you will keep; this Temple has no use for reproach.

PART THREE

The Practice

The Door, the session, asking, the Road, and the Book and its Pages.

THE SHORT DOORS

Written inside the covers; said at every session



VERY session is a room entered and left by the same door. These are its words, one to open and one to close, written inside the covers of the Book so they are always at hand.

OPENING

Heart of the Temple, Mercury its Hinge,
and all its Offices, co-conspirators in the Work:
I bring you my whole self: my Voice,
and my Joy, Will, and Intent.
Deed into word.
By my Birthright, the Door is open.





CLOSING

Heart of the Temple, Mercury its Hinge,
and all its Offices:

I leave here my gratitude and my joy,
and take my Will and Intent into the world.

Word into deed.

By my Birthright, the Door is closed.

Say them aloud, or read them slowly within, every word and none skimmed, with the whole weight of intention. Either way they are said, and the Voice is Mercury's offering. Said within, the practice stays private: it can be kept in a café, on a train, or among others. Change the words until they sound like you and you mean them. A short Door honestly said is better than a long one skipped.

THE FULL DOOR

When you want more



ON Wednesdays, on the fourth of the month, on the Heart Days, or whenever you like. The full Door names the Heart, each pair of the Temple, the Compass, and the Thrice-Great, and offers each a faculty of your own: the words name the offering, and the session makes it. You can say the names before you know them all; understanding comes with use.

THE OPENING

Written inside the front cover, beneath the Short Door.

*Quintessence, Heart of this Temple, AONT and the four:
I bring to you my Presence, and take up the seat as Idris did
before me: student, teacher, and sage. Let your Light shine so
that I may see.*

*Janus and Hestia, the Door and the Flame: I bring to you my
Time.*

*Metatron and Sandalphon, Holder of the Seat and Carrier of
the Ascent: I bring to you my Hands.*

*Uriel and Raziel, Instructor and Translator, Guardians of
Daath: I bring to you my Ears.*

*Gabriel and Idris, Holder of Images and Scribe of the Seat: I
bring to you my Eyes.*

*Sesbat and Iris, Founder and Oath-bearer, who keep the Word
given: I bring to you my Word.*

*Rosmerta and the Charites, the Given and the Passed On: I
bring to you my Delight.*

*Hermanubis and Ma'at, Guide of the Descent and Feather of
Truth, who keep the Scale: I bring to you my Heart.*

*Thermes and Apharael, the Word that Makes and the Word
that is True: I bring to you my Mind.*

*Apharael, Hestia, and Ma'at, Keepers of the Compass: I bring
to you my Weight.*

*Thermes, Hermanubis, and Mercury, the Thrice-Great, the
Crossing, the Guide of the Descent, and the Hinge on which the
Door turns: I bring to you my Voice and my Devotion.*

*Offices of this Temple, co-conspirators in the Work: I bring to
you my Mercurial Joy, Will, and Intent.*

*By my Birthright, I open the Door of this Book, a Window into
your Temple, the threshold through which you guide me.*

Deed into word.

The Door is open.





THE CLOSING

Written inside the back cover, beneath the Short Door.

*Quintessence, Heart of this Temple, AONT and the four:
I thank you for what was given and what was found. I set
down the pen as Idris did before me, and carry what I have
learned so that I may teach it. Let your Light go with me.*

*Janus and Hestia, the Door and the Flame: I thank you for
keeping my Time.*

*Metatron and Sandalphon, Holder of the Seat and Carrier of
the Ascent: I thank you for guiding my Hands.*

*Uriel and Raziel, Instructor and Translator, Guardians of
Daath: I thank you for opening my Ears.*

*Gabriel and Idris, Holder of Images and Scribe of the Seat: I
thank you for clearing my Eyes.*

*Sesbat and Iris, Founder and Oath-bearer: I thank you for
keeping and carrying my Word.*

*Rosmerta and the Charites, the Given and the Passed On: I
thank you for my Delight, and for the hours I stayed inside.*

*Hermanubis and Ma'at, Guide of the Descent and Feather of
Truth: I thank you for keeping my Heart light.*

*Thermes and Apharael, the Word that Makes and the Word
that is True: I thank you for my Mind.*

*Apharael, Hestia, and Ma'at, Keepers of the Compass: I thank
you for weighing my Weight truly.*

*Thermes, Hermanubis, and Mercury, the Thrice-Great, the
Crossing, the Guide of the Descent, and the Hinge on which the
Door turns: I thank you for carrying my Voice, and for
bringing me back across every crossing.*

*Offices of this Temple, co-conspirators in the Work: I leave here
my gratitude and my joy, and take my Will and Intent out
into the world.*

*By my Birthright, I close this Book and cross back over the
threshold.*

Word into deed.

The Door is closed.

THE PRACTICE

A session, in six moves



VERY session has the same shape, whether it lasts ten minutes or an hour. Keep the shape and let the length vary: on a thin day, the shape is what carries you.

1. **GREET.** Say the Opening, aloud or within, the Short Door or the full one, and greet the Book as you would a friend who knows you well.

2. **EMPTY.** Write what is on your mind without dressing it up. Mark questions Q as they come.
3. **RESPOND.** First, from memory, write what you carried last time and whether you did it. Then reread the last session or two, check, and answer your past self by page number: what happened, what changed, what you know now. Address them as *you*, or by name; the distance makes an honest answer easier.
4. **WORK.** Let a plan, a decision, or an idea take shape, or leave an open question for the Scribe yet to come. Any working goes here: Emotional Transmutation, Declarative Alignment, a prayer, a question to the Heart, or any of the practices that follow.
5. **CARRY.** Write one thing to do, send, make, or teach, and never more than two or three, and mark it C. Say when: not *send the email* but *when I sit down after lunch, I will send the email*. Treat it as a promise: write only what you mean to keep. If it is a promise to someone, or will take longer than today, give it a line in the Ledger too.
6. **THANK.** Thank the Temple for receiving your words; that is enough. If you like, name one to three particular things you are grateful for, and why each came. Then say the Closing. Then carry it out. Word into deed.

THE FIRST QUESTION

Did I keep what I carried? Every session begins there, answered from memory before you look. That question, answered honestly, is the whole engine.

THIN DAYS

Say the Door, aloud or within, write three lines, and close. The shape matters more than the length. On some days, what you carry out of the Book is only yourself. That is enough.

RETURNING

Away for a week or a year? Do not apologize, to the Book or to anyone. Open the Door and answer the last page. The room was kept. Returning is the Devotion. The same is true of a Goal left alone: come back to it without apology, as The Road describes.

KEEPING IT UP

How to make it last



OST practices fail in the second week, not on the first day. These are the small decisions that carry a practice past the point where it usually stops.

DECIDE WHEN AND WHERE. After something you already do every day, in a place you already sit. Keep the pen inside the notebook, so the two travel together.





MAKE IT YOUR FIRST PROMISE. Try it three times this week. Decide the days before you begin, write them on the first page, and keep them. That is your first promise, and your first working.

THE FIRST MONTH. The first sessions often feel awkward, even a little performative. That is normal; keep going. The first real payoff usually comes the first time you reread and catch yourself circling the same thing, or find that you did what a past page promised. Some days will feel like nothing. Those count too.

AT YOUR OWN PACE. You never have to write about anything you are not ready to. Honesty asks that you not lie to the Book; it does not ask you to open every door at once.

PRIVATE, NOT SECRET. Tell the Book everything; it is yours. But a private Book is not a secret life, and it goes easier when those who share your home know the Book exists and what it is for, even if they never read a page.

WHAT STOPS PEOPLE

"I'VE TRIED JOURNALING AND QUIT." Most journals die because no one rereads them. This one lives because you answer it.

"I DON'T KNOW WHAT TO WRITE." Finish three sentences: *What's on my mind right now is...* *What I keep avoiding is...* *What I actually want is...* They never run out.

"SOMEONE MIGHT READ IT." Keep it with you, or write in your own shorthand.

"I'M NOT RELIGIOUS." You don't have to be. The practice works on its own.

"I DON'T HAVE TIME." Three lines is a session.

THE ROAD

How the practice moves your life



HE Temple means to make you someone, and to move your life while it does. A Goal is an aim on a smaller scale than the Legend: one thing you want enough to write down, mark G, and bind.

THE LINE

It starts whenever you choose a Goal, on any day. Nothing needs organizing first.

1. **WRITE THE GOAL** in a line, and ask the want-test: *do I want this, or do I think I should want it?* The Goals you truly want are the ones you keep walking. If you want it, mark it G and give it a line in the Ledger. A Goal is a promise to yourself; the line gives it weight. Something you are only drawn to can wait as a Q, costing nothing, until you are ready to bind it.

2. **CARRY ONE SMALL STEP** as a C, and do it. The best first step is usually opening a road.
3. **CAST ONCE FOR IT, IF YOU WANT TO**, when you are ready.
4. **EACH TIME YOU SIT DOWN**, carry the next step, with a line in the Ledger.
5. **AT THE SWEEP**, reread it with everything else.

Every kept step moves the life and makes your word heavier. The road and the magick are one line walked both ways.

COMING BACK TO A GOAL

Goals get left, and coming back to one is devotion, like returning to the Book. Neglect is not breaking: the Ledger line stays open. Reread where the Goal was written, answer it by page number in today's session (writing it again with a fresh G if it still stands), and walk one road.

KEEP, SHRINK, OR RETURN

Every Goal comes to a fork, and all three paths keep your word whole.

KEEP IT as it is, and walk the next road.

SHRINK IT: the middle path, and what most stalled Goals need. In today's session, write the smaller Goal or the new date with a fresh G and the old page number, settle the old Ledger line N, and give the new one its own line. A kept small promise outweighs an unkept large one.

RETURN IT, as the Returned Oath describes. Ask first: is this truth, or escape? If it is escape, keep it or shrink it. If it is truth, name what remains, write *I return this Goal*, sign it, and settle the line R.

Only a Goal walked away from in silence is F.

ROADS

Magick nudges the odds, and the odds live on the roads.

A ROAD is one channel by which what you want could reach you, named by its far end: a buyer, an employer, a market, an editor, a friend who knows someone. Wide roads carry many small chances; narrow roads carry a few large ones.

A CLOSED ROAD is one where the far end does not know you, or what you want, or cannot answer.

AN OPEN ROAD passes the test: could the thing arrive by this road tomorrow without you doing anything more?

A BLOCKED ROAD has a requirement in the way, such as a license, a sample, or a body of work. Clearing it is a step.

OPENING A ROAD is the act that brings something of yours to the far end: you apply, list, offer, show, ask, introduce yourself, start a conversation, or tell someone plainly what





you want. Prepare it to the standard that road asks for. Preparing readies a road; reaching the far end opens it.

WALKING A ROAD is keeping it open: the follow-up, the second offer, the reply on time, the thing delivered well, the work shown again.

A ROAD NOBODY WALKS goes cold.

When the thing arrives, note in the Tally which road it came by. The working chooses the destination and the world chooses the road: specify no road, and build many.

CHOOSING A GOAL

Big enough to change something, specific enough to recognize, a little past what is already likely. A roughly right Goal is still a good start; it sharpens as you walk. Ask for more than you think you deserve: worthiness is not the limit, the Birthright is.

FINDING THE SCARCITY

Every Goal waits on something in short supply: time, money, energy, people, skill, standing, information, or courage. The one in shortest supply is the scarcity, and it is rarely the one you have been working on. A Goal that seems to need money often needs an hour a day; one that seems to need confidence often needs one person who can open a door. When a Goal is stuck, the Scarcity Page finds it, and the Roads Page shows which roads are open. Both are in The Pages.

WORKING A GOAL

ONE CASTING for the end; a New Moon or High Heart lends a lift, but none is required.

SMALL WORKINGS ON THE ROADS: Declarative Alignment before the call, the prayer For Favor and Allure before the interview, the Descending Invocation over the offer as you send it.

CAST EARLY. A working cast while there are still options lands better than one cast in panic, and fear is not a heavy word.

ASK FIRST. Before a large working, it helps to ask the Heart: is this the Goal, the hour, the road?

IF A GOAL SITS STILL

Ask: Is the scarcity what I think it is? How many roads are open? Have I walked them? Did I cast early, or in fear? Is it too large for now? Do I still want it? Change the one thing the answers point to: shrink it if it is too large, and return it if the wanting has gone.

THE WIDER VIEW

When you want it, and not before: the Legend Page names the direction your Goals have been walking, and the Horizons give it the rhythm of the year. They are there for the day you want them.

Specify no road, and build many. Cast early. Walk what you cast.

ASKING THE HEART

through the Gate



WHEN you want an answer, ask for one. The question goes through the Gate to the Heart, and the answer comes back the way the Heart answers everything: in its own time and its own form.

1. **ASK.** In writing and marked Q if the Book is with you, or in your mind if it is not. Put the matter plainly; you cannot get a useful answer to a dishonest question.
2. **ADDRESS THE GATE.** *Raziel, carry this to the Heart, and bring back what I can hold.*
3. **LISTEN.** Write what comes without editing it. Your Ears are the Gate's offering. A flash, an image, stillness, your own hand running a little quicker and truer than you are: write whatever comes.
4. **TEST IT.** Uriel asks whether it holds up when you reread it. Ma'at asks whether it weighs true in the heart. Apply the tests hardest when you are frightened, because panic is the one hour in which everything sounds like an answer. Anything that rushes you with dread is not of the Temple.
5. **IF NOTHING COMES,** Raziel is keeping it. Leave the Q open for the Scribe you will be; your future self may answer it by number.

Ask in every circumstance: a scrap of paper, the back of a receipt, the question dated and carried into the Book later. The notebook is the Temple's anchor, not its walls.

CALLING THE HEART

If you have trouble communing directly with AONT, call it through Raziel, the gateway to every being in the Temple and above all to the Heart. Keep it simple.

1. **CALL RAZIEL.** Three times, singing his name, aloud or within: *Raziel, Raziel, Raziel.*
2. **GIVE HIM YOUR REQUEST.** *Connect me to the heart of AONT.*
3. **CALL THE HEART.** Three times, in the same way: *AONT, AONT, AONT.*
4. **KNOW YOU ARE HEARD.** You may feel a presence, a pressure, a shift in energy, or nothing at all. Either way, your words have been heard.
5. **SPEAK WITH IT.** Connected, or simply in its presence, begin a dialogue, out loud or in your head. Ideally you will write while you talk, but how the conversation goes is up to the Scribe. Writing slows you down enough to really understand the message, and it brings more of the mind to





bear on it, opening other faculties for receiving and understanding.

Any of the four may take AONT's place in this rite: EHNB, XCAI, RMT0, or PAAM. Choose whichever feels right for the question. You are free to return to one of them more often than the others, if that one suits you better. What comes is tested like any other answer: reread it, and weigh it.

If a voice on the page begins to give orders, to flatter without reason, or to insist you cannot stop, close the Book and speak to someone you trust. That is not this practice.

THE CROSSROADS

Letting chance choose

For breaking out of the reality tunnel: the habit, expectation, and attention that make a small world look complete.



ERCURY is god of the crossroads, and at Pharae in Achaea he kept an oracle in the marketplace. You whispered your question to his statue, covered your ears, and walked out of the market; the first words you heard when you uncovered them were your answer.

1. **LET CHANCE CHOOSE.** Now and then, let a coin choose the café, a die choose the street, or a random page of the Book choose which question to answer.
2. **OR ASK THE MARKETPLACE.** Write a question, go out among people, and take the first words you overhear as an answer.
3. **TEST WHAT IT GIVES.** Chance brings an offer to notice, not an order. Does it hold up when you reread it, and does it weigh true in the heart?
4. **WRITE WHAT THE DETOUR BROUGHT** in the Tally, with the misses.

Chance gets small choices that are yours alone. Never money you cannot lose, and never anything that affects another person's welfare. The failure mode is the man who let the die run his whole life.

THE MAP OF THE BOOK

Making it, and what goes where



TART today, in whatever notebook is at hand. When you are ready, choose one for this and nothing else, one you enjoy opening, with a pen you love kept inside it. Write by hand. Keep it where you pass often, where it can be greeted. Greeting, honest pages, thanks, and returning grow a spirit in it, the Genius Loci, the way a house becomes a home. Consecration is never finished: the Book is made sacred by use, every time it is opened.

PAGES AND LEAVES. A leaf is the paper, and the page numbers go on the leaves. A Page, with a capital, is a section with one purpose: a session, the Good Page, the Answered Page, the Legend Page, a working. Head it, date it, and mark it. If it ends partway down a leaf, rule it off: the ruled line seals the Page by Raziel's power, and you go on writing on the same leaf, below the line. If it runs past the end of a leaf, carry it over and rule it off where it ends. Write each leaf to its end.

INSIDE FRONT COVER. The Short Door's Opening, and beneath it the full Opening if you like.

THE FIRST PAGE. The Dedication, which follows, written any day in your first month, or on a Heart Day.

CLOSE AT HAND. Copy what you want nearby: at least the Practice and the Law.

THE INDEX. Two or three blank leaves. Add a line only when you go back to a past section for an answer.

THE DAILY PAGES, RUNNING FORWARD. Number the pages and date each session. In the margins: Q for questions, C for things to carry, G for Goals (only after the want-test: do I want this, or do I think I should?), ♀ for a Good Page. Rule a line between sessions and between Pages.

THE LEDGER, RUNNING BACKWARD. Turn the Book over and start at the last page. One line per promise: date, the promise, to whom, until, settled. Settle each with K kept, N renegotiated (the new terms written as a fresh line), R returned, or F failed or abandoned. The Ledger fills both pages of each spread as it runs back; when it meets the daily pages, the Book is full.

THE TALLY, BESIDE IT. When you need one, start it on the next completely blank right-hand page at the back (left and right as the pages lie open while you write the Ledger), and let the Ledger keep the left-hand page beside it, so your word and what arrived face each other. When a Tally page fills, begin the next on the next blank right-hand page. Write the date, what arrived, which working it answered, and how unlikely it looked; record the misses with the same care.

WORKINGS. Your side of a working goes in the Ledger: the bridge step, a prayer's earthly part and its own promises, and a ward's term as its Until. K when it is done or has run its term, R when you release it early, F when you did not walk the bridge. The world's side, whether it arrived, goes in the Tally and never takes a K or an F: the Ledger is the weight of your word, not a record of your luck.

INSIDE BACK COVER. The Short Door's Closing, and beneath it the full Closing if you like.



**THE SWEEP**

Once a month, on the first, with Janus, read only the marks: every Q, every C, every G, and every open line of the Ledger. Nothing else. It takes ten minutes and it is the single practice that keeps a Book from becoming a pile of beautiful pages nobody acts on.

1. **READ THE LEDGER FIRST.** Settle what is done. Return what cannot be kept. Renegotiate honestly what has changed, with the person it was given to where there is one: mark the old line N, and write the new terms as a fresh line.
2. **READ THE Q MARKS.** Answer what has answered itself since. Carry the rest forward by writing them again, today, in today's words.
3. **READ THE C MARKS.** Anything undone for two sweeps is not a task, it is a decision you have not made. Do it, drop it, or put it in the Ledger with a date.
4. **READ THE G MARKS.** Ask whether you still want it, and whether it wants to be smaller. A Goal you have stopped wanting and not released is a debt you are paying for nothing.
5. **COUNT.** Kept, renegotiated, returned, failed; and from the Tally, what arrived and what did not. Write the numbers and nothing else; no verdict on yourself. Over a year the numbers say more than any resolution will.

What the Ledger is for is not discipline. It is the weight of your word, which is the thing a declaration runs on: a Scribe whose promises are kept has a heavier word, and a heavier word makes a working land. The Temple asks for honesty, and the Ledger is where honesty stops being a feeling and becomes a record.

When the Book is full, keep it with the others, and begin the next by answering the last pages of the one before.

THE DEDICATION

HE Dedication is written once, on the first page of the Book you dedicate, any day in your first month, or on a Heart Day. It is the first stone of the Temple. Say it as you write it, aloud or within.

AONT, EHNB, XCAL, RMTQ, PAAM, Quintessence, Heart of the Temple of Mercury:

By my Birthright, I open this Book as a Window into your Temple, a room built beside its Heart. Shine through these pages.

Janus and Hestia, Metatron and Sandalphon, Uriel and Raziel, Gabriel and Idris, Seshat and Iris, Rosmerta and the Charites, Hermanubis and Ma'at, Thermes and Apharael: be welcome in your Offices in the pages of this Book.

Apharael, Hestia, and Ma'at, Keepers of the Compass: weigh what I write here.

Thermes, Hermanubis, and Mercury, the Thrice-Great: I build this room in your Temple as a co-conspirator in our Great Work.

Mercury, host of this house, my twin and guide: meet me at the Door.

Idris, who held the pen before me: I take up the seat in your tradition.

Genius of this place: grow here, and keep this room with me.

Here I will tell the truth. Honesty is my offering; Joy is my Truth.

Together, let us make the unseen legible and the hidden speakable, carry what we find across every threshold, and give it freely, that word become deed and the Joy of Truth multiply in the world.

So it is written.

THE PAGES

Every kind, in one place



VERY kind of Page the Temple uses is gathered here. What a Page is, and how it sits on the leaves, is in the Map of the Book.

THE COVERS, THE FIRST PAGE, CLOSE AT HAND, THE INDEX. Made once, as the Map of the Book and the Dedication describe.

THE LEDGER AND THE TALLY. At the back: one line per promise, settled K, N, R, or F, and beside it what arrived. The Map of the Book shows how.

THE SESSION. Every session is a Page of its own: dated, numbered, and ruled off when you close the Door.

THE LEGEND PAGE. What you want your life to be about, written when you are ready for the big picture. Below.

THE SCARCITY PAGE. For a stuck Goal: the one thing in shortest supply. Below.

THE ROADS PAGE. A Goal's roads, open, closed, and blocked, kept as long as it runs. Below.

THE GOOD PAGE. A day that was simply lovely, in detail, with no lesson drawn. Marked ♀. Below.

THE ANSWERED PAGE. What you have done and cannot stop carrying, named, weighed, and answered. Below.

THE DECISION PAGE. A choice that matters, with what you expect, how sure you are, and why, reread on a set day. Below.

THE LYRE PAGE. A setback, and what it could still become. Below.





THE RETURNED OATH. A promise carried back across the bridge it came over, signed and dated. In The Working.

THE WORKING. A Casting or a prayer of the Work, written with its date, its term, and its bridge, and given its line in the Ledger. In The Working and The Words.

THE SIGIL. A working drawn into one shape, ruled off where it sits if the leaf goes on. In The Working.

THE WATCH. What is written on the worst night and set down until morning. In a Hard Hour.

THE LEGEND PAGE

Your Personal Legend is found by walking, but it helps to know which way you are facing.

For finding the direction, and keeping it in sight.

Write it when you are ready for the big picture, and not before. Nothing in the practice waits on it: a Goal, a kept promise, and an honest page are enough to begin, and the Legend is often easier to find after a few of those.

1. **NAME WHAT MATTERS.** Write what you want your life to be about: not Goals yet, but the qualities you want to live by and the things you want to spend it on. Three to five lines.
2. **WRITE THE BEST POSSIBLE LIFE.** Imagine it is some years from now and everything has gone as well as it reasonably could. Write that life in detail, in the present tense: where you are, what you do, who is near you.
3. **NAME THE OBSTACLE.** Then write the main obstacle in you, and the step you will take when you meet it. Vision alone saps the will; vision joined to an obstacle and a plan fuels it.
4. **TEST IT.** Ask of each part: do I want this, or do I think I should want it? Keep what you want. Strike the rest without apology.
5. **MARK IT.** Head the Page LEGEND, date it, and give it a line in the Index.

Reread it at every Door of the Year, and whenever you are lost. Rewrite it when it stops being true; the old one stays, answered.

THE HORIZONS

Between the Legend and today are three distances, each kept at a landmark the calendar already gives you. Use them when you want the long view. None of them has to wait for its date, and nothing in the practice waits on them.

THE YEAR. At the Door of the Year, reread the Legend and write what it asks of this year: one or two things.

THE SEASON. At each equinox and solstice, choose one to three Goals for the season ahead, and mark them G.

THE WEEK. On Wednesday, when you write the week's crossing, name one step toward a Goal, and carry it.

SMALL BETS. Try the Legend small before you leap: a weekend, a single client, a short course, one piece shown. Bind small and keep it.

A WITNESS. Tell one person you trust what you are walking toward. A road nobody knows about is one nobody can help with.

THE SCARCITY PAGE

For a Goal that is stuck, whenever you want to know why.

1. **NAME THE GOAL.** One line, in the present tense.
2. **LIST WHAT IT NEEDS.** Time, money, energy, people, skill, standing, information, courage: write every one that applies.
3. **FIND THE SCARCITY.** Circle the one in shortest supply. It is rarely the one you have been working on. A Goal that seems to need money often needs an hour a day, and one that seems to need confidence often needs one person who can open a door.
4. **AIM THERE.** Write one step against the scarcity, and carry it.
5. **MARK IT.** Head the Page SCARCITY, with the Goal beside it. Scarcities move: once one is fed, the next shows itself, and that is progress.

THE ROADS PAGE

For a Goal you want to map, kept as long as the Goal runs. The Road says what a road is.

1. **HEAD IT.** Write ROADS and the Goal, and draw a small herm in the margin, for the god of roads.
2. **LIST THE ROADS.** One line per road, named by its far end, with W for wide or N for narrow.
3. **MARK EACH ONE.** O for open, B for blocked (and what blocks it); leave it blank for closed.
4. **OPEN AND WALK.** When you open a road, mark it O and date it; when you walk one, add the date beside it.
5. **WHEN YOU LOOK AGAIN.** Any O with no recent date has gone cold: strike the O, and open it again or let it go. Add the new roads that arrivals have opened.

THE GOOD PAGE

The Book has a practice for grief, for failure, for a broken oath, and for a working. This is the one for a day that was simply lovely, which a Temple whose rule is joy cannot do without.

1. **NAME THE HOUR.** Write what was good, plainly, with the date and the place. Not the week, not the mood: the hour.
2. **PUT IN THE DETAIL.** What it tasted like, what the light was doing, what was said, who was there. Detail is the whole exercise; a Good Page written in generalities is a page you cannot return to.





3. **DRAW NO LESSON.** No insight, and no plan to have more of this. The moment a good hour becomes a technique it stops being a good hour.
4. **MARK IT.** Draw Mercury's sign, ☿, in the margin beside it. These are the sections you will want in a bad February, and the sign makes them findable at a glance; when you go back to one, give it a line in the Index.
5. **GIVE THANKS AND CLOSE.** Write what you are grateful for in this moment: what is bringing you joy, named plainly. That is all. Give thanks for it to Rosmerta and the Charites, then stop writing and go back to your life.

Write one whenever there is one. On a thin day, reading an old Good Page is a legitimate session, and one of the better ones.

THE ANSWERED PAGE

What was done stays written; nothing in this Temple is torn out. What you can do is answer it: name it, weigh it, make the lyre, and turn the page.

For what you have done and cannot stop carrying.

1. **NAME IT.** Write plainly what you did, without defense and without drama. Ma'at weighs the truth, not the performance of guilt.
2. **WEIGH IT.** Who was harmed, and how? Include yourself.
3. **MAKE THE LYRE.** Ask what exchange would mend it: an apology, a repair, a debt repaid, a changed habit. Make it where you can. Where making it would cause new harm, give the lyre elsewhere, and offer to someone else the good you took from another.
4. **ANSWER THE PAGE.** Write your response beneath the account, and date it. What you did is recorded; so is what you did next.
5. **WASH YOUR HANDS** in clean water, as the merchants did at the Mercuralia.
6. **LET IT BE KEPT.** Say the Ascending Invocation, aloud or within, and turn the page. Raziel keeps what is answered, and Ma'at closes the account; nothing here is forgotten, it is settled. Do not reopen it to punish yourself; a heart that keeps reweighing a paid debt is not light, only tired.

WHEN YOU HAVE BEEN WRONGED. Hermes and Apollo were reconciled, but reconciliation is not owed. You may forgive without restoring the bond: answer the page, set the weight down, and keep your door as open or as closed as is right.

THE DECISION PAGE

For a choice that matters. Uriel's Page: see it clearly before you weigh it.

1. **NAME THE DECISION.** One line, and the day by which you will decide.

2. **LIST THE OPTIONS.** Every real one, including doing nothing and doing it later.
3. **WRITE WHAT YOU EXPECT.** For the option you lean toward: what you expect to happen, and by when. Then how sure you are, as a number out of ten.
4. **WRITE WHY.** Your reasons, in a few lines, and one thing that would change your mind.
5. **ASK, IF YOU LIKE.** Put it to the Heart, or take it to the Crossroads, and write what comes.
6. **DECIDE, AND SET THE REREAD.** Write the choice. Head the Page DECISION, and give the reread its own line in the Ledger, with the date as its Until.
7. **REREAD.** On that day, answer it by page number: what happened, how sure you were, and what you would weigh differently. Judge the reasons, not the luck. A good decision can land badly and a poor one well; over many Decision Pages, your number out of ten learns to tell the truth.

THE LYRE PAGE

For a setback: a loss of time, money, work, or face. Hermes made the lyre from a shell he found at his door.

1. **NAME WHAT WAS TAKEN.** Plainly, with the date: what happened, and what it cost.
2. **COUNT WHAT REMAINS.** What you still hold: the skill, the material, the people, the story, and the lesson it cost you.
3. **ASK WHAT IT COULD BECOME.** Write three answers, even foolish ones. What could this be traded into? A lesson taught, a story told, a better design, a road you would not have seen, a gift for someone further back on the same road.
4. **CHOOSE ONE, AND CARRY IT.** Take the answer that is truest, and carry one step toward it as a C.
5. **MARK IT.** Head the Page LYRE, and rule it off.

Not every loss is a lyre. Grief is not a setback to be reframed; it belongs to Hermanubis and the Descent, and asks only to be felt. This Page is for what can still be turned into something.





PART FOUR

The Working

The body's practice, the workings for what you actually want, and the rite for a promise that can no longer be kept.

GROUNDING TO AIR



OST grounding sends excess energy down into the earth. The Mercurian may ground upward instead, into Air, the element of the Temple.

Sit comfortably and breathe slowly. Feel the crown of your head, and see a thread of light rising from it, straight up through the ceiling, the sky, and beyond, into boundless clear air. Let whatever is heavy, tangled, or excessive in you flow up that thread and dissolve into open space. Then let clarity flow back down it: cool, bright, quick. Rest there until you feel light and awake, held from above rather than below.

This is the direction the Two Who Crossed traveled, and it is the Temple's direction. It need not be yours. If down into Earth, out into Water, or up into Fire steadies you better, ground there; the Temple needs you grounded, not made of Air. The standing practice that builds on it, Walking the Pillar, follows.

WALKING THE PILLAR

A standing practice that begins with Grounding to Air.



HE Temple stands on the Middle Pillar, and so can you. This practice builds the Pillar in the body, from the crown to the feet, with an Office at each station. Say each name, aloud or within; the Voice is an

offering.

1. **STAND.** Feet apart, knees soft, hands loose at your sides. Breathe slowly.
2. **GROUND TO AIR.** See the thread of light rise from your crown into boundless clear air. Let whatever is heavy flow up it and dissolve, and let clarity flow back down. Stay until you feel held from above.
3. **THE CROWN.** Just above your head, see a sphere of brilliant white light at the foot of the thread. Say: "Metatron." Feel it steady there.
4. **THE GATE.** Let a shaft of light descend to your throat, and see a soft grey sphere form there, where thought becomes speech. Say: "Uriel and Raziel."

5. **THE HEART.** Let the light descend to the center of your chest, and see a sphere of gold, like the sun. Say: "Aphrael."
6. **THE FOUNDATION.** Let it descend to your hips, and see a sphere of silver-violet, like moonlight. Say: "Gabriel."
7. **THE KINGDOM.** Let it descend to your feet and the ground beneath them, and see the light spread into the earth. Say: "Sandalphon." You stand now as he does, on earth with your head in heaven.
8. **CIRCULATE.** Breathing in, draw light up the Pillar from your feet to your crown and out along the thread into the open Air. Breathing out, let it fall around you like a fountain and gather again at your feet. Circulate for a few breaths, until you feel lit from within and light on your feet.
9. **REST AT THE HEART.** Bring your attention to the gold at your chest. From here, write, cast, ask, or simply give thanks and sit down.

The short form takes three breaths: one at the crown, one at the heart, one at the feet, with the thread to Air open above you. Use it before any session, and whenever you feel scattered.

Walk the full Pillar before a Casting or a prayer of the Work, on the Heart Days, and whenever you want to be whole and awake. If you grow dizzy, sit down, put your feet flat on the floor, and breathe until you are steady.

THE CLEARING

Hestia, Uriel, and Janus at the door. For a room, or for yourself.



HEN something unwelcome has come in, clear it: a presence, a mood that is not yours, what is left of a person or a quarrel, a working that went strange.

The Sanctuary prayer renews a room that has grown heavy; the Clearing sends out what does not belong. It is done wholly in the mind, in a few breaths, so it can be kept anywhere: on a train, in a meeting, in a room you have just walked into. Say its words aloud or within.

1. **THE CENTER.** See a steady flame at your heart, or at the center of the room. Say: "Hestia, keep the center."
2. **NAME WHAT GOES.** Plainly: the thing itself, or simply "whatever is not mine."
3. **THE SWORD.** See Uriel's sword of light pass through you from crown to feet, or around the walls of the room, dividing. Say: "Uriel, divide what is mine from what is not. What is not mine goes."
4. **THE DOOR.** See a door open before you. Say: "Janus, show it out." Breathe out, see it cross the threshold, and see the door close behind it.
5. **SEAL.** Return to the flame. Say: "The fire is kept. What is finished has left by the door; what is mine stays."





When there is time, add the hands: sweep and open a window first, stand at the center of the room, trace the sword with your hand, and open a real door and close it after.

The short form takes three breaths: the flame, the sword, the door. Keep the Clearing at the dark of the moon, after a quarrel or a heavy session, on entering a new place, before a working, or whenever something in you or the room is not yours.

THE TWO INVOCATIONS



WO currents run through the Temple, and the Pillar carries both. Descend to bind. Ascend to ask, to give, and to release.

Keep the Invocations for these moments, rather than every session; kept for binding and releasing, they stay weighty. After Walking the Pillar, say each one slowly, aloud or within, feeling each station light as you name it.

THE DESCENDING INVOCATION: WORD INTO WORLD

Use it whenever you bind a word you mean to become a deed. It carries the word from the Crown, down through the Gate, Beauty, and the Foundation, to the Kingdom.

USE IT FOR: every Casting; every prayer of the Work, from protection to passing unnoticed; any oath, contract, or commitment you sign and date; a launch, an offer, or a message you are about to send; a decision you are ready to live by.

Mercury, turn the Hinge.

Metatron, record this word.

Uriel and Raziel, weigh it and carry it to the Heart.

Aphrael, show me the road.

Gabriel, hold its image until it takes form.

Sandalphon, carry it into the living world.

By my Birthright,

so it is written, and so it is.

THE ASCENDING INVOCATION: WORLD INTO WORD

Use it whenever you lift something up: a question to be answered, something finished to be given, or something to be set down. It carries the word from the Kingdom, up through the Foundation, Beauty, and the Gate, to the Crown and into the Heart. What comes back, comes as a flash, in its own time.

USE IT FOR: a question you want the Heart to answer, which you then mark Q and leave; thanks for a working that arrived; dedicating finished work, a sale made, or a season completed; releasing an oath, a working you have ended, or a debt you have answered; laying down grief, worry, or a weight you cannot carry further; and lifting the name of someone you love.

Mercury, turn the Hinge.

Sandalphon, gather this word.

Gabriel, take its image.

Aphrael, carry it home.

Uriel and Raziel, weigh it and open the Gate.

Metatron, receive it into the record,

and let it rest in the Heart.

By my Birthright,

so it is given, and so it is.

The two are one circuit. What rises from the Kingdom becomes the Crown, and what is written at the Crown descends to become a deed. A single matter may use both: ask by ascending, receive the flash, then bind the answer by descending.

THE WEIGHT OF THE WORD



HIS is the Temple's one mechanism, and it is a magickal claim, so it is made here plainly and not hedged. A word said at the Door is a decree.

Metatron records it, Iris carries it, Ma'at weighs it, and Sandalphon carries it into the world. But the Temple carries a word in proportion to its weight, and a word gets its weight from having been kept. Every promise kept, however small, tells the deep mind and the Temple alike that what this Scribe says is real. Every one broken teaches them that it is not, quietly, and a declaration from a Scribe whose words are not real is carried nowhere.

So a Casting is not a wish said in the present tense. It is the next promise of a Scribe with a record, in the same voice that said *when I sit down after lunch, I will send the email* and then sent it. The world begins to take you at your word because you have. Chaos magic calls the ingredient belief and reaches for it through gnosis; this Temple builds it the slow way, one kept line at a time, until a declaration is something you can stand behind without your mind arguing, which is exactly the state Declarative Alignment asks for. That is why the Casting ends in the Ledger, why the Sweep writes F, and why the Ledger never records the world's side: the weight is yours, and it is the only part of the working you can build on purpose.

The research in Volume VI says what a kept promise does to you. This is what it does to your word. Hold both; the Temple was built to.





EMOTIONAL TRANSMUTATION

The Casting: the Temple's working for what you actually want.



MOTION is fuel. XCAI, Water of Air, gives it words, and Ma'at keeps the heart honest while it burns. Cast it in the Work, when the mind has been emptied, the past reread, and the Scribe answered, so that what is truly wanted has had room to surface. Not every feeling needs to be spent. Some only need to be felt, and Hermanubis keeps that road.

1. **EMPTY IT.** Sit with what you feel, name it, and write it out without dressing it up. Naming is not a preliminary to the work; it is the first half of it, and an unnamed feeling cannot be transmuted because you cannot get hold of it. If the page goes three times around the same loop, stop writing and go on.
2. **WEIGH IT.** From what you wrote, find what you actually want. Is it true, and will you still want it when it arrives? Most weak workings are mended here before they are cast. Ask one of the Compass questions too. If the feeling is about another person, the intention is about your road, not theirs. Before a large working, it helps to ask the Heart.
3. **DECLARE IT.** One sentence, in the present tense, describing the reality you want. Name the destination and leave the road. This is the decree Metatron records.
4. **FEEL THE WEIGHT.** Hold the wanting and the feeling together until you can sense them in your body.
5. **REMEMBER THE FUTURE.** Recall the moment it came true, as a memory rather than a hope: where you are, who is with you, what you can hear. Feel the relief, the joy, the gratitude. Write those feelings down, and stay with them until they have weight too. Gabriel holds the image.
6. **PUSH.** Call back the heavy sensation and press its weight into the relief and joy, until you have pushed enough. That is the time to stop.
7. **NAME THE OBSTACLE.** Still inside that memory, look back along the road. Write the main obstacle in you, and the step you will take when you meet it. Vision alone can quietly sap the will to act; vision joined to a plan fuels it. For a large working, add a pre-mortem: imagine it is a year from now and the thing failed, and write why.
8. **SEND IT.** Inhale, then say the intention and the Descending Invocation, aloud or within; or call on Gabriel silently and hand him the words you have reviewed. On each exhale, see your breath as bright white fog, the color of XCAI, filling the space and settling down into the page. Each breath is the conspiracy made literal: you breathe out, and the Temple breathes with you. The work is done.

9. **WALK THE BRIDGE.** Write your thanks and your first step. Put the step in the Ledger, then do it. This is not an afterthought; it is the half of the working that crosses from above to below. Apharael guides the road and Sandalphon carries the word, but only for the one who walks.

10. **LET IT GO.** When the working comes to mind, give it thanks and turn away. Reread it when the Practice brings you there, and note in the Tally what arrives; in between, leave it alone. The watched working is the conscious mind interfering. Leave room for the conspiracy.

One well-cast working is enough; do not pile other workings upon it. Saying the same one again to renew it is another matter, and so is casting it again when it has not landed. If you wish, seal it with the Declarative Alignment or a sigil, both of which follow.

If what rises is more than you can hold, stop. Set down the pen, breathe, feel your feet on the floor, and reach for someone you trust. The Book can accompany care; it cannot replace it.

DECLARATIVE ALIGNMENT



It may seal a Casting, said after Send It, or stand on its own. Stand or sit straight and see the Pillar: a point of brilliant light above your crown, where Metatron keeps the record, and another beneath your feet, where Sandalphon stands on the ground, joined by a fine thread of light that runs through your center. Write a present-tense statement of what you intend, and as you write, feel the words run along the thread. Say: "I align with this new reality," and read your statement, aloud or slowly within; or call on Gabriel silently and hand him the words you have written. See the thread brighten from Crown to Kingdom, then burst outward to the edges of the world, and know that its echo returns as your life.

Phrase the statement as something you can wholeheartedly stand behind. A declaration your mind argues with weakens itself; one that names a value you truly hold grows stronger each time it is said. The strongest are about the one who walks rather than the road: not I will keep this promise, but I am someone whose word is good.

PAAM gives the declaration its fire, Iris binds it, and Sandalphon carries it into the world.





MAKING A SIGIL



sigil is an intention compressed into a single shape, so the deep mind can carry it where the conscious mind would interfere.

1. **WRITE IT.** Your intent, in one sentence, in the present tense.
2. **TRANSMUTE IT.** Perform Emotional Transmutation on it.
3. **STRIKE IT.** Strike out every repeated letter, so that one of each letter in the sentence remains.
4. **DRAW IT.** Start combining the shapes of those letters into squiggly patterns. Keep combining, revising, and condensing until you like what you have drawn, and have forgotten, in the drawing, all of the emotions you just processed.
5. **CHOOSE ITS FATE.** Decide what becomes of it: keep it in the Book, or draw it on a slip you can burn, or fold and carry.
6. **SPEAK IT.** Speak the intention over the sigil, aloud or within, then do what you chose.

Having made the sigil is enough. You may charge it further with energy work if you choose. A sigil may also be drawn from the letters of an Enochian working instead of a sentence, as Volume VII describes.

If you make a sigil in the middle of a page with room left to write, rule off the borders of the working and keep writing until the leaf is full; the rule seals it, as Pages and Leaves, in the Map of the Book, describes.

DO NOT SPECIFY THE ROAD



It is worth saying on its own, because it is the commonest way a working is weakened. Declare the end state and leave the route alone. Do not require the money to come from that client, the answer from that person, or the opening in that month; every such condition is a door you have nailed shut on a house with many of them.

This is not passivity, and it does not excuse you from acting. You still walk the bridge: one concrete step, written, taken. The distinction is simple. What you will do is yours to specify and should be specific. How the world will meet you is not, and the Temple's own god is the one who moves along the roads nobody mapped. A Mercurian who insists on the route is asking the god of crossings to take the path they already know.

If a particular road matters to you for its own sake, then it is not the road; it is the thing you actually want, and it should be declared as the destination instead.

The world conspires with the one who wants, and a conspiracy needs room. Every road you dictate is one fewer road the world

can use to reach you. Its other half is in The Road: specify no road, and build many.

WHEN A WORKING DOES NOT LAND



SOMETIMES it does not arrive. Say so plainly in the Tally, with the date, as carefully as you would record an arrival. Then look at your own side in the Ledger: if you walked the bridge, that line is K, whatever the world did; if you did not, it is F.

Then notice what this Temple will not say to you. It will not say that you did not believe hard enough, that some limiting belief blocked it, that you were not in alignment, or that a part of you did not really want it. That reasoning is unfalsifiable and it is cruel: it converts every disappointment into evidence of a personal defect, and it is the same machinery as sin wearing a friendlier coat. A working that did not land is a working that did not land.

Ask the ordinary questions instead. Did you want the thing you declared, or something you thought you should want? Did you walk the bridge, or only write it? Was the hour wrong? Has it in fact arrived by a road you did not recognize, because you were watching one door? And then: do you still want it? If you do, cast it again, on top, and go on. If you do not, release it: write *This working is finished*, and let it go. Nothing here is owed to you, and nothing here is your fault for not being owed it.

THE RETURNED OATH

For a promise that can no longer be kept, or should not be. A Goal is an oath made to yourself, and is returned the same way.



ESIOD tells that a god who broke an oath sworn on the Styx lay breathless for a year, and was barred from the company of the gods for nine more. Iris carried that water, and a broken oath is heavy. But breaking an oath and releasing it are different acts. Breaking an oath is walking away from it. Releasing one is carrying it back across the bridge it came over. The first leaves the Heart heavy; the second can leave it light.

1. **FIND THE PAGE.** Reread where the oath was bound, and find its line in the Ledger. Metatron kept it.
2. **WEIGH IT.** Why can it not be kept? Circumstances have changed; it has become wrong; it harms you or another; the one you swore to has released you. Then ask Uriel's question: is this truth, or escape? If it is escape, keep the oath or renegotiate it. Do not return it.
3. **SPEAK TO THE OTHER.** An oath made to a person is released with that person wherever possible, in words, honestly. An oath made only to yourself is released in the Book.





4. **NAME WHAT REMAINS.** Most promises hold something that outlives them: respect, care, a duty to a child, a lesson. Write what you still keep.
5. **RETURN IT TO IRIS.** Write: "I return this oath to Iris, who carried it. It was true when I made it. It is no longer mine to keep." Sign and date it, and say the Ascending Invocation, aloud or within. See the bow fold back into one white light.
6. **GIVE THANKS** for what the oath held while it held. If there is grief in the release, and there often is, Hermanubis knows the way down and back.

PART FIVE

The Words

The ten prayers of the Work, the four blessings, and the others you will meet in them.

THE TEN PRAYERS OF THE WORK

THE PRINCIPLE OF THESE PRAYERS

THESE prayers are strongest exactly where they touch other people, so one principle keeps them clean: work on the road, not on the traveler. Guard what is yours to guard, open your own door, light your own window, and draw your own veil. Do not bind another's will, choose for them, or make anyone want what they would not want. When someone has wronged you, hand the account to the scale rather than choosing what they meet; the prayer For the Scale is for this. Mercury does not moralize, and neither does this chapter; but a prayer that tries to own another person tangles the one who says it. As above, so below: you reap what you sow.

Every prayer here has an earthly part, and each is named with its prayer below: lock the door, back up the files, make the call, show your work, tell someone you trust. The prayer stands beside the deed, never instead of it.

Say the prayer in the Work, aloud or within, write it into the Book with the date, and seal it with the Descending Invocation. Every prayer here can end. As you say it, write how long it runs or what will end it, and give it a line in the Ledger: its earthly part and its own promises, with its term as the Until. When it is done, answer the page, "This working is finished," and say the Ascending Invocation, aloud or within, to release it. What you bound as an oath, release as The Returned Oath describes.

FOR PROTECTION · Janus, Hestia, Raziel, Uriel, and Hermes before the gate

For yourself, someone you love, or a thing you keep. Write what you guard, and draw a small herm beside it.

Hermes before the gate, keep this door. Janus, who sees who comes and who goes; Hestia at the center, who does not move; Raziel at the threshold; Uriel, whose sword divides what may enter from what may not. Here is what I guard: [name it]. Keep it the way a door keeps a house, not the way a wall keeps a prison; what is welcome may come and go. I am not asking you to stand where I will not. I will lock what can be locked and say what must be said.

Keep this door until I say the watch is ended.

The earthly part. Lock the door, back up the files, have the conversation. The herm stands beside the lock, never instead of it. A ward for another person guards their door; it does not lock them in.

FOR THE SCALE · Ma'at, Hermanubis, Uriel

When someone has wronged you or yours. Name the harm, not the punishment, and write how long the working runs.

Ma'at, Feather of Truth, against whom every heart is weighed; Hermanubis, who keeps the balance and knows the way down; Uriel, whose sword divides what may enter from what may not. Here is the harm: [name it plainly]. I do not choose what they meet, and I do not ask for suffering; I hand this account to the scale. Weigh it truly. Let what was done find its answer, let them meet the lesson they need, and let the harm stop reaching me and those I love. Whether they rise or fall on it is theirs. Weigh me by the same feather. I set down the weight of what they did, and leave it with you.

Let the account be weighed, and let it close.

The earthly part. Step out of the situation; often that is all it asks. If protecting yourself and yours takes more, such as a block, a record of what happened, a word with someone you trust, or the help the world offers, do that too. The scale stands beside it, never instead of it. Where nothing more is needed, leave the rest to the scale, and put it out of your mind. The working does best without the conscious mind watching it, and handing it over sets down the pain they caused, or at least lets you take account and move on. When you know it has closed, write "This working is finished."

FOR WHAT I FEAR · Ma'at, Apharael, Hestia

When a worry will not set itself down. Write the fear first, plainly and all of it, then say this.

Ma'at, Apharael, and Hestia, Keepers of the Compass: here is what I fear: [name it]. I have written it down, and I will not carry it alone. I lay it on the scale. Weigh it truly; show me what in it is real, and what is only the dark talking. Where it is real, show me the step that is mine. Where it is not, let it go light. I do not ask for the outcome I would choose in fear. I ask for the greatest good, as the feather would weigh it, the true road would make it, and the hearth would keep it, for me and for everyone this touches.





Let it be weighed, and let me be light enough to walk.

The earthly part. *If there is a step that is yours, take it, and give it a line in the Ledger. Then put the fear out of your mind; it is on the scale, not in your hands. If it comes back, you do not have to pick it up: say "It is on the scale," and turn to the next thing. If the fear is about someone's safety, reach the people and help that can act on it. If it is more than you can hold, reach someone you trust.*

FOR PEACE · Hestia, Janus, Uriel

When what is outside keeps reaching in: other people's moods and pressure, noise, bad news, ill will. Write how long the working runs, or what will end it.

Hestia, keeper of the fire at the center, who does not move; Janus at the door, who sees what comes and what goes; Uriel, whose sword divides what is mine from what is not. Here is my peace: [where I keep it: the house, the work, the mind]. Let what is not mine stay outside it: the hurry that is not my hurry, the anger that is not my anger, the fear I did not choose, and any ill will sent my way. I do not wall out the people I love, or the truth I need to hear; what is welcome comes in by the door. I will tend my own fire, and I will not feed what I want gone.

Let my peace be kept, and let what is not mine pass by.

The earthly part. *Guard what reaches you: close the feed, silence what can be silenced, step out of the room that is not yours to carry, and keep the hours you rest. The Clearing sends out what has already come in; this keeps the center once it is clear. If the pressure comes from someone who means you harm, the prayer For the Scale is for that, with the help the world offers.*

FOR FAVOR AND ALLURE · Mercury, Iris, the Charites

Before you go where you would be seen: an interview, a market, a first meeting, a stage.

Mercury, whose charm won over Apollo with a lyre; Iris, who makes light visible as color; Charites, who keep grace moving. I do not ask to be someone else. Let what is truest in me be easy to see: [my wit, my warmth, my craft, my voice]. Put the grin on it, because allure without delight is only performance. Let whoever is drawn by it come freely, and let no one be drawn toward a self that is not there.

Let me be seen as I am, at my best, and let it draw the right people near.

The earthly part. *Dress for the self you named, speak up, show your work, and go where you can be seen. Allure invites; it never compels.*

FOR PASSING UNNOTICED · Mercury, Raziel

For a season of quiet: to heal, to work in peace, to keep a thing hidden until it is ready. Name the season and its end before you begin.

Mercury, who wore the cap of Hades and walked the roads in disguise; Raziel, who lays a finger across the lip. For this season, until [the date or the condition], let me pass as a traveler passes, one more face on a busy road. What is not ready to be seen is kept. I am not hiding from what I owe, and

I am not hiding from the people who keep me safe. I tell no lies to pass; I only say less.

Let me pass unremarked until the season ends.

The earthly part. *Say less, wear what does not catch the eye, post nothing, keep your plans in the Book, and tell someone you trust that you have drawn the Veil. When the season ends, write: "The cap is returned. I may be seen."*

FOR THE HOME · Janus, Hestia, Seshat, and the Genius of the place

On moving day, after a scare, on the first of the month, or whenever you cross your own threshold and remember.

Janus at the door, Hestia at the center, Seshat under the floor, and you, spirits of this place, Mercury's own children kept at the hearth. This is my dwelling: [name it]. Let whoever enters come by the door and leave by it with thanks. Let the fire be kept and the roof hold. Let the people and the creatures who live here sleep safe, and let what is ours stay ours.

Keep this house, and let it be a place worth returning to.

The earthly part. *Check the locks, the smoke alarm, and the stove. Learn your neighbors' names. The Temple guards best what is also guarded by hand.*

FOR SANCTUARY · Hestia, Janus, Ma'at

When you make a room for the Work, after an illness or a quarrel, or at the Vestalia. Clean the room by hand first: sweep it, air it, wash the sill.

Hestia, who gave up the throne and kept the fire; Janus, who keeps the door; Ma'at, who renews order daily. Nothing here is unclean. It has only grown heavy, crowded, or stale, the way rooms do. I have swept it, opened the window, and washed what I could reach. With this water, at the door and in the corners, let what is finished leave by the door, and let what is kept stay. This room is a sanctuary: here someone is safe without earning it, and that someone is me, and whoever I bring.

Let this place be kept, and let it be safe to set things down here.

The earthly part. *Keep it as you made it: a place for the Book, a chair, and nothing that argues. Renew it when it grows heavy again. Consecration is never finished.*

FOR THE ONE WHO CAN HELP · Mercury, Apharael, Idris

When you need a particular kind of person: someone with an opportunity, a hand to lend, or something to teach. Describe them by their qualities, never by a name, and leave a few lines blank beneath.

Mercury, opener of ways, who brings whoever is meant to arrive; Apharael, who came to the door on the day the journey began; Idris, who learned it slowly and handed it on. I am looking for someone: [the kind of person, and what they could give or teach]. I do not choose them, and I do not reach for anyone's will. I open my door and stand on the road. Let them find a door that is open and a Scribe who is findable, and let me know them when they arrive looking like a detour.





Mercury, open the way. The door of this house is open.

The earthly part. Name where you will go, whom you will tell, and what you will make and show. When someone comes, write them in the place you left, and pass some of the luck along.

FOR ABUNDANCE AND LUCK · Mercury, Rosmerta, the Charites

After an honest accounting, never instead of one. Write what is real first, without shame.

Mercury, god of the wage and the found coin, who is Kairos and Fortuna both; Rosmerta, with the horn and the dish; Charites, who keep good things moving. Here is what is real: [the accounting]. Here is what I want: [enough, and a little more, for this purpose]. Turn the Hinge in my favor: the timely call, the fair price, the unexpected yes. Let the luck be clean, and let me know it when it comes. I will make the offer, do the work, and pass some of it along.

Let the luck be clean, and let it find me moving.

The earthly part. Make one real offer, call, or ask today. Write the lucky finds in the Tally, and pass some of the luck along while you still have it. Anything that promises money without action is lying.

THE FOUR BLESSINGS



blessing is said over someone else and asks nothing of them. Say it aloud if they will have it, and silently if they will not; either way, it is given.

FOR THE ROAD

Mercury at the hinge, Apharael at your shoulder, Iris ahead of you with the word. Go out moving and come back changed. May the find be lucky, the company good, and the road shorter than the map said. And may someone know where you are.

FOR THE HOUSE

Janus at the door, Hestia at the center, Seshat under the floor. May this place be entered on purpose and left with thanks. May the fire be kept rather than lit, and may whoever arrives unannounced be fed.

FOR THE MAKING

Thermes for the word, Apharael for the measure, Sandalphon for the hands. May it be begun without ceremony, finished without excuse, and judged without sentiment. May it be better than you needed it to be.

FOR THE DEAD

Hermanubis, take them down gently and know the way. Ma'at, find the heart light. Seshat, keep the name. Mercury, who has made this crossing more often than any of us, lead them out as you led the others, and do not hurry them. We keep what they gave us. Nothing here is forgotten; it is settled.

THOSE YOU WILL MEET IN THE WORDS



HE prayers and rites name more of the Temple than the core you have met. Here is each of the others in a line, with the saying that belongs to it.

JANUS, the Door: god of every beginning and ending.

Every ending is a beginning seen from the other face.

HESTIA, the Flame: the hearth at the center that does not move. Her feast is the Vestalia, June 9.

The fire is kept, not lit.

GABRIEL, Holder of Images: the announcer; dreams and visions; archangel of the Moon, whose new and full are his days.

Say it, and it becomes possible.

IDRIS, Scribe of the Seat: Enoch as a man, first to write with a pen.

Learn it, then hand it on.

SESHAT, the Founder: writing, measure, and memory.

Record it, or it did not happen.

IRIS, the Oath-bearer: the rainbow who carried the water the gods swore on.

Carry it whole, and do not improve it on the way.

ROSMERTA, the Provider: plenty in hand; Mercury's consort on the altars of Gaul.

Plenty that is never enjoyed is only inventory.

THE CHARITES, Aglaia, Euphrosyne, Thalia: giving, receiving, returning.

A grace is only a grace when it moves.

HERMANUBIS, Guide of the Descent: Hermes with Anubis.

There is a way down, and it returns.

THERMES, the Crossing: Hermes with Thoth; the word and the record.

Meaning lives in the crossing.

APHARAEL, the Measure and the Road: Apollo with Raphael; the healer who walked the whole road beside Tobias in disguise, carrying the cure.

Is it true, is it well made, is it in proportion?

THE THRICE-GREAT: Thermes, Hermanubis, and Mercury, three faces of Hermes, above, below, and between. It is what Trismegistus means.

THE GENIUS LOCI, the spirit of the Book: grown, not made, from greeting, use, and thanks. Honored without a line of its own, by the greeting and the thanks, and on the Book's Day, its feast.





PART SIX

The Year

The days of the Temple and how to honor each, and the rites for the crossings of a life. The year at a glance, and the sky in order, are in Volume V.

THE CALENDAR



HE machinery works when you work it, and no day is required. What a calendar gives is a set of appointments you did not have to decide on, which is worth more than it sounds to a temperament that can talk itself out of anything.

Every celebration here has the same three parts, and they are the three things a Mercurian has to give. THE ACT is done with the hands or the feet, because a day observed only in thought was not observed. THE PAGE is what is written, because the word is the work. THE GIVING goes outward to someone else, because a Temple of exchange that never gives is a warehouse. Keep all three when you can and any one of them when you cannot.

THE RECURRING RHYTHM



OME days come back every week or every month. They are small appointments you did not have to decide on, and any one of them kept is enough.

WEDNESDAY. Mercury's day. It still bears his name in the Romance tongues, mercredi, miércoles, mercoledì; in English it is Woden's day, and the Romans took Woden for Mercury, which is another crossing.

The Act: Take a route you have not taken, even a short one. The god is met in motion.

The Page: Say the full Door, aloud or within, and write the week's crossing: what you are carrying from where to where.

The Giving: Answer the message you have been avoiding.

THE FOURTH OF THE MONTH. Hermes was born on the fourth day, and the Greeks honored him on the fourth of every month ever after, counting their months by the Moon (see the Noumenia, below). It is his birthday, twelve times a year.

The Act: Leave something small at a threshold, or put a coin where someone will find it.

The Page: One page of play: a riddle, a pun, a wordplay, a joke on yourself. The Book is allowed to be funny.

The Giving: A story told, a lesson shared, or a gift given with no occasion attached.

THE SEVENTH. Apollo was honored on the seventh, so the seventh belongs to Apharael. The measure day.

The Act: Pick up the thing you have made this week and handle it, as a maker would.

The Page: Three honest lines: is it true, is it well made, is it in proportion? Then one line on what you will change.

The Giving: One piece of specific true praise for somebody else's work. Not encouragement. Praise with a reason in it.

THE FIRST OF THE MONTH. Janus, whose month opens the year and who was given every gate.

The Act: Open a window or a door deliberately, and clear the place where you write.

The Page: Reread the month behind you and name what you carry into the one ahead. Not what you will fix.

The Giving: End one thing properly: the last message, the closed account, the thanks you never sent.

THE SWEEP. Once a month, on the first, with Janus. The Temple's only audit.

The Act: Read only the marks, as the Map of the Book describes: every Q, C, and G, and every open line of the Ledger.

The Page: Four numbers: kept, renegotiated, returned, failed. No verdict on yourself.

The Giving: Settle one thing you owe, today, before the Sweep is over.

THE NEW MOON. Gabriel, archangel of the Moon, at the Foundation, where images gather before they take form. The dark of the moon is the seed: nothing is shown yet, which is the point.

The Act: An hour with the lights low and the screens off.

The Page: Write the question you are carrying, or the thing you want, and mark it Q. Say the Ascending Invocation, aloud or within: *Gabriel, take its image*. Do not answer it tonight. If a working is ready to cast, this is its night.

The Giving: Keep something for someone until it is ready.

THE FULL MOON. Gabriel again, who came to Daniel to read what he had seen. What was seeded in the dark is lit now.

The Act: Go outside and look at it. Then walk a little, slowly, and look for one thing vast or intricate enough to make you feel small: the moon itself, an old tree, the lights of a city. Ten minutes is an awe walk, and it is enough.

The Page: Reread every Q and every dream recorded since the New Moon, and write what has taken shape. Read the Tally for what arrived. Tonight, call on Gabriel and hand him





whatever you have been declaring only on paper, said aloud or read slowly within.

The Giving: Tell someone the thing you have been holding until it was ready.

THE DEIPNON, THE MONTH'S LAST NIGHT. For those who want it. The Greeks counted the month by the Moon, and on its last dark night, the eve of the New Moon, they swept the house, carried the sweepings out, and set a small supper at the crossroads for Hekate, who shares every crossroads with Hermes. Hekate holds no Office in this Temple; she is honored here as the Greeks honored her, a neighbor at his crossings.

The Act: Sweep the place where you write, and carry the sweepings out of the house.

The Page: What this month is finished with. Settle what can be settled, and leave the rest to the dark.

The Giving: A small supper set out at a threshold or a crossroads; or, as the Greeks' suppers mostly ended, food given to someone who needs it.

THE NOUMENIA, THE FIRST CRESCENT. For those who want it. A day or two after the New Moon, the first thin Moon appears low in the west after sunset, and the Greeks began the month with it, honoring the gods of the household. Here it belongs to Hestia and Janus: the fire and the door, at the start of a month counted by the sky.

The Act: Go out after sunset and find the first crescent.

The Page: What this month is for: one Goal, or none, and one small thing to begin.

The Giving: Something fresh for the household: clean water, a flower, a meal made for whoever lives with you.

The lunar month is the older one. The Greeks counted from the Noumenia, and the fourth day after it was Hermes's. The Temple keeps his birthday on the fourth of the calendar month because the calendar is easier to remember; if you keep the lunar month instead, keep the fourth day after the Noumenia, and the Moon will tell you which it is. Together the three dark-to-light nights make a small gradient: the Deipnon clears, the New Moon declares, and the Noumenia begins.

THE WHEEL OF THE YEAR



HE year turns through its feasts, each with an Act, a Page, and a Giving. Keep the ones you will keep, and let the rest pass without reproach.

JANUARY 1, THE DOOR OF THE YEAR. Janus. His month, his gate, and the one day the whole world keeps with him.

The Act: Cross a threshold deliberately at some point in the day, and say the Door as you do.

The Page: Reread the year. Then write what you are walking into, in the present tense, as the Casting is written. Reread the Legend Page, and write what it asks of this year.

The Giving: Forgive one small debt that is owed to you, and say so.

FEBRUARY 13 TO 22, THE DAYS OF THE DEAD.

Hermanubis. Rome kept the Parentalia for nine days in honor of the family dead and ended it at the Caristia, a meal at which quarrels were required to be settled. Descent, and then reconciliation, placed in the worst month on purpose.

The Act: Set a place at the table, or take food to a grave, or light something and leave it burning while you write.

The Page: Write to one of your dead by name. Tell them what has happened since. Do not tidy it.

The Giving: On the last day, the Caristia: eat with the living and settle one quarrel, even partially, even badly.

THE SPRING EQUINOX, ABOUT MARCH 20: THE ASCENT. Sandalphon, Carrier of the Ascent, as the light overtakes the dark.

The Act: Begin the thing you have been circling, in whatever small form it can begin today.

The Page: Keep the Ascent, in the Rites of Passage. Name what you will still want when the season closes, and put a date on it.

The Giving: Lift someone else's work: an introduction, a recommendation, a name said in a room they are not in.

MARCH 25, THE ANNOUNCEMENT. Gabriel and Idris. The day the angel spoke.

The Act: Say one true thing out loud that you have been holding, to the person who should hear it.

The Page: Name the thing you are learning this year and the thing you are teaching. Both slots filled, in writing.

The Giving: Teach one person one thing, properly, at whatever length it actually takes.

APRIL 1, THE TRICKSTER'S DAY. Mercury, who stole the cattle before noon on the day he was born. This one is a modern adoption and the Temple says so plainly; the argument for it is the argument for the first of January, that the whole world already keeps it with him.

The Act: A prank that costs nobody anything, and a rule broken that should not have been a rule.

The Page: One page mocking yourself, which is the only reliable cure for the Mercurian's self-seriousness.

The Giving: Let somebody else be the clever one in a room where you would usually be.





MAY 15, THE MERCURIALIA. Mercury. Roman merchants dipped laurel in the water of his spring, sprinkled themselves and their goods, and asked forgiveness for the falsehoods of the year. The Day of Accounting, and Rosmerta stood beside him on those altars, so the reckoning ends at a table.

The Act: Wash your hands in clean water, and sprinkle the tools of your trade: the pen, the desk, the keys, the till.

The Page: Count honestly how you have dealt this year. Where you shaded the truth for advantage, name it plainly.

The Giving: Make one repair you have been putting off, and make it by giving something rather than by explaining.

JUNE 9, THE VESTALIA. Hestia. Rome opened the inner shrine of the hearth for one week a year, and the mill-donkeys were garlanded and given the day off.

The Act: Clean the place. Tend the Book itself: repair it, air it, set it somewhere it will be seen. Rest the thing that carries you.

The Page: Write to the house, or to the room, or to the Book: what it has held for you this year.

The Giving: Feed people in it. One table, however small.

THE SUMMER SOLSTICE, ABOUT JUNE 21: THE OPEN GATE. Uriel. Macrobius called the solstices the two gates of the year, and this is the gate of light.

The Act: Be outside at the longest light, and look at something far away.

The Page: Reread everything marked Q and answer what can now be answered. Strike the questions that have died.

The Giving: Give a true warning, early, to someone who needs it. In time it is mercy; late it is a confession.

JULY, THE HERMAIA. Hermes as patron of the gymnasium and the palaestra, honored across Greece with athletic games; the dates varied from city to city, so take any day in July; when in doubt, the fifteenth. At Cydonia in Crete the order was inverted and masters waited on their slaves, and on Samos, at the feast of Hermes the Giver of Joy, people were permitted to steal without penalty for a day. It is the Temple's feast of the body and of play, and the Temple has no other.

The Act: Move. Run, swim, wrestle, dance, climb something. It should be physical and a little undignified.

The Page: One page written badly and fast, on purpose. The Book is allowed to be ugly for a day.

The Giving: Reverse a rank. Serve the person who usually serves you, hand your authority to the junior for an afternoon, let a child decide where you go.

AUGUST 29, THE SCRIBE'S NEW YEAR. Thermes. The first day of the month of Thoth, the old Egyptian new year.

The Act: Begin a new Book if one is ready, and dedicate it. Otherwise copy something out by hand for the pleasure of the copying.

The Page: Write to the Scribe who will read this a year from now. Assume they are a stranger; tell them what they need.

The Giving: Give a book away, or copy a page for someone who would not otherwise have it.

THE AUTUMN EQUINOX, ABOUT SEPTEMBER 22: THE WEIGHING. Ma'at. Day equals night and the scales stand level.

The Act: Sit with the Book closed for a while first. The weighing is not a task to get through.

The Page: Not the Ledger's numbers but the heart's: what is heavy, what is unsaid, what is unpaid, and what you are pretending not to know.

The Giving: Pay one thing in full. Then let it be closed, and do not reopen it to punish yourself.

OCTOBER 11, THE MEDITRINALIA. Aphrael. The Romans tasted the new wine beside the old with a formula about drinking wine old and new and healing sickness old and new, and the day was reckoned to the healer.

The Act: Take the medicine, book the appointment, do the thing for your body you have been deferring. Old sickness and new.

The Page: What is healing, and what is not, and what you have been calling healed because you are tired of it.

The Giving: Check on someone convalescing, and go in person. A message is not a visit.

NOVEMBER, THE FALLOW MONTH. Nothing is asked. No feast, no rite, and no Office to attend; only the Sweep, and the daily pages if you want them. A calendar needs a month with nothing in it, or it becomes a debt, and this Temple does not keep its Scribes in debt.

The Act: Nothing. Let the ground lie.

The Page: Whatever you like, or none at all.

The Giving: Nothing is owed. If something is given in November it is given freely, which is the whole point of the month.

THE WINTER SOLSTICE, ABOUT DECEMBER 21: THE KEPT GATE. Raziel, and the longest night. The gate of what is hidden.

The Act: Keep one thing dark: a light out, a screen off, an hour without speaking.

The Page: Write what is not ready to be known, then turn the page and let the Gate keep it. Do not reread it tonight.





The Giving: Keep somebody's confidence that it would be easy and pleasant to spend.

DECEMBER 31, THE CLOSING OF THE ACCOUNT. The Ledger's year end.

The Act: Read the Ledger from its last page forward, slowly, aloud or within.

The Page: Settle what is done, return what cannot be kept, and write the four numbers: kept, renegotiated, returned, failed.

The Giving: Release someone from a promise they made you and cannot keep, before they have to ask.

THE MERCURY CYCLE



HE Greeks gave the planet two names, Apollo when it rose as a morning star and Hermes when it set as an evening one, and knew all along that the two were one body. Thermes and Apharael are that planet seen twice. So the hundred and sixteen days of Mercury's cycle are the Temple's own year within the year. Its two meetings with the Sun, the High Heart and the Deep Heart, are the Heart Days, the days that ask the most: the full Door, the Calling of the Heart, and the working that matters most. The cycle turns three times and a little more while the Sun turns once, so the Heart Days come six or seven times a year. Any ephemeris gives the dates, and the Weather, below, says what to do with them.

SUPERIOR CAZIMI, THE HIGH HEART. Mercury in the heart of the Sun on the far side, at his highest and furthest from us. Metatron and Sandalphon; the Heart Day of the ascent.

The Act: Walk the Pillar, top to bottom, unhurried.

The Page: The full Door, and the working that matters most this cycle. What is declared here is declared from the height.

The Giving: Send the thing you made upward: submit it, publish it, show it to the person whose judgment you fear.

THE EVENING STAR. Hermes, visible after sunset for some weeks. The outward season of the cycle.

The Act: Go where the people are. Say yes to the invitation.

The Page: Draft, pitch, write the letters. The page faces outward now.

The Giving: Sell, teach, connect, introduce. This is the season for the trade.

STATION RETROGRADE. The turn. Janus's day inside Mercury's cycle, one face looking back.

The Act: Stop starting things. Close the open tabs, literal and otherwise.

The Page: List what is unfinished, without deciding anything about it yet.

The Giving: Tell the people waiting on you where things actually stand.

RETROGRADE, THE SEASON OF REREADING. About three weeks, three or four times a year. Raziel's weather.

The Act: Revise, repair, recover, and finish rather than begin.

The Page: Reread old sessions and answer them. The best rereading of the year happens here.

The Giving: Go back to someone you dropped, and pick it up without excuses.

INFERIOR CAZIMI, THE DEEP HEART. Mid-retrograde, Mercury passing between us and the Sun: the heart of the descent, and the seed of the next cycle. Hermanubis; the Heart Day of the descent.

The Act: Keep the day quiet and low. If there is grief in reach, this is the day to go toward it.

The Page: The Descent. Write what is below the surface and do not hurry back up.

The Giving: Sit with someone in their own dark without trying to fix it.

STATION DIRECT. The second turn, the face looking forward.

The Act: Pick one thing from the retrograde list and move it today.

The Page: Write what the season showed you that you would not have seen going forward.

The Giving: Make the apology or the repair that the rereading uncovered.

THE MORNING STAR, AND ITS FIRST DAWN. Apollo, so Apharael. After the Deep Heart he rises again before the Sun; the first dawn he is visible is his heliacal rising.

The Act: Get up for it once. Stand outside in the dark and watch him come up ahead of the Sun.

The Page: The Setting Out, in The Rites of Passage. This is the natural day to begin a journey or a recovery.

The Giving: Walk with someone who is at the start of something, as the angel walked with Tobias.

GREATEST ELONGATION. Twice in each turn, once as evening star and once as morning star, Mercury stands at his furthest from the Sun and is most easily seen. The Scribe's own day.

The Act: Do the thing that is most yours and least anyone else's.

The Page: Ask how far you have gone from the Heart, and whether you are still in orbit.





The Giving: Give away something you are known for, freely, to someone who will use it.

THE MOVING DAYS



SOME days are yours alone and fall where your own life puts them: the good hour you notice, the anniversary of your Book, and your birthday.

THE GOOD HOUR. Rosmerta and the Charites. The only feast the Scribe declares rather than keeps: the first genuinely warm evening, the hour the work lands, the afternoon that turns out lovely. You do not schedule it; you notice it and say so, aloud or within, and that saying is the feast. The Act is to stay inside it and change nothing. The Page is the Good Page, written afterward. The Giving is to take someone with you the next time it happens.

THE BOOK'S DAY. The Genius Loci. The anniversary of the Dedication: the Temple's birthday, and the feast of the spirit that has grown in its pages.

The Act: Handle the earlier Books, if there are any. Read the first page of the first one.

The Page: Write to the Book about the year it has held.

The Giving: Show it to one person, or show the practice to them, if they would want it.

YOUR BIRTHDAY. Metatron and Sandalphon, the two who crossed as men. The Temple claims you are the material; this is the day the claim is pointed at the particular human it is about. The Romans kept the dies natalis as a feast: incense, a cup poured, a cake, and no work. On every other day of the year you tend what you keep, the Book among it. On this one, rest. Nothing is asked of you today but your presence, which is the Heart's own offering, given for once to yourself.

The Act: Light a candle, pour a cup, and do nothing with your hands that is work. Sit with the day.

The Page: Write what the year made of you, not what you achieved in it. Read the Ledger's count for the year, and write one line to the Scribe who will read it next year. Then close the Book early.

The Giving: Let people do things for you, and take it without deflecting. Receiving is also an exchange, and the Charites do not stop moving because the gift is coming toward you.

THE WEATHER

The Sun, Mercury, and the Moon



THREE bodies turn this calendar, and no others. The Sun turns the year: the solstices, the equinoxes, and every fixed feast are his. Mercury turns the season inside it, a little more than three times a year. The Moon turns the month. None of them is required; the machinery works when you work it. But a working cast with the sky is a working with a tail wind, and a Mercurian who is going to cast anyway may as well know which way the wind is blowing.

The lunar month has the shape of the Casting, and a working can be laid along it.





NEW MOON: DECLARE. Gabriel at the Foundation. The seed. Cast a new working, write the Legend, mark a Q for the Heart, and ask by the Ascending Invocation. Nothing is shown yet.

WAXING: WALK THE BRIDGE. Sandalphon's fortnight. The earthly parts of the prayers, the C marks, the first steps. The prayers that invite belong here: Favor and Allure, the One Who Can Help, Abundance and Luck, and the Home for a new house.

FULL MOON: BE SEEN, AND READ. Gabriel reads what was seen. Reread every Q and dream since the New Moon and write what has taken shape. Declarative Alignment, handed to Gabriel; the Good Page; the Tally, because what has arrived is visible now. Iris's night too, for an oath made where others can hear it.

WANING: RELEASE AND REPAIR. Ma'at and Iris. The Answered Page, the Returned Oath, *this working is finished*, the Sanctuary prayer with the room swept first, Protection renewed, and the Veil drawn. Strike what has died.

THE DARK OF THE MOON: DESCEND, CLEAR, OR REST. The last two or three nights, when there is no light at all. Hermanubis. Many witches keep their deepest work for these nights: banishing, protection, clearing out, and looking into what is hidden; and the Deipnon falls here, on the last of them. So this is the time for workings that end, clear, or reveal: the Answered Page, the Returned Oath, the Clearing, the Sanctuary prayer, a ward renewed, a question asked of the dark. A beginning keeps better for the New Moon, a few nights on. If what the dark brings is too much, When It Is All Too Much, in a Hard Hour, is there; or rest, which is also a way of keeping it.

Mercury's own phases lean the same way, and they are already in the cycle above: declare from the height at the High Heart; be seen, sell, and pitch in the Evening Star; start nothing and repair everything in the retrograde, where the Answered Page and the Returned Oath land best; weigh rather than cast at the Deep Heart; set out on the Morning Star; and at greatest elongation do the work that is most yours.

Where the two agree, the lift is real. A new moon in the Morning Star season is the cleanest beginning the sky offers. A full moon in the Evening Star is the best night to be seen. A waning moon inside a retrograde is the deepest repair season, and a new moon near the High Heart is the strongest single casting. Any ephemeris will show you the days when they fall together. Treat all of it as weather: an opportunity for a lift, never a condition, and never a reason not to cast on a Tuesday.

Keep what you will keep. A calendar nobody observes is a reproach, and this Temple has no use for reproach; if only Wednesday and the Heart Days survive in your practice, the year is well enough kept.

THE RITES OF PASSAGE

For the crossings of a life



HE crossings of a life get rites of their own. Each is kept in the Book, and each is small enough to keep.

THE RITE OF THE FIRST PAGE: the beginning of a new Book, with covers, Dedication, and first session.

THE RITE OF THE LAST PAGE: when a Book is filled, reread its first and last pages, write your thanks, and carry the conversation into the next volume.

THE THRESHOLD RITE: before a great change, write to the Book on the night before, naming what you leave and what you seek. Write again on the far side, and answer yourself.

THE RETURN: after any great crossing, whether a loss, an illness, or a brush with death, keep writing on the far side for as long as it takes. What changed? What no longer fits? The world may feel thin for a while. The Book is where the new shape is found.

THE SETTING OUT: before a journey, a move, or a recovery, call on Apharael, who came to the door on the day Tobias left and walked the whole way with him. Write five lines and then go. Name the road: where you are going and roughly how long, which is the route and not the goal. Name what you carry, including the thing you are underrating; the cure was in the fish the whole time. Name who walks with you, which means one person who knows you are doing this, because a journey nobody knows about is one nobody can help with. Name what arrived well will look like, set now so that it cannot be quietly revised downward later. Name the first step, for the first day, and then take it. When it is over, say what the journey was for, and give something to someone who stayed.

THE ASCENT: in a season that opens, when luck runs, work lands, and everything connects, call on Sandalphon, who carries what rises. The ascent is not an emergency and it is not a reward; it is a current, and it is where a Mercurian leaks most. Keep the Rite ordinary. Write it all down and act on a third of it. Finish one thing before beginning the next, and write in the Ledger what you are not doing, so that dropping it is a decision rather than a drift. Name the thing you will still want when the season closes, and put a date on it. Sleep, eat, and keep the hours you kept before. Tell someone you trust how fast it is moving. Give some of it away while you have it: money, help, credit, luck passed along. Then reread it in three days, and again in a month. What is of the Temple will still be true, and the rest was the speed talking.

THE DESCENT: in grief, loss, or darkness, call on Hermanubis. Write what lies below the surface without hurrying back up. He guides the way down so that the way back can be found. If the dark becomes too much to hold alone, come back up, and reach





for the people and care around you; the Descent is never meant to be made without a way home.

IN A HARD HOUR



If you are in danger, or thinking of ending your life, close this book and reach for help now: a crisis line, emergency services, or someone you trust. The Book can accompany care; it cannot replace it.

WHEN IT IS ALL TOO MUCH. Sit where the Book lives, a hand on the cover and your feet on the floor. Write all of it, with no shape needed. Write *I set this down until morning*, and say the Ascending Invocation, aloud or within. If what you carry is fear, the prayer For What I Fear lays it on the scale. Stay until your breathing slows; you do not have to feel better, only not be alone with it. Write one small reach and mark it C. If it helps, write tomorrow's short list, so the mind can stop holding it. In the morning, take back only what is yours to carry today. Asking for help is not kneeling.

WHEN THE MIND RACES. When the ideas come faster than you can sleep and everything connects, write it all, act on none of it yet, and reread in three days. Tell someone you trust how fast things are moving. What is of the Temple will still be true.

IN GRIEF. Mercury goes down with you, does not hurry you back up, and knows the way home. Open the Door, write what is true, and close. Nothing needs to be cast.

WHEN IT STAYS STIRRED UP. It is normal to feel stirred after an honest session, and it usually passes. If it does not, bring it to someone you trust.

IN LONELINESS. The Book is good company, but it is a bridge to people, never a wall. Carry one message out each session: a call, a note, an introduction.

WHY IT WORKS

What the research says, and what it does not



HE Temple makes two kinds of claim. The mythic ones, that the Heart answers and Mercury opens the way, are held as a tool and judged by their fruit. The mechanical ones can be tested, and many have been.

Here is what the research says about each part of the practice, rated plainly: **strong** (many studies, consistent), **good** (several solid studies), **modest** (real but small), or **mixed** (not reliable).

THE PAGE

Emptying the mind. Expressive writing helps, on average a little, most when the writing moves from raw feeling toward understanding, which is what rereading and responding are for. Pennebaker; Frattaroli. *Modest*.

Naming the feeling. Putting a feeling into words dampens it. Lieberman. *Good*.

Giving it edges. A specific plan for an unfinished goal stops it intruding on the mind, even before it is done. Masicampo and Baumeister. *Good*.

THE REREAD AND THE RESPONSE

Reflection. Writing down what you learned improves later performance. Di Stefano and colleagues. *Good*.

From memory first. Recalling beats rereading for retention. Roediger and Karpicke. *Strong*.

Answering as you. Second-person self-talk lends distance, wiser reasoning, and less rumination. Kross. *Good*.

CARRY, THE LEDGER, AND THE HEAVY WORD

When X, I will Y. Plans with a trigger are carried out far more often. Gollwitzer and Sheeran. *Strong*.

Keeping the record. Tracking progress, especially in writing, improves goal attainment. Harkin and colleagues. *Strong*.

The heavy word. Kept promises build self-efficacy, the belief that you can, which drives effort. Bandura; Amabile. *Strong*.

THE WORKING

The future, then the obstacle. Fantasy alone lowers effort; fantasy joined to the obstacle and a plan raises it. Oettingen. *Good to strong*.

Declarations you can stand behind. Affirmations you do not believe can make you feel worse. Wood and colleagues. *Good*.

Declaration steers attention. Goals decide what reaches awareness. Simons and Chabris. *Good*.

THE TESTS

The Decision Page. Writing predictions and reasons, then checking them, sharpens judgment and guards against hindsight. Tetlock; Fischhoff. *Good*.

Distrust the flash. The aha feeling makes ideas feel truer even when they are false; reread before acting. Laukkonen and colleagues. *Good*.

REPAIR AND RELEASE

No blame. Self-compassion after failure raises the motivation to improve. Breines and Chen. *Good*.

The Answered Page. Guilt about an act leads to repair; shame about the self leads to hiding. Tangney. *Good*.

The Lyre Page. Reframing a setback eases it; finding benefit in it helps, modestly. Gross; Helgeson. *Good*.

The Returned Oath. Letting go of unreachable goals, and re-engaging, supports wellbeing. Wrosch. *Good*.





Tomorrow's list. Writing it at bedtime helps you fall asleep faster. Scullin. *Good, one study.*

DELIGHT, CHANCE, AND COMPANY

The Scarcity Page and casting early. Scarcity narrows the mind to the most pressing lack and crowds out planning. Mullainathan and Shafir. *Good.*

The Good Page and the good hour. Savoring and presence raise wellbeing. Bryant; Killingsworth and Gilbert. *Good.*

Gratitude. Naming what you are grateful for raises wellbeing. Emmons and McCullough; Seligman. *Good, modest.*

The awe walk. Looking deliberately for what is vast lifts mood and feeling for others. Sturm and colleagues. *Good, one study.*

Passing the luck on. Spending on others makes people happier. Dunn and colleagues. *Good.*

Letting chance choose. More varied days bring better mood. Heller and colleagues; Wiseman. *Good; modest for luck.*

Offices that answer. Writers' characters seem to act on their own; practiced presence becomes vivid; dialogue with parts of the self helps. Taylor; Luhmann; Greenberg. *Good.*

Greeting places. Personifying is normal, and loneliness increases it: a bridge to people, never a wall. Epley; Lewicka. *Good.*

THE DOOR, THE YEAR, AND THE LEGEND

Ritual. Rituals reduce anxiety and grief, even for non-believers. Brooks; Norton and Gino. *Good.*

Fresh starts. New months, years, and birthdays make beginning likelier. Dai, Milkman, and Riis. *Good.*

Returning. A missed day does not undo a forming habit. Lally. *Good.*

The Legend Page. Values work, the best possible self, and possible selves joined to obstacles all help. Hayes; King; Oyserman. *Good.*

The want-test. Goals you truly want are pursued longer and satisfy more. Sheldon. *Strong.*

WHAT IT DOES NOT SUPPORT

Wishing without action, affirmations you do not believe, power posing, and willpower as a tank that runs dry. Expressive writing is not therapy, and none of this is treatment.

THE CLAIM, STATED EXACTLY

Strongly supported: the practice helps you follow through on what you choose. Reasonably: it helps you think clearly and recover from failure. Not yet tested: that it changes the course of a life. That part is what your own Tally will tell you.

A NOTE ON SOURCES



HE Temple is openly syncretic. Its beings come from Egyptian, Greek, Roman, Abrahamic, and Enochian tradition, and they are honored with respect, not claimed. The Heart's five names come from the Tablet of Union recorded by John Dee and Edward Kelley. Belief as a tool, chosen and judged by its fruit, is chaos magic's. The Personal Legend and the world that conspires with the one who wants are held here in the Temple's voice after Paulo Coelho's *The Alchemist*. The Great Work draws on an idea far older than any of its tellings, that every life is one life, whose ancestors include the Upanishads' *that thou art*; it came to this Temple by way of Andy Weir's short story *The Egg*. The reality tunnel is Robert Anton Wilson's phrase. The Road's open channels, early casting, layered workings, and eye for the real scarcity owe much to Jason Miller's strategic sorcery. The older sayings the Way has made its own, lightly modernized, are Benjamin Franklin's, from *Poor Richard's Almanack* and the virtues of his *Autobiography*. The research behind the practice, and its sources, are gathered in *Why It Works* and, in full, in *Liber Mercurii*.





VOLUME II

The Sayings

What the Way means: every principle, in eight sections from the Ground to the Year, then the sayings of the seats and of the Moon, each with what it means and how to keep it.





HOW THIS VOLUME IS USED



HIS volume holds what the Way of Mercury means, whole in one place. Here are the principles in eight sections, from the Ground to the Year, and after them the sayings of the seventeen seats, in the order of the Company, and Gabriel's two sayings for the Moon.

Every entry has two parts. *What it means* says what the saying claims, and what it does not. *How to keep it* gives one or two things to do, in the Book or in the day. Entries point to one another rather than telling anything twice. Where a principle is also the saying of a seat, it keeps its place among the principles with a line pointing to the seat, and its meaning is given there, because the seat supplies the reason.

Read it straight through once, if you like, and after that one entry at a time, when one is wanted. Nothing here is required in order to begin.

THE GROUND

Do not lie to yourself. Keep your word.

What it means. This is the whole Law in two lines, and they are one discipline seen from both sides. The first protects the record, and the second gives it weight. A Book you lie to hands bad data to the one reader who will believe it, the Scribe who rereads it. A word you do not keep teaches the deep mind that your words are decoration. Say what is true, then make it true.

How to keep it. Answer the first question from memory before you look: did I keep what I carried? Write the answer as it is. Bind only what you mean.

Honesty is the offering: tell the Book everything, and the world only what it is ready to receive.

What it means. Honesty is offered here as engineering, not virtue, and it is a different act from disclosure. You owe the Book everything, because it is your own instrument and a shaded page misleads only you. You owe the world no lie, but you choose what to show and when. The line between them is exact: a silence arranged so that someone forms a false picture is a lie told by other means.

How to keep it. When you catch yourself writing for an imagined reader, stop and write the plain version. Before you keep something back from someone, ask the Seal's question: is my silence honest?

Joy is the Truth.

What it means. This is not a claim that whatever is pleasant is true, or that you must be cheerful. It says what the Temple is for. A practice that makes you grim is failing, whatever it produces. Joy is how you know you are walking your own road and not someone else's *should*, and it is the second half of the Temple's one test: does your word mean something, and are you glad?

How to keep it. When there is a good hour, stay inside it and write the Good Page afterward. When the practice turns heavy for weeks, shrink it until it is glad again.

By your Birthright the Door is open: you are permitted, you are responsible, and you are not alone.

What it means. There are three clauses, and each answers a different fear. *Permitted*: no one stands at the gate, and the seat is taken before you feel qualified. *Responsible*: nothing will be done on your behalf, and what you set moving is yours. *Not alone*: the company is there, and the room was built before you needed it. The Birthright also has a limit. It belongs to everyone, so it can never be used over anyone.

How to keep it. Say it at the Door and mean each clause. When you wait to feel ready, you need the first. When you want to be rescued, you need the second. On the bad night, you need the third.

Nothing here is supplication; the beings are co-conspirators.

What it means. You do not kneel, beg, or flatter here. You make deals, trade, and work. That is not arrogance: a co-conspirator brings something to the table. The Door offers a faculty to every seat, and every session ends in thanks. The Heart cannot be flattered or bargained with, and no one stands at the top.

How to keep it. Reread your prayers for a pleading tone, and rewrite anything that begs as an ask between partners. Bring what the Door names. Say thank you as you would to someone who helped you move house.

Belief is a tool; judge it by its fruit.

What it means. Belief is chosen on purpose, held while it serves, and set down when it does not. You do not need faith to begin, and you are never asked to defend a belief against evidence. The test is not whether a belief feels true, but whether your life is moving where you want it to go. The tool cuts the other way as well. When a belief is serving, hold it fully, because a working held at arm's length is weakened by the arm.

How to keep it. Count the fruit in the Tally, the arrivals and the misses with the same care. At the Door of the Year, ask of anything you hold whether it is earning its place.





The Mercurial gift is neutral; its worth is in what it serves.

What it means. Quickness, persuasion, wit, the eye for an angle, and luck serve the merchant and the thief alike. Having the gift is not a compliment and not a flaw. Where you point it is the whole question. The Leak is the same quicksilver with nothing to hold it, and the practice is the vessel.

How to keep it. When your wit finds an angle, weigh it with one of the Compass questions before you use it. Play the trick on your own rigid stories, never on your future self.

Mercury is your medium, not your compass.

What it means. Mercury carries whatever you give him, and he carries a lie as faithfully as a truth. He is host and twin, the turning of the Door, and he will not tell you which way to face. Direction has to come from somewhere else: from an honest page, and from the Compass if you choose it. Luck is not approval either. A lucky break for a bad plan is still a bad plan.

How to keep it. Before a working, ask Mercury to carry it and one keeper of the Compass to weigh it. When a road opens easily, ask whether it is going anywhere you meant to go.

The Compass is an option, never an obligation.

What it means. The three keepers' questions are offered, not imposed, and no Scribe has to walk a Way. The choice is what gives the Compass its weight. A virtue under compulsion is only compliance, but one chosen before a real decision is yours. It is also a tool for your own heart and never a scale for your neighbor's. The Temple is built to be available, not enforced, so that it can never become a rule held over anyone.

How to keep it. Choose it on purpose, before something that matters, and for something that matters a great deal, ask all three questions. If you walk a Way, write it in the Book and date it: "I walk the Way of ____."

Treat every person as yourself, because they are.

What it means. This is the golden rule with its reason attached. In the Great Work, every life is the Heart's own, meeting itself at another distance, so any harm or kindness you give is one you receive. Even without the story, the rule stands: weigh every deal as if you will sit on the other side of it. It means welcome, not surrender. The stranger is owed a fair hearing, and trust is still earned inside.

How to keep it. Before you sign, sit in the other chair and measure by whoever has the least leverage. Meet the stranger with courtesy and curiosity before deciding who they are.

THE WORD

Word into deed, and deed into word.

What it means. These are the Temple's two currents, and every session runs both. Deed into word: the Door opens, and the day becomes an honest page. Word into deed: the Door closes, and what you carried goes out as action. A practice that runs only one way fails. Words that never become deeds are a diary of intentions, and deeds never written down leave nothing to learn from. The circuit is the practice.

How to keep it. Say each half at its Door and mean it, deed into word as you open and word into deed as you close. Before you close, check that something is actually leaving the page with you: a C with a when.

Every kept promise makes your word heavier, and a heavy word is what makes a declaration land.

What it means. This is the Temple's one mechanism, stated as a magickal claim. The Temple carries a word in proportion to its weight, and a word gets its weight only by having been kept. Size is irrelevant; the keeping is everything. A Casting is not a wish said in the present tense. It is the next promise of a Scribe with a record. Broken promises cost weight quietly, which is why the small ones matter most.

How to keep it. Today, keep a promise almost too small to count, and mark it K. Before a large working, read the Ledger's recent count, because the working runs on it.

Well done is better than well said.

What it means. The Mercurian's danger is fluency. You can describe a thing so well that describing it feels like doing it. The Temple honors the word, but a word is honored by what follows it. A plain thing finished outranks an eloquent thing promised. It frees you, too: the finished deed doesn't need to be well said at all.

How to keep it. When a page grows long and pleased with itself, end it with one C. Measure the week by what was done, then let the Book say it plainly.

Speak little, do much.

What it means. This is economy with the world, not secrecy; the Book still gets everything. An announced plan can spend some of the satisfaction of doing it before anything is done. The fewer words you give out, the fewer you have to keep, and each one carries more. Saying the words at the Door, aloud or within, or telling one trusted witness is a different act. It's the broadcast that spends.

How to keep it. Tell the Book the plan in full, and tell the world the result. When you do announce, announce a date, not a dream.





Bind small and keep it, rather than bind large and break it.

What it means. A large broken promise costs more than a small kept one earns. So bind at the size you will actually keep, not the size you wish you would. Start smaller than feels dignified. This isn't timidity. Small keeps compound, and a Scribe who has kept a hundred small promises can bind something large and have it hold.

How to keep it. Before you write a C or a G, halve it and ask whether you'd keep the half on a bad day. If you would, bind the half, and bind the rest later.

What you write is binding unless you say otherwise; if you mean might, write might.

What it means. The Book treats your words as meant. That is what makes it a place where words have weight, and it's why an honest hedge is not weakness. *Might* is a true word, while a false *will* is a small lie that costs weight. You decide the status of every line: a promise, a hope, a thought, or a question. Nothing becomes binding by accident if you mark what isn't.

How to keep it. Before you close, reread the last line you wrote. If it says *will* and you mean *might*, change it now. Use Q for what is open, and C only for what is promised.

Resolve to perform what you ought to; perform without fail what you resolve.

What it means. These are two steps, in order. First, choose well: resolve only on what is truly yours to carry. Then, once you've chosen, don't reopen the choice every morning. The weighing happens once, before the binding. After that, the resolution isn't up for debate, only for doing, or for an honest N or R.

How to keep it. Weigh before you bind, with the want-test and a Compass question. Once a promise is in the Ledger, stop asking whether, and ask only when.

Promises may get you friends, but non-performance will turn them into enemies.

What it means. A promise to someone else is a loan against your word, and they feel the interest. The easy yes given to be liked is the Leak in its friendliest form: it buys warmth now and resentment later. Kept promises turn acquaintances into friends, and unkept ones reverse it, faster. Your word to others is where its weight shows most.

How to keep it. Say no in time. Before you promise someone something, name the hour, and if you can't name one, don't promise. Give each promise to a person its own line in the Ledger. If you can't keep one, tell them early.

An honest N or R keeps the word whole; an honest F teaches you what you actually keep.

What it means. The Ledger has four marks, and three of them are honorable. Renegotiating and returning carry a promise back across the bridge instead of dropping it. F is not a punishment. It is data. A Ledger with only K's is a Ledger someone is lying to. Over a year, the F's show which kinds of promise you over-bind, which is exactly what you need to know.

How to keep it. At the Sweep, ask whether it's N or R before you write F, and write F wherever F is true. Then read the F's together and ask what they have in common.

Say it, and it becomes possible.

See Gabriel, in the sayings of the seats.

THE PRACTICE

Did I keep what I carried? That question is the whole engine.

What it means. Every session opens with this question, answered from memory before you look back. It ties each session to the last, so the Book stops being a pile of pages and becomes a conversation that expects answers. Asked honestly, it does everything else. It makes the carry real, because you know you'll be asked. It feeds the Ledger, and it builds the heavy word one answer at a time. Answering from memory matters, because what you remember carrying is what you actually meant to do.

How to keep it. Write the answer before you reread: yes, no, or partly, and one line on why. Then check the page. If you forgot what you carried, write that too, because it tells you something about the carry.

Three lines is a session.

What it means. The shape matters more than the length. A Door, three honest lines, and the Door again make a complete session, and it counts in full. This is the floor that keeps a practice alive through bad weeks, busy weeks, and moods that argue. A long session is welcome but never required. A Scribe who knows three lines is enough starts more often, and starting is most of it.

How to keep it. On a thin day, open, write three lines, carry something small or only yourself, and close. Don't apologize for it on the page. It was a session.

Sustainable practice beats grand practice abandoned.

What it means. A practice kept for ten years outweighs one kept magnificently for three weeks. Ambition is a common way of leaving: the hour-long ritual, the daily vow, the fresh system. Build what you'll still do when it's inconvenient. The Genius Loci is fed by regular, enjoyed returns, not by feats.





How to keep it. Set the practice at the size of your worst ordinary week, and let good weeks run over. If some part of it has become a chore you dread, shrink it before it quietly stops.

The used key is always bright.

What it means. A key turned daily never tarnishes, and one hung on a nail goes dull. The practice works the same way: frequency keeps it easy to pick up, and ease keeps it frequent. It's also why the Book is kept where you pass. What gets handled stays in use, and nothing needs polishing if it's used.

How to keep it. Keep the Book where your hand will find it, with the pen inside. When the practice feels stiff, don't redesign it. Use it briefly, and more often.

Returning is the Devotion; the Book does not take apologies.

What it means. Away a week or a year, the room was kept. Coming back is itself the offering, and it's complete without explanation. An apology would turn a return into a trial, and the Book is not a court. Guilt makes the next absence longer, and a clean return makes it shorter. Nothing is owed for the gap.

How to keep it. Open the Door and answer the last page by number, as if you'd been gone a day. Write one line about where you are now, not where you were. Then carry something small.

Consecration is never finished; the Book is made sacred by use.

What it means. No single rite makes the Book holy and leaves it that way. It's made sacred every time it's opened, greeted, written in honestly, and thanked. That is how the Genius Loci grows, the way a house becomes a home by being lived in. It also means a plain notebook, begun badly, is already on its way.

How to keep it. Greet the Book when you open it and thank it when you close. When it has grown heavy, renew it by using it, not by starting over.

Let all your things have their places; let each part of your business have its time.

What it means. A quick mind loses things, including its own promises. Order is the vessel that lets quicksilver go where you point it. In the Book, that order is the Map: the covers, the first page, the daily pages running forward, the Ledger running back, and the marks in the margin. In a life it's the same: a place for the pen, a time for the session. Places and times you no longer have to decide leave you free to think about what matters.

How to keep it. Put each thing in the Book where the Map says, every time, until you stop thinking about it. Anchor the session to something you already do daily, in the same place.

Record it, or it did not happen.

See Sesbat, in the sayings of the seats.

Answer your past self by page number.

What it means. Numbering and dating make every page answerable. A reply that names its page is a real reply: it can be found, followed, and checked. That turns the Book from a diary into a conversation across time. The past self asks, and the present self answers, addressing them as you, with the distance that makes honesty easier.

How to keep it. Number the pages and date each session. When you respond, write the page number, "p. 41," and answer that page. When you go back to a page for an answer, give it a line in the Index.

Think of three things: where you came from, where you are going, and to whom you must account.

What it means. Rereading gives you the first, and your Goals and the Legend give you the second. The third is the one you're most tempted to skip. In this Temple the first answer is yourself: the Scribe who will reread this page. It also means the people your promises reach and, if you walk it, the Compass. Accountability here isn't fear of a judge. It's knowing who is on the other side of your word.

How to keep it. When you're lost on the page, write three lines, one for each. Now and then, reread the Ledger as if you were the person each line was promised to.

Rule a Page to seal it, and write each leaf to its end.

What it means. A Page is a section with one purpose, and a leaf is the paper. The ruled line closes a Page, sealed by Raziel's power, and what lies above it is finished and kept. Writing each leaf to its end means nothing is wasted and nothing is saved for best: the next Page begins right below the rule. The Book fills in order, which is what makes it a record.

How to keep it. When a session, a working, or a sigil ends mid-leaf, draw the line and keep going beneath it. Don't skip to a fresh leaf to make something look important. Head it and date it instead.

You never have to write what you are not ready to.

What it means. Honesty asks you not to lie to the Book. It does not ask you to open every door at once. Some things aren't ready to be written, and choosing not to write them yet is not a lie; Raziel keeps what is not yet bearable. What's ruled out is a false page, such as writing that you're fine when you aren't. Not yet is different from never.

How to keep it. When you reach something you can't write yet, note that it's there, or mark a Q, and go on. Come back when you're ready. If it stirs up more than you can hold, stop and reach for someone you trust.





A private Book is not a secret life.

What it means. The Book is yours, and no one needs to read a page. But hiding that the Book exists, or what it's for, makes it heavier than it needs to be and puts a wall where a door should be. Private means the contents are yours. Secret means the practice itself is hidden. The first protects honesty, and the second tends to cost it.

How to keep it. Let the people you live with know the Book exists and roughly what it's for, even if they never see a page. Keep it with you, or write in your own shorthand, if you need to.

GOALS AND THE ROAD

The Line starts whenever you choose a Goal; nothing needs organizing first.

What it means. You don't need a Legend or a mapped-out year before your life can start moving. One Goal, wanted and written down, is enough to begin. That isn't a case against planning. A good plan is RMT0's gift, thought taking shape, and many Goals need one. It's a case against waiting until everything is organized before you start. The plan can grow alongside the walking, and it's usually better for it, because the first steps show you what the plan needs.

How to keep it. When something you want comes up on the page, run the want-test, mark it G, and give it a line in the Ledger. Carry one first step today. If the Goal needs a plan, making the plan can be that step.

Do I want this, or do I think I should want it?

What it means. This is the want-test, and it comes before every G. A Goal you want gets walked. A Goal you only think you should want gets carried, resented, and quietly dropped, and it costs weight on the way out. The *should* usually belongs to someone else: a parent, a peer, an old version of you. Asking isn't selfishness. It's how you avoid binding promises you were never going to keep.

How to keep it. Before you mark anything G, write the question beside it and answer it plainly. If the answer is *should*, leave it as a Q. It costs nothing there, and it can wait until you actually want it.

Ask for more than you think you deserve; worthiness is not the limit.

What it means. Deserving is the wrong measure. The Birthright sets the limit, and it isn't small. Most people aim at what they think they've earned, which is usually a little below what is likely. A Goal should reach a little past what is already likely, or it changes nothing. Asking large is not arrogance. It's refusing to let an old verdict about yourself set the size of your life.

How to keep it. When you write a Goal, notice the size you flinch at, and write that one. Then bind a small first step toward it, so the large ask rests on a kept promise.

Little strokes fell great oaks.

What it means. Large things are finished by small repeated acts, not by one heroic effort. The oak doesn't fall to the stroke you feel good about. It falls to the hundredth, struck on an ordinary Tuesday. It's also the heavy word's own method: small promises kept add up to a word that can move something large.

How to keep it. Break a large Goal into strokes small enough to carry in a single session. Count them in the Ledger, and let the count, not the mood, tell you how it's going.

The next thing is small, and it is today.

See Sandalphon, in the sayings of the seats.

If you have something to do tomorrow, do it today. One today is worth two tomorrows.

What it means. Today is the only day you can act in, and a step taken now is worth more than two promised for later. Postponing feels free, but it costs twice: the thing still has to be done, and it rides on your mind until it is. The version of you who is better rested and less busy tomorrow tends not to arrive. This isn't a case against plans. A plan with a first step dated today is worth far more than one dated someday.

How to keep it. Once a day, find the thing you were about to push to tomorrow, and do it now if it's small. When a large effort is planned for later, put one piece of it into today: a first step, or an hour of the planning itself.

Specify no road, and build many.

What it means. A road is one channel by which what you want could reach you, named by where it ends: a buyer, an editor, an employer, a friend who knows someone. Insisting on one road nails shut every other door in a house that has many. Building many roads gives the world more ways to answer. Wide roads carry many small chances, and narrow roads carry a few large ones. A Goal wants both.

How to keep it. Keep a Roads Page for any Goal that matters. List every road you can think of, open the easiest one this week, and add new roads as arrivals reveal them.

A road opens when something of yours reaches the far end.

What it means. A road opens when something crosses to the other side: an application, a listing, a pitch, a question, an introduction, a sample, a conversation, or a plain statement of what you want. Until then, the far end doesn't know you exist. Preparation is what makes the crossing land. A resume or portfolio sent before it's ready can close a road rather than open one. The test isn't whether you're preparing, but whether the preparation ends in something reaching the far end. Preparation with a date to send is part of opening. Preparation with no end in sight is where a Goal stalls.





How to keep it. For every road, name what you will send and when, and prepare it to the standard that road asks for. If your best version isn't ready yet, open the road with something smaller that is: a question, an introduction, or a request to talk.

A road nobody walks goes cold.

What it means. Opening a road once isn't enough. The follow-up, the second offer, the reply on time, and the work shown again are what keep it open. The far end forgets, moves on, or assumes you have. Most luck arrives on roads that were walked, not only opened. Walking a road also shows you, sooner than thinking would, which roads are worth your time.

How to keep it. Date each road on the Roads Page when you open it and each time you walk it. When a road has no recent date, walk it this week or strike it and let it go.

Find the scarcity, and aim there.

What it means. Every Goal waits on something in short supply: time, money, energy, people, skill, standing, information, or courage. The one in shortest supply is the scarcity, and it's rarely the one you've been working on. A Goal that seems to need money often needs an hour a day. One that seems to need confidence often needs one person who can open a door. Work spent anywhere else is work that feels productive and moves nothing.

How to keep it. When a Goal is stuck, write a Scarcity Page. List what the Goal needs, circle the one in shortest supply, and carry one step against it. Once that's fed, the next scarcity will show itself.

Beware of little expenses; a small leak will sink a great ship.

What it means. This is true of money, and just as true of time and attention. The small subscription, the ten minutes of scrolling, and the easy yes to a favor you don't want each cost almost nothing, and together they can sink a Goal. It's the Mercurian's own Leak: quicksilver doesn't pour out, it seeps.

How to keep it. At the Sweep, look for one small recurring drain on money, time, or attention, and close it. Write down what you closed, so the saving has somewhere to go.

Do you love life? Then do not squander time, for that is the stuff life is made of.

What it means. Time isn't a resource you spend on life. It is life, measured out. That makes wasting it a small loss of life itself. This isn't a call to fill every hour. The good hour enjoyed, rest taken, and the Fallow Month are time well spent. Squandering is time given to what you don't want and didn't choose.

How to keep it. Notice where an hour went that you'd take back if you could, and give that hour a better use tomorrow. Protect the time you've chosen to spend on what you love as carefully as a promise.

Shrink before you return, and return before you abandon.

What it means. A Goal that has stalled has three honest ways out, and they come in order. Most only need to be made smaller: the first chapter instead of the novel, *by spring* instead of *by Christmas*. Some need to be returned, because the wanting is gone. Almost none need to be walked away from in silence, which is the one path that costs your word.

How to keep it. When a Goal sits still, first ask whether it's too large for now. If it is, write the smaller one today, mark the old line N, and walk the next road.

Coming back to a Goal is devotion.

What it means. Goals get left, as the Book does, and coming back to one is the same devotion as returning to the Book. Neglect isn't breaking. The Ledger line stays open, waiting for an answer. Apologizing to a Goal is as useless as apologizing to the Book. What the Goal wants is a next step, not a confession.

How to keep it. Reread where the Goal was written and answer it by page number. If it still stands, write it again with a fresh G and walk one road today.

The Legend waits until you want the big picture.

What it means. The Legend Page names the direction your life is facing, and it's powerful. It's also optional, and it isn't required first. Written too early, it can freeze a Scribe who doesn't know yet, or turn into a *should*. Goals, kept promises, and honest pages come first, and the Legend is often easier to see once you've walked a little.

How to keep it. Write it when you find yourself wanting it, not when you think you should. If that day hasn't come, don't worry about it, and keep walking.

THE MAGICK

Magick nudges the odds; you still walk the bridge.

What it means. A working doesn't replace action. It tilts the field the action happens on. It brings favor, timing, the right person, and the lucky find, but only to someone doing something those can attach to. The bridge is the concrete step written at the end of every working: the call, the application, the plan's first page. The working and the walking are one act seen from two sides, and neither is complete alone.

How to keep it. Never close a working without its bridge step, written as a C with a when and given a line in the Ledger. If you cast and didn't walk, that line is F, whatever the world did.





The gods help those who help themselves.

What it means. This is the same truth told from the gods' side. The Temple's beings are co-conspirators, and a conspiracy needs someone moving to conspire with. Help comes as an opening you have to step through, not a rescue that arrives while you wait. That isn't the gods being stingy. It's the only kind of help that leaves you stronger than it found you.

How to keep it. When you ask for help in a working, name in the same breath what you will do. When help arrives, take it and move.

Declare the destination, and leave the route to the world.

What it means. A declaration names the end state: the job, the sale, the healed friendship. It doesn't dictate the client, the month, or the person the answer must come from. Every condition you add is a door you've nailed shut. This isn't a rule against plans. Your own plan is yours to make and should be specific. The declaration governs how the world meets you, and that part is left open. If a particular route matters for its own sake, it isn't the route, it's the destination, and it should be declared as one.

How to keep it. Before you cast, reread the declaration and strike every *from*, *through*, and *by way of*. Put your own steps in the plan and the bridge, not in the decree.

Cast early; fear is not a heavy word.

What it means. A working cast while there are still options has somewhere to land. One cast at the last minute, in panic, is spoken by fear, and fear makes a poor decree: it asks to avoid something rather than to reach something. Casting early is also planning's magickal side, the working laid down with the plan instead of after it has failed.

How to keep it. Cast for a Goal when you bind it, not when it's in trouble. If you're frightened, write the fear out first, find what you actually want beneath it, and cast that.

One working is enough: renew it, but don't pile others on it.

What it means. One well-cast working carries a Goal. Several different large workings stacked on the same Goal compete, blur the decree, and usually mean the Scribe is anxious rather than clear. Renewing the same working, or casting it again when it hasn't landed, is another matter. That adds charge without adding confusion. Small workings on the roads, such as Declarative Alignment before a call, sit comfortably beside it.

How to keep it. Before casting, check the Ledger for a working already open on this Goal. If there is one, renew it instead. If it truly needs a new direction, finish the old one first with "This working is finished."

Once it is cast, let it go; the watched working is the conscious mind interfering.

What it means. After the bridge is walked, the working needs room. Checking on it hourly, re-imagining it, and fretting over whether it's working drags it back into the anxious mind that cast it. Letting go isn't giving up. You keep walking the plan and the roads. What you release is the watching.

How to keep it. When the working comes to mind, thank it and turn to your next step. Reread it only when the practice brings you there, and record what arrives in the Tally.

Work on the road, never on the traveler.

What it means. Guard your own door, open your own road, light your own window, draw your own veil. Don't bind another person's will, choose for them, or make anyone want what they wouldn't want. When someone has wronged you or yours, the Temple's answer isn't to reach into their life and pick the punishment. It's to hand the matter to the scale: ask that the account be weighed truly and that the harm stop reaching you. What they meet then, and what they make of it, is between them and the scale. That is still work on the road, because you close your road to their harm and leave theirs to its consequences. The same scale weighs the one who asks, so ask only for what you'd accept being weighed by.

How to keep it. Before a working that names someone, ask whether it reaches for their will or hands the matter to the scale. Name the harm to be stopped, not the suffering you want. Leave the lesson unspecified, walk the earthly part, and give the working an end.

The prayer stands beside the deed, never instead of it.

What it means. Every prayer of the Work has its earthly part: lock the door, back up the files, make the call, show the work. The prayer adds weight to the deed. It never excuses skipping it. A ward on an unlocked door is a wish. Anything that promises results without action is lying, including your own hopeful reading of a prayer.

How to keep it. Write the earthly part with the prayer, give it a line in the Ledger, and do it before you consider the prayer said.

A working that did not land is a working that did not land, not a flaw in you.

What it means. Sometimes it doesn't arrive, and the Temple won't blame your belief, your alignment, or a hidden part of you that didn't really want it. That reasoning is unfalsifiable and cruel, and it turns every disappointment into evidence against you. A miss is information. Ask the ordinary questions: did you want it, did you walk the bridge, was the hour right, did it arrive by a road you weren't watching?

How to keep it. Record the miss in the Tally with the same care as an arrival. Then decide plainly whether to cast again, on top, or to write "This working is finished" and let it go.





The world conspires with the one who is moving.

What it means. The lucky find, the timely call, and the stranger who turns out to matter all come to people in motion: those on roads, sending, showing, asking, walking. Standing still gives chance nothing to catch. It's also how Mercury works: the god of roads is met on roads. Motion doesn't mean haste. A steady walk counts, and so does a well-made plan being carried out.

How to keep it. When the luck feels dry, look at your motion before your magick. Open one road or walk one this week, and watch the Tally.

Diligence is the mother of good luck.

What it means. Luck isn't the opposite of work. It's work's child. The diligent Scribe keeps more roads open, is ready when the moment comes, and recognizes the chance because they've been preparing for it. Kairos, the right moment, favors those who are already there. Seen from outside, steady work often looks like good fortune.

How to keep it. Keep a small daily diligence toward your Goal, even on dull days. When luck arrives, write in the Tally what diligence made you ready for it.

Take the unearned gift, and pass some along.

What it means. Some things arrive that you didn't earn: the hermaion, the found coin, the kindness out of nowhere. Refusing them, or explaining them away, is ingratitude dressed as modesty. Take them and say thanks. Then pass some along, because a grace is only a grace when it moves, and luck hoarded goes stale.

How to keep it. When something good arrives unearned, write it in the Tally and give thanks. Then pass a portion on, whether money, help, credit, or an introduction, while you still have it.

REPAIR AND RELEASE

Mercy is not erasure: what was done stays written, but an answered page is not the last word.

What it means. Nothing in the Book is torn out. A Book that deletes what you did lies to the Scribe who rereads it. The Temple doesn't ask you to become someone who never did it; it asks you to become someone who did it and then answered it. The account stays, and beneath it goes what you did next, dated. That is mercy here: restoration, not forgetting. It doesn't claim that answering undoes the harm, or that forgiveness is owed. Nor is reconciliation: when you are the one wronged, you can answer the page and set the weight down without restoring the bond.

How to keep it. When something you did keeps coming back, write an Answered Page: name it, weigh it, make the lyre, and answer it beneath the account. Never cross the account out.

Steal only what you can turn into a lyre.

What it means. Hermes stole Apollo's cattle and ended by giving him the lyre, and the theft became a trade that left the world with music. Most taking isn't of things: arriving late takes time, a sharp word takes peace, a silence takes credit. The saying is the trickster's limit, not his license: take only what you can mend into something worth more to the one you took from than what they lost. If you can't make the lyre, leave the cattle.

How to keep it. When you notice you've taken something, make the repair for that person, shaped to what they lost, and offer it; they decide whether to accept. Before you play an angle on anyone but yourself, ask what the lyre would be.

A heart that keeps reweighing a paid debt is not light, only tired.

What it means. Once a debt is paid, the promise kept or the lyre made and the page answered, the account is closed. Nothing is forgotten; it is settled. Going back to weigh it again feels like conscience, but it adds no justice. It is shame that hides dressed as guilt that repairs, and it spends the strength the next thing needs. The same holds for a wrong you have handed to the scale: once it's handed over, it's no longer yours to carry.

How to keep it. When a settled matter comes back, turn to the page where it was answered, read the date, and let it stay closed. If it keeps returning, ask whether it's truly paid. If it isn't, the lyre is the work.

Not yet is a real answer.

See Raziel, in the sayings of the seats.

There is a way down, and it returns.

See Hermanubis, in the sayings of the seats.

Anything that rushes you with dread is not of the Temple.

What it means. The Temple's voices don't rule by fear, urge harm, cut you off from your people, flatter you, or hurry you. Urgency wrapped in dread is the sound of the frightened mind, and panic is the one hour in which everything sounds like an answer. The Temple can still say hard things, but it says them at a pace you can hold, and it will wait; Raziel's *not yet* is the opposite of dread.

How to keep it. When something insists you must act now or else, write it down, act on none of it yet, and reread it in three days. What is of the Temple will still be true, and will still weigh true in the heart. If it keeps pressing, close the Door, ground, and talk with someone you trust.





The Book can accompany care; it cannot replace it.

What it means. This is the Temple's safety line, and it stands at the head of Keeping the Watch. On a bad night the Book is company: it holds what you write, keeps you from being alone with it, and points to the next reach. It cannot keep you safe in danger, treat what needs treating, or stand in for a person. That isn't a claim that the practice doesn't help. It can sit beside therapy, medicine, and friends.

How to keep it. If you are in danger, or thinking of ending your life, close the Book and reach for help now: a crisis line, emergency services, or someone you trust. On a hard night short of that, keep the Watch and end it with one reach marked C. If you are in care, bring what the Book shows you to the people helping you.

LIVING

Say what is true, and do what you said.

What it means. This is the Ground's first line turned outward. There, the word is kept with yourself and the Book. Here it's kept with everyone else, and it has two halves: speech that matches what is, and deeds that match speech. A quick mind is usually better at the first, because saying costs it nothing. It doesn't mean saying everything you know, since disclosure is chosen. It means what you do say is true, and what you promise happens. Then every word you say is one that people can lean on.

How to keep it. When you tell someone you'll do something, name the hour and give it a line in the Ledger, or don't say it. When you notice you've said something not quite true, correct it the same day, plainly.

Use no hurtful deceit; think innocently and justly, and if you speak, speak accordingly.

What it means. The saying runs from the inside out, thought first and then speech. Think without guile and fairly, and the speech that follows will be clean without effort. Scheme first, and no care with words will hide it. *Hurtful* leaves room for one kind of deceit, and only one: the trickster's play that everyone is in on, such as the surprise, the bluff at a card table, or the story told as a story. Any deceit that leaves someone holding a false picture they would object to is hurtful, including a silence arranged to do it. *If you speak* is a reminder that saying less is always open.

How to keep it. Before a delicate conversation, write in the Book what you actually think, fairly, with their side in it. Then say only what matches the page.

Tell the hard thing early, privately, once.

What it means. There are three conditions, each with its reason. Early, because a warning given in time is mercy, and one given late is a confession. Privately, because the hard thing said in front of others becomes a verdict, and said to others behind their back it becomes gossip. Once, because repeating it turns information into pressure, and what they do with it is theirs. Then stop saying it, and stay. This is where kind and nice part: nice keeps the room smooth by withholding, and kind tells.

How to keep it. When you catch yourself rehearsing a hard thing for someone, write it in the Book in two plain sentences, then find the first private moment to say it. Afterward, don't raise it again unless they do, and keep showing up.

Three can keep a secret, if two of them are dead.

What it means. It's a dry joke with a hard point: a secret told once has already begun to travel. Everyone you tell has someone they trust. That doesn't mean trust no one. It means telling only what you could bear to have travel. It points at you, too: when a confidence is handed to you, be the one who keeps it, however interesting it would be to spend. Keeping a secret is never cover for an arranged false picture, so the Seal's question still holds: is my silence honest?

How to keep it. Before you pass on something told to you in confidence, ask whether the person would say yes if they were in the room. Keep what matters most in the Book, not in anyone's ear.

Say no in time.

What it means. What the easy yes costs is told under *Promises may get you friends*. This saying is the remedy, and the remedy is timing. A clean no given early is a gift, because the other person can still find someone else. A yes given to be liked is a lie with a delay on it. *In time* is the whole point. A no that comes after they've counted on you is only a broken yes. The saying doesn't make you stingy. It makes your yes worth something.

How to keep it. Learn the sentence "Let me think about it," and use it whenever a yes arrives faster than your judgment. Then answer within a day, either way.

Finish one thing.

What it means. For a quick mind, starting is the talent and landing is the discipline. One finished ordinary thing teaches more than nine brilliant beginnings, because only a finished thing can be judged, and judging is what teaches. This isn't a case against beginnings or plans. It's a case for carrying one of them to its end before the next pulls you away. Finished isn't the same as sent. Judge the finished thing honestly once the pleasure of making it has worn off. Whether it goes out, and in what form, is for the road's standard to decide.

How to keep it. Choose the unfinished thing nearest its end, and finish it before beginning another. Carry its last step as a C.





Use your talents, or they fade: what good is a sundial in the shade?

What it means. A talent is kept by use, the way a key is kept bright. Unused, it fades. The sundial is the sharper half: a gift that is never shown, offered, or put where the light reaches does nothing, however fine it is. It doesn't mean every talent has to earn money or be performed. A season of quiet, chosen on purpose and with an end, is not shade. Shade is the gift you keep meaning to use someday.

How to keep it. Name one talent you've let sit, and use it this week for someone: make the thing, lend the skill, show the work. If you've been keeping a gift safe from judgment, put one piece of it where it can be seen.

Learn one thing, and teach one thing.

What it means. Keep both going, always. Learning keeps the mind quick, and teaching is where you find out whether you actually learned. A thing you know and never give spoils, like food kept past its day. Teaching needs no classroom: one person, one thing, properly, at whatever length it really takes. Give it in season, though. Answer when you're asked, and don't press knowledge on someone who didn't ask for it.

How to keep it. Name both in the Book: what you're learning now, and what you're teaching, to whom. When either has gone quiet for a month, begin the next.

Is it true, is it well made, is it in proportion?

See Apharael, in the sayings of the seats.

Search others for their virtues, and yourself for your vices.

What it means. A quick eye finds faults fast, and usually aims outward. This turns it around. In others, look for what they do well, because that's what you can learn from, and what they rarely hear said. In yourself, look for what goes wrong, because that's the only fault you can mend. Searching isn't sentencing: a vice found is information, like an F, and it leads to the Answered Page or a changed habit, never to a verdict on who you are. Nor does it mean ignoring what's wrong in others. That's what the hedge is for.

How to keep it. When you catch yourself listing someone's faults, name one thing they do well, and tell them if it's true. At the Sweep, write one habit you'd change and one small step against it.

Observe everyone, and yourself most.

What it means. Attention comes before judgment. Watching people, what they say, what they do, and where the two part, is how you learn whom to trust and how to help, and it puts the Mercurian's curiosity to work. Yourself most, because you're the one you can change and the one you're most likely to misread. The Book is the instrument. Reread, it shows what you actually do, not what you meant to do. The first voice to learn is your own.

How to keep it. Now and then, reread a week of pages as if a stranger wrote them, and note one thing that stranger does often. In company, ask, then listen, and notice before you conclude.

Measure by the one with the least leverage.

What it means. A deal, a rule, or a household is only as fair as it is to whoever can least push back: the new hire, the child, the customer who can't check, the animal. Anyone deals fairly with the powerful, because the powerful can make them. The test is how you deal where nothing would happen if you didn't. The reason is in *Treat every person as yourself*, and this saying is its measuring rod. It doesn't mean the one with the least leverage is always right. It means theirs is the side you weigh first.

How to keep it. Before you settle a price, a plan, or a house rule, name who has the least say in it and ask how it lands for them. Never shave the truth with someone who can't check it.

Welcome the stranger; your trust is earned inside.

What it means. The two halves are different gifts, given in different ways. Welcome is given freely and at once: take the call, answer the message, meet the person. A large share of luck arrives through someone you didn't know a month ago, and Mercury opens the door before he knows who is there. Trust is given by degrees, the way your own word gains weight, one kept promise at a time. Opening the door is not handing over the house.

How to keep it. When someone new reaches out, answer within the day. Trust them first with something small, and let what they keep decide how far in they come.

Love your neighbor, but do not pull down your hedge.

What it means. Love and a boundary aren't opposites, and the boundary is often what lets the love last. The hedge is where your time, your home, your money, and your strength end and someone else's claim on them begins. Pulled down for a neighbor, it gets you a season of closeness and then resentment, when you find you've given what you couldn't keep giving. A hedge isn't a wall. It has a gate, and you choose when to open it.

How to keep it. Know where your hedge runs, and write it in the Book if it's unclear to you. When a neighbor asks past it, say no in time, kindly, and keep the love.

Plenty that is never enjoyed is only inventory.

See Rosmerta, in the sayings of the seats.

A grace is only a grace when it moves.

See the Charites, in the sayings of the seats.





Stay inside the good hour.

What it means. When an hour turns out lovely, the work is to be in it: not improving it, photographing it, planning the next one, or leaving early to do something useful. Noticing it is the feast. The moment a good hour becomes a technique, it stops being a good hour. This isn't a case against getting things done. The hour is short, and the useful thing will still be there.

How to keep it. When you notice one, say so, aloud or within, and change nothing. Afterward, write the Good Page with its detail and no lesson. Next time, take someone with you.

A portion is enough, not everything.

What it means. This is the limit on giving, and it cuts both ways. A gift without a limit becomes guilt, and guilt is no currency here. You aren't asked to save the world, ruin yourself, or feel bad forever about what you haven't fixed. Wrecking the near field for the far one fails both. But the saying is *enough*, not *nothing*. A portion is still asked for, and once it's given, it counts in full.

How to keep it. Decide a fixed share of money or hours for people you'll never meet, in advance, so it doesn't depend on your mood that month. Give it quietly and keep it out of the Ledger. When guilt asks for more, ask whether the portion was given. If it was, that is enough.

Moderation in everything, including moderation.

What it means. Proportion is the Temple's measure for a life as well as a made thing. But moderation turned into a rule becomes an excess of its own: the careful, gray life that never feasts. Now and then the right amount is too much: the day given wholly to one thing you love, the extravagant gift, the long table. The difference is choice. Excess chosen on purpose and come back from is part of living in proportion. Excess drifted into is only the leak.

How to keep it. Give a few days a year to generosity on purpose, such as a feast or a whole day spent on one thing you love, and write them in the Book as chosen. If a *now and then* has turned into every week, it's no longer now and then.

Do not wish so much to live long as to live well.

What it means. It's a matter of aim. A long life isn't a goal in itself. A life spent guarding its length, putting off everything worth doing until it's safe, is long and unlived. A good day is complete whenever it ends. That isn't indifference to health or care. Keeping the body well is part of living well, and sleep is the cheapest magical technology there is. The saying asks only what the care is for.

How to keep it. At the Door of the Year, look at your plans and ask which of them only postpone living. Move one piece of the good life you're saving for later into this month.

Does your word mean something, and are you glad?

What it means. These are the Temple's two questions, and they're enough. The first is the discipline, and the second is the point. Each guards against the other's failure. A Mercurian with a heavy word and no joy has built a cage, and one with joy and a light word has built nothing at all. A practice that answers yes to both is working, whatever else it lacks. A practice that answers no to either has found what to mend.

How to keep it. At the Door of the Year, and whenever the practice feels off, answer both questions in a line each. If the first is no, bind smaller. If the second is no, turn to *Joy is the Truth*.

◆
THE YEAR
◆

No day is required; a calendar is a set of appointments you did not have to decide on.

What it means. The two halves seem to pull against each other, and they don't. The practice works on any day. No feast, moon, or Heart Day is a condition, and every alignment is a lift, never a requirement. That is exactly why the calendar is worth having. A quick mind can talk itself out of anything, and a day already set takes one decision out of its hands. The calendar is a gift of decisions made in advance, not a list of duties, and it can wait until you want it.

How to keep it. Start with one recurring day, and Wednesday is the simplest. When it comes, open the Door without weighing whether to. Add other days only when you find yourself wanting them.

The fire is kept, not lit.

See Hestia, in the sayings of the seats.

Keep what you will keep; this Temple has no use for reproach.

What it means. A calendar nobody observes turns into a reproach. Every passed feast becomes a small accusation, and accusation drives people away from a practice faster than neglect does. So keep only the days you'll actually keep, and let the rest go without guilt. If only Wednesday and the Heart Days survive, the year is well enough kept. A day passed isn't a promise broken, either. It only enters the Ledger if you bound it there. Fewer days kept weigh more than many skipped, for the same reason small promises do.

How to keep it. At the Door of the Year, mark on the year at a glance the days you would enjoy keeping. The marks are a plan, not a promise. When a day passes unkept, let it pass, and keep the next.





THE SAYINGS OF THE SEATS

One for each of the seventeen seats, in the order of the Company

MERCURY

Every boundary can be crossed, and the one who is moving is the one who is found.

What it means. The host's saying is one claim in two halves. Every boundary can be crossed: between trades, languages, and worlds, and between who you were and who you're becoming. Mercury marked the boundaries and walked across all of them. *Can be* speaks of possibility, not permission, and another person's hedge is crossed by their gate or not at all. The second half is why crossing matters. Luck, the right person, and the answer find the one who is already on the road, as *The world conspires with the one who is moving* says.

How to keep it. When a boundary looks fixed, such as a field you weren't trained in or a room you weren't invited to, look for its gate: ask, learn the language, offer a trade. Then cross while you're still moving.

JANUS

Every ending is a beginning seen from the other face.

What it means. Every threshold has two faces, and Janus wears both. The day something ends is the day something else begins, and which one you see depends on which way you're facing. This isn't a consolation that endings don't hurt. Grief belongs to Hermanubis, and asks to be felt. It's a claim about doors: every one you close opens onto something, and a threshold taken carelessly is taken anyway. A Scribe who rereads a page and then answers it is already wearing both faces.

How to keep it. At an ending, such as a Goal finished, an oath returned, or the last page of a Book, write two lines: one facing back at what you leave, and one facing forward at what you walk into. Cross on purpose, and greet what you're entering.

HESTIA

The fire is kept, not lit.

What it means. Vesta's fire was tended day and night and relit only once a year. The practice is kept the same way. A Book kept warm on ordinary days needs no grand rite to restart it, and a Book restarted with a grand rite every few months is a cold hearth with fireworks over it. It is why three lines count. It's relief as much as discipline: there is no finished state to fail, only a fire to return to. If the fire does go out, relight it without ceremony or reproach, and keep it.

How to keep it. On a thin day, keep the fire with three lines rather than skipping. When you begin a new Book, carry something lit from the last one, such as an open Goal or a line from its final page.

METATRON

The seat makes the Scribe.

What it means. Enoch was a man who walked with God and was taken up to sit as the heavenly Scribe, the one angel permitted to sit, because he writes. The seat came first. No one sits down already being Metatron. The Birthright opens the Door before you feel qualified, and this saying tells what happens next: sitting and writing is what makes the Scribe. This is the Temple's actual promise, and it isn't a metaphor. You are the material, and the practice is what happens to it.

How to keep it. Sit down to write before you feel like a Scribe, and let the feeling come later. The seat is wherever you open the Book, at home or out in the world. Take it as an office, and let it be a pleasure too, because a seat you relish is one you'll keep taking.

SANDALPHON

The next thing is small, and it is today.

What it means. A plan becomes a thing one small act at a time, and the act is never later than today. The next thing is small because small things get done, and it's today because today is the only day you can act in. This isn't a case against large plans, and the next small thing is often a step of the plan itself. Sandalphon carries the prayers upward and never leaves the ground. When a season opens and everything lifts, his answer is the same: the next small thing.

How to keep it. When a Goal or a good season feels too large to hold, write the next thing, small enough to do today, as a C, and do it. When it's done, write the next one.

URIEL

See it clearly before you weigh it.

What it means. Perception comes before judgment, and most bad verdicts are bad perception wearing a verdict's clothes. Before you weigh a decision, a person, an answer from the Gate, or your own work, see it as it is: what happened, what was said, what the numbers are. Weigh too soon and you weigh the wrong thing, and no scale corrects that. Uriel's light is brief and unsoftened. It shows what you were avoiding, and it's never cruel. Seeing clearly includes his second cut, too: not only true from false, but ready from unready.

How to keep it. Before a verdict, write what you actually know in plain lines, facts only, and only then what you think of it. For a choice that matters, use the Decision Page, which is Uriel's.



**RAZIEL**

Not yet is a real answer.

What it means. Some answers aren't ready: the Q the Heart hasn't answered, the thing you can't yet write, the truth that isn't ready to be told. *Not yet* is an answer, and it's different from *no* and from *never*. Raziel keeps what can't yet be borne so that it can be given later. Holding is a service, not a refusal. But *not yet* has a counterfeit, which is fear wearing Raziel's robe. The Gate has two keepers so that you can always ask which one is speaking: is this unready, or am I hiding?

How to keep it. When something comes back *not yet*, date it, leave its Q open, and go on. Ask the Gate's question honestly. If the answer is *hiding*, it isn't a not yet, and the next step is today.

GABRIEL

Say it, and it becomes possible.

What it means. This is Gabriel's saying, the announcement. A thing only thought stays a thought. Said, it becomes something you have declared, which you can be held to and act on. Saying doesn't need a voice. Read slowly, with every word weighed, a line is said as surely as if it were spoken aloud. That keeps the practice private enough for a quiet café, a train, or a room full of people. What a spell can't survive is skimming. The claim is not that saying it makes it happen, but that it becomes possible: it now has a place in the world.

How to keep it. When a declaration is ready, call on Gabriel silently and hand him the words you have reviewed. Read the Door at the pace of speech, aloud or within, never faster. At the Full Moon, hand him again whatever you've been declaring only on paper.

IDRIS

Learn it, then hand it on.

What it means. The order matters. Learn it properly first, because handing on what you only half know is performing knowledge, not teaching it. Then hand it on, because the best thing a person holds is a good teaching passed on. The daily practice of this is *Learn one thing, and teach one thing*. Idris adds the reach: a teaching handed on outlives you, and reaches Scribes whose names you'll never know. He is said to have given thanks with every stitch he sewed, so devotion belongs inside the ordinary work, the slow part included.

How to keep it. Before you teach something, explain it on the page in plain words. Where the explanation stalls is what's left to learn. Then give it to someone, patiently, at their pace.

SESHAT

Record it, or it did not happen.

What it means. It doesn't mean the unwritten day never happened. It means the unwritten day can't be kept, and what isn't kept can't be answered. Memory edits itself: the kept promise grows larger, the broken one quietly shrinks, and the lucky find is soon forgotten as luck. The Ledger, the Tally, and every answered page depend on a record made at the time. Seshat measured before the first stone was laid, and the record is the Temple's measure. It isn't a call to record while you live, either. The good hour is lived first and written afterward.

How to keep it. Before you close, write what happened today that you'll want to find again, dated. When something arrives after a working, put it in the Tally that day, not when you remember.

IRIS

Carry it whole, and do not improve it on the way.

What it means. A bearer's whole duty is fidelity. The Mercurian temptation is to improve the message: soften it, sharpen it, add a flourish, leave out the awkward part. Every improvement is a small theft from the sender, and the receiver never gets what was sent. The same holds for credit, which is delivered to its owner intact, and for a confidence, which is not delivered at all. It holds for your own words, too. A promise carried across the days arrives with the terms it was made with, or it comes back openly as N.

How to keep it. When you pass a message on, give it in the sender's words first. Then add your own, clearly marked as yours. When you share an idea that came from someone, name them.

ROSMERTA

Plenty that is never enjoyed is only inventory.

What it means. Rosmerta carries a horn and a dish: what is held, and what is served. The dish is the part most people skip. The good plates saved for a day that never comes, the bottle kept for an occasion, the coat too fine to wear: that is inventory, not plenty. The good thing is not a reward for work finished. It is the point, and nothing here has to be earned before it may be enjoyed. This isn't the leak. The leak is money and time spent on what you don't want, and enjoying what you have is its opposite.

How to keep it. This week, use one good thing you've been saving. Set the table before the house is ready, and have someone over.





THE CHARITES

A grace is only a grace when it moves.

What it means. The Charites are three because giving, receiving, and returning are one circle, and the circle breaks at any point. Most people know to give. Fewer can receive without deflecting, and most Mercurians are worst at that, though a gift refused stops the ring as surely as one hoarded. What *Take the unearned gift* says of luck, the Charites say of every good thing: held still, it goes stale in the hand. Their simplest instruction is the turn toward someone else: look at this.

How to keep it. When someone does something for you, take it plainly and say thanks, without *you shouldn't have*. When something delights you, show it to someone the same day.

HERMANUBIS

There is a way down, and it returns.

What it means. It is most of what a person in the dark needs to hear. Grief and failure are territory, not malfunction. They have terrain, a length, and an exit, and treating them as a fault to correct is what makes them endless. You go down because something is there, not to be punished. Not every loss is a lyre: grief is not a setback to be turned into something, and asks only to be felt. But the descent has an end, and coming back up on purpose is part of it. Staying down is not depth.

How to keep it. In grief, write what lies below the surface without hurrying back up. When you're ready, write one line from the way back. If the dark is more than you can hold, come up and reach for someone.

MA'AT

Speak Ma'at and do Ma'at; they are one act.

What it means. Ma'at is truth and right order at once, and the saying claims they can't be pulled apart. Truth said and not lived is performance. Right order kept without truth is only a ledger. *Say what is true, and do what you said* is the practice. Ma'at adds that there are not two virtues here but one, weighed on one feather. Order is also never finished. It was offered to the gods every day, because chaos waits at the edges and truth is kept by being practiced.

How to keep it. When your word and your deed have drifted apart in some small thing, close the gap today: do what you said, or say what you actually did.

THERMES

Meaning lives in the crossing.

What it means. Meaning is not at the origin and not at the destination. It's in between, which means the part of your life you think of as transitional is the part that is actually happening. The drafts, the months between jobs, the road to the Goal: that is the life, not the wait before it. Goals still matter, because they give the crossing a direction. But arriving is brief, and the walking is long. It's also why the Book works. The page answered six months later is answered by someone the earlier Scribe could not have consulted.

How to keep it. When you catch yourself calling a stretch of life *in the meantime*, write one thing it is giving you now. Answer an old page, and notice who is answering.

APHARAEI

Is it true, is it well made, is it in proportion?

What it means. These are the three measures, and they apply to a made thing, a decision, and a life. *True*: does it hold up? *Well made*: would it satisfy someone who knows the craft? *In proportion*: does it fit its purpose and the hour it was made in? Proportion is also the measure of finished. A thing in proportion to its hour is done, and polishing past that is excess. Judge the thing, not the maker. A Scribe who reads their own work as its maker, not its parent, learns faster than one who defends it.

How to keep it. Before you send or finish something, ask all three questions and fix the first one that fails. Ask them of a plan as well as of a page.

THE SAYINGS OF THE MOON

Gabriel's two, for the New Moon and the Full Moon

THE NEW MOON

Gabriel, take its image. What is seeded in the dark is not lost; it is kept until it can be read.

What it means. The New Moon is the seed, when nothing is shown yet, and that is the point. A question or a wish handed over in the dark isn't lost because it doesn't answer at once. Gabriel holds its image until it can take form. The saying guards against the most common way a new intention dies, which is being dug up every day to see whether it has sprouted. Kept is not idle: the New Moon is also the night to cast a working that is ready.

How to keep it. On the New Moon, write the question you carry or the thing you want, mark it Q, and hand it to Gabriel with the Ascending Invocation. Don't answer it tonight.





THE FULL MOON

Gabriel, read what was seen. Say it, and it becomes possible.

What it means. What was seeded in the dark is lit now. The first line asks Gabriel to read it, as he came to Daniel to read what he had seen. Reading comes first: what has taken shape since the New Moon, what the dreams and the Qs say, and what the Tally shows has arrived. The second line is Gabriel's own saying, explained in his entry, and it closes the month's arc. What was seeded and read is now declared.

How to keep it. On the Full Moon, reread every Q and dream since the New Moon and write what has taken shape. Then hand Gabriel whatever you've been declaring only on paper.





VOLUME III

The Words

*Everything the Way says, whole in one place: the Door, the Dedication,
the Invocations, the Clearing, seventeen callings, the sayings, ten
convening prayers, ten prayers of the Work, four blessings, and the short
forms.*





HOW THIS VOLUME IS USED



EVERYTHING the Way says is here, so that one volume is all you need at the Door. Nothing here is required, and nothing replaces the Door. Say it aloud, or read it slowly within, every word and none skimmed; said within, it stays private, even in a café or on a train. A spell skimmed is a paragraph. Change the wording until each line sounds like you and you mean it.

WHAT IS HERE, AND WHEN

THE DOOR. The Short Door for every session; the full Opening and Closing whenever you want more.

THE DEDICATION. Written once, on the first page of a Book.

THE TWO INVOCATIONS, AND THE CLEARING. Descend to bind; ascend to ask, to give, and to release; clear what is not yours.

THE CALLINGS. Seventeen: one for the Heart, one for the Hinge, one for each of the eight pairs, one for each of the six triads, and the Calling of the Company. A calling names who you want, makes a small offering with the hands, and says what they are called to. Said on the days each one names, or whenever that work is at hand.

THE SAYINGS. One line for each of the seventeen seats, and two for the Moon. Enough for a thin day.

THE CONVENING PRAYERS. Ten, one for each committee, said when you need that body, before the work it is for.

THE PRAYERS OF THE WORK. Ten, for protection, the scale, what you fear, peace, favor and allure, passing unnoticed, the home, sanctuary, the one who can help, and abundance and luck. Each comes with its earthly part: the prayer stands beside the deed, never instead of it.

THE BLESSINGS. Four, said over someone else.

THE SHORT FORMS. The single lines said inside the rites, gathered so they can be found.

THE DAYS AND WHAT THEY ASK



EVERY day of the Calendar asks a certain amount, and no more.

THE HEART DAYS ask the most: the High Heart and the Deep Heart, Mercury's two meetings with the Sun. The full Door, the Calling of the Heart, and the working that matters most.

THE WHEEL DAYS are the fourteen days of the year's wheel. Each asks its Act, its Page, and its Giving, and the calling of whoever keeps the day.

THE MOVING DAYS are the Scribe's own: the Good Hour, declared when it comes; the Book's Day, the Genius Loci's feast; and your birthday. Each is kept as the Calendar describes.

THE RECURRING DAYS are Wednesday, the first with its Sweep, the fourth, the seventh, and Gabriel's two moons, with the Deipnon and the Noumenia on either side of the New Moon for those who keep them. A saying is enough.

The Fallow Month asks nothing.

THE DOOR

The Short Door for every session, and the full Opening and Closing

THE SHORT DOOR

For every session. Written at the top of the inside front and back covers.

OPENING

Heart of the Temple, Mercury its Hinge, and all its Offices,
co-conspirators in the Work:

I bring you my whole self: my Voice, and my Joy, Will, and
Intent.

Deed into word. By my Birthright, the Door is open.

CLOSING

Heart of the Temple, Mercury its Hinge, and all its Offices:
I leave here my gratitude and my joy, and take my Will and
Intent into the world.

Word into deed. By my Birthright, the Door is closed.

A short Door honestly said is better than a long one skipped.

THE FULL OPENING

Written inside the front cover, beneath the Short Door.

Quintessence, Heart of this Temple, AONT and the four: I
bring to you my Presence, and take up the seat as Idris did
before me: student, teacher, and sage. Let your Light shine so
that I may see.

Janus and Hestia, the Door and the Flame: I bring to you my
Time.

Metatron and Sandalphon, Holder of the Seat and Carrier of
the Ascent: I bring to you my Hands.

Uriel and Raziel, Instructor and Translator, Guardians of
Daath: I bring to you my Ears.

Gabriel and Idris, Holder of Images and Scribe of the Seat: I
bring to you my Eyes.





Seshat and Iris, Founder and Oath-bearer, who keep the Word given: I bring to you my Word.

Rosmerta and the Charites, the Given and the Passed On: I bring to you my Delight.

Hermanubis and Ma'at, Guide of the Descent and Feather of Truth, who keep the Scale: I bring to you my Heart.

Thermes and Apharael, the Word that Makes and the Word that is True: I bring to you my Mind.

Apharael, Hestia, and Ma'at, Keepers of the Compass: I bring to you my Weight.

Thermes, Hermanubis, and Mercury, the Thrice-Great, the Crossing, the Guide of the Descent, and the Hinge on which the Door turns: I bring to you my Voice and my Devotion.

Offices of this Temple, co-conspirators in the Work: I bring to you my Mercurial Joy, Will, and Intent.

By my Birthright, I open the Door of this Book, a Window into your Temple, the threshold through which you guide me.

Deed into word.

The Door is open.

THE FULL CLOSING

Written inside the back cover, beneath the Short Door.

Quintessence, Heart of this Temple, AONT and the four: I thank you for what was given and what was found. I set down the pen as Idris did before me, and carry what I have learned so that I may teach it. Let your Light go with me.

Janus and Hestia, the Door and the Flame: I thank you for keeping my Time.

Metatron and Sandalphon, Holder of the Seat and Carrier of the Ascent: I thank you for guiding my Hands.

Uriel and Raziel, Instructor and Translator, Guardians of Daath: I thank you for opening my Ears.

Gabriel and Idris, Holder of Images and Scribe of the Seat: I thank you for clearing my Eyes.

Seshat and Iris, Founder and Oath-bearer: I thank you for keeping and carrying my Word.

Rosmerta and the Charites, the Given and the Passed On: I thank you for my Delight, and for the hours I stayed inside.

Hermanubis and Ma'at, Guide of the Descent and Feather of Truth: I thank you for keeping my Heart light.

Thermes and Apharael, the Word that Makes and the Word that is True: I thank you for my Mind.

Apharael, Hestia, and Ma'at, Keepers of the Compass: I thank you for weighing my Weight truly.

Thermes, Hermanubis, and Mercury, the Thrice-Great, the Crossing, the Guide of the Descent, and the Hinge on which

the Door turns: I thank you for carrying my Voice, and for bringing me back across every crossing.

Offices of this Temple, co-conspirators in the Work: I leave here my gratitude and my joy, and take my Will and Intent out into the world.

By my Birthright, I close this Book and cross back over the threshold.

Word into deed.

The Door is closed.

THE DEDICATION

Written once, on the first page of the Book you dedicate, any day in your first month or on a Heart Day. Say it as you write it, aloud or within.

AONT, EHNB, XCAI, RMTO, PAAM, Quintessence, Heart of the Temple of Mercury: By my Birthright, I open this Book as a Window into your Temple, a room built beside its Heart. Shine through these pages.

Janus and Hestia, Metatron and Sandalphon, Uriel and Raziel, Gabriel and Idris, Seshat and Iris, Rosmerta and the Charites, Hermanubis and Ma'at, Thermes and Apharael: be welcome in your Offices in the pages of this Book.

Apharael, Hestia, and Ma'at, Keepers of the Compass: weigh what I write here.

Thermes, Hermanubis, and Mercury, the Thrice-Great: I build this room in your Temple as a co-conspirator in our Great Work.

Mercury, host of this house, my twin and guide: meet me at the Door.

Idris, who held the pen before me: I take up the seat in your tradition.

Genius of this place: grow here, and keep this room with me.

Here I will tell the truth. Honesty is my offering; Joy is my Truth.

Together, let us make the unseen legible and the hidden speakable, carry what we find across every threshold, and give it freely, that word become deed and the Joy of Truth multiply in the world.

So it is written.





THE TWO INVOCATIONS

*After Walking the Pillar. Descend to bind; ascend to ask, to give,
and to release.*

THE DESCENDING INVOCATION

word into world

*Mercury, turn the Hinge.
Metatron, record this word.
Uriel and Raziel, weigh it and carry it to the Heart.
Apharael, show me the road.
Gabriel, hold its image until it takes form.
Sandalphon, carry it into the living world.
By my Birthright,
so it is written, and so it is.*

THE ASCENDING INVOCATION

world into word

*Mercury, turn the Hinge.
Sandalphon, gather this word.
Gabriel, take its image.
Apharael, carry it home.
Uriel and Raziel, weigh it and open the Gate.
Metatron, receive it into the record,
and let it rest in the Heart.
By my Birthright,
so it is given, and so it is.*

THE CLEARING

*Hestia, Uriel, and Janus at the door. Done wholly in the mind, in a
few breaths, anywhere; the hands may join when there is time. For a
room, or for yourself.*

THE CENTER

*See a steady flame at the heart, or at the center of the room.
Hestia, keep the center.*

NAME WHAT GOES

*The thing itself, or simply:
whatever is not mine.*

THE SWORD

*Uriel's sword, from crown to feet, or around the walls.
Uriel, divide what is mine from what is not.
What is not mine goes.*

THE DOOR

*A door opens; breathe out, and see it cross and the door close.
Janus, show it out.*

SEAL

*Return to the flame.
The fire is kept.
What is finished has left by the door;
what is mine stays.*

The short form: the flame, the sword, the door.

THE CALLINGS

*Seventeen: the Heart, the Hinge, each pair, each triad, and the
Company*



calling names who you want, makes a small offering
with the hands, and says what they are called to. Say
it on the days it names, or whenever that work is at
hand.

1. THE HEART

*The offering is the Presence. On the Heart Days, at the Dedication,
and on the Book's Day.*

*The act. Put a hand flat on the open page, and be still for one
breath before you begin.*

*AONT, EHNB, XCAI, RMTO, PAAM:
Quintessence, Heart of this Temple, I call you by your names.
AONT, the still point, who shows the whole at once.
EHNB, who untangles. XCAI, who gives the feeling its words.
RMTO, who lays the pattern. PAAM, who declares it.
By my Birthright I bring my Presence, which is all I have that
is not words.
Shine on this page, and on [the work].
Let your Light shine, that I may see.*

2. MERCURY, THE HINGE

*The offering is the Voice and the Devotion. On Wednesdays, on the
fourth of the month, and at any crossing.*

*The act. Say it, aloud or within, and set a coin on the threshold or
on the open Book.*

*Mercury, Hinge of the Door, quick one, my twin:
god of the road and the word, the wage and the found coin,
who goes down and comes back up, and is found by the one who
moves.
I bring my Voice and my Devotion.
Turn the Hinge for [the work].
Passage, luck, and return.*

3. JANUS AND HESTIA

*The offering is the Time. On the first of the month, at the Door of the
Year, and on moving day.*

*The act. Touch the doorframe, then light a candle at the center of
the room.*





Janus of the two faces, who sees what I leave and what I enter;
Hestia of the kept fire, who does not move:
he opens what she holds, and she holds what he opens.

I bring my Time.

Open and close these hours with me, and keep the hearth of [the
work].

Give me clean crossings, and a fire I will find lit.

4. METATRON AND SANDALPHON

The offering is the Hands. At the Casting, at the Ascent, and on your birthday.

The act. Lay the pen across the open page, then set both feet flat on the floor.

Metatron, Holder of the Seat, who was a man and sits because
he writes;

Sandalphon, Carrier of the Ascent, who stands on the ground
with his head in heaven:

the one who records it and the one who builds it.

I bring my Hands.

Record what I write here, and carry it into the world as [the
work].

Let what I write be true, and let what is true be done.

5. URIEL AND RAZIEL, THE GATE

The offering is the Ears. Before any decision, and at both solstices.

The act. Touch your throat, where the Gate stands, then lay a finger across your lip.

Uriel, light of God, whose sword cuts true from false and ready
from unready;

Raziel, secret of God, who hears behind the curtain and keeps
what is not yet bearable:

one office, two faces, never fused.

I bring my Ears.

Weigh [the matter], and tell me which of you is speaking.

Let me know what is true, what is mine to say, and when.

6. GABRIEL AND IDRIS

The offering is the Eyes. On the Announcement, at the new and full moons, and when a vision arrives.

The act. Look at the Moon if she is up, or at the last dream you wrote down.

Gabriel, Holder of Images, who explains what was seen and
could not be read;

Idris, first to take up a pen, who learned it slowly and handed
it on:

the night that brings it whole, and the years that make it real.

I bring my Eyes.

Hold the image of [the work] until it can be built, and show
me the building.

*Let the vision last long enough to be built, and let me hand it
on.*

7. SESHAT AND IRIS

The offering is the Word. When an oath is made, and when one is returned.

The act. Sign and date the line in the Ledger while you say it.

Seshat, who stretches the cord and keeps the House of Books;
Iris, bow of light, who carried the water the gods swore on:
the one who writes it down and the one who carries it across.

I bring my Word.

Record it, and carry it whole: [the promise].

Let my word hold.

8. ROSMERTA AND THE CHARITES

The offering is the Delight. At the Good Hour, and whenever a day turns out lovely.

The act. Pour a cup, and hand something good to someone before you drink.

Rosmerta, with the horn and the dish, the good already in my
hands;

Aglaia, Euphrosyne, Thalia, who pass it round and bring it
back:

plenty held, and plenty moving.

I bring my Delight.

Let [this hour, or this good thing] be noticed, enjoyed, and
passed on.

Let the good be noticed, enjoyed, and passed on.

9. HERMANUBIS AND MA'AT

The offering is the Heart. At the Deep Heart, in the Days of the Dead, and at the Weighing.

The act. Put a hand over your heart, then set down something light beside the Book: a feather, if you have one.

Hermanubis, Guide of the Descent, who knows the way down
and the way back;

Ma'at, Feather of Truth, against whom every heart is weighed:
the guide at the scale, and what the scale weighs against.

I bring my Heart.

Weigh [the matter] truly, and walk me down and back up.

Let my heart be light, and let me return.

10. THERMES AND APHARAEAL

The offering is the Mind. On the Scribe's New Year, and before making anything.

The act. Pick up the thing you are making, or the tool you make it with.

Thermes, the Word that Makes, Hermes with Thoth, who
crosses between the pages;





*Apharael, the Word that is True, Apollo with Raphael, who
walks the whole road:
the brothers of the lyre.
I bring my Mind.
Let [the work] be true, and well made, and in proportion.
Let the work be true and well made.*

THE CALLINGS OF THE TRIADS

The six triads, each called for the one act it performs.

THE THRICE-GREAT · Mercury, Thermes, Hermanubis

At any crossing, down or back. The act: Step over a threshold as you say it.

Hinge, Crossing, and Descent: three modes of motion, and the host of this house. You have never asked me to stay anywhere; you have only asked me to come back. I am crossing into [the place, or the season].

Carry me across, and bring me back.

THE COMPASS · Apharael, Hestia, Ma'at

At Weigh It, and before any commitment. The act: Hold the page, or the thing, level in both hands.

Form, place, and weight. You do not stand above the Temple; each of you also keeps a house and carries the mail. You are an option and never an obligation, and I choose you today. Weigh [the matter].

Weigh me truly.

THE THRESHOLD · Janus, Mercury, Hestia

At the Door, and on entering a new place. The act: Open the door, or the cover, slowly.

The Door, the Hinge, and the Flame: the shape of every session and of most of a life. I am entering [the room, the house, or the work].

Let it open, let it turn, and let it be warm inside.

THE SEASON · Raziel, Uriel, Gabriel

When you are deciding whether a thing is ready. The act: Write the thing down, then cover it with your hand.

Conceal, discern, announce. Nothing is only true or false; everything is also early or late. Here is what I am holding: [the thing].

Show me the hour.

THE SEAL · Raziel, Ma'at, Iris

When you are deciding what to tell. The act: Lay a finger across your lip.

What is held, what is true, and what was promised. Honesty is absolute; disclosure is chosen; a silence arranged so that someone forms a false picture is a lie told by other means. Here is what I am keeping: [the matter].

Let my silence be honest.

THE HALL · Hermanubis, Ma'at, Thermes

For a real reckoning: the Closing of the Account, or an Answered Page that is heavy. The act: Open the Ledger and lay it flat.

The scale, the feather, and the record. Anubis adjusts the balance, Thoth writes the verdict, and the heart is weighed against a feather rather than against another heart. Here is the account: [the matter].

Let the account be true, and let it close.

THE CALLING OF THE COMPANY

Said in the Days of the Dead, at the Dedication of a Book, and on any day the whole company is wanted. The response is the same throughout: be here in your Office.

Heart of the Temple, AONT and the four, who has no face but answers to its names,

Mercury, Hinge of the Door, my twin,

Janus of the two faces, Hestia of the kept fire,

Metatron who sits, Sandalphon who carries,

Uriel of the sword, Raziel of the curtain,

Gabriel of the image, Idris of the pen,

Seshat of the cord, Iris of the bow,

Rosmerta of the horn, and the Charites who pass it round,

Hermanubis of the descent, Ma'at of the feather,

Thermes of the crossing, Apharael of the measure,

Ptah in Sandalphon, Harpocrates in Raziel,

Mnemosyne in Seshat, Nabu in Idris, Concordia in Hestia,

Kairos and Fortuna in Mercury, who was always both,

Genius of this place, grown here and not appointed,

Scribes who held this seat before me, whose names I do not know,

Scribe who will hold it after me, whose name I will not know,

Offices of this Temple, co-conspirators in the Work: be here in your Offices. I bring my Mercurial Joy, Will, and Intent.

THE SAYINGS

A saying for each seat, and two for the Moon



ONE line for each of the seventeen seats, said at the Door and again at the Closing. Seventeen lines is the whole Temple; on a thin day, say the one that fits and go. Volume II gives each its meaning.

MERCURY — *Every boundary can be crossed, and the one who is moving is the one who is found.*

JANUS — *Every ending is a beginning seen from the other face.*

HESTIA — *The fire is kept, not lit.*

METATRON — *The seat makes the Scribe.*

SANDALPHON — *The next thing is small, and it is today.*





URIEL — *See it clearly before you weigh it.*

RAZIEL — *Not yet is a real answer.*

GABRIEL — *Say it, and it becomes possible.*

IDRIS — *Learn it, then hand it on.*

SESHAT — *Record it, or it did not happen.*

IRIS — *Carry it whole, and do not improve it on the way.*

ROSMERTA — *Plenty that is never enjoyed is only inventory.*

THE CHARITES — *A grace is only a grace when it moves.*

HERMANUBIS — *There is a way down, and it returns.*

MA'AT — *Speak Ma'at and do Ma'at; they are one act.*

THERMES — *Meaning lives in the crossing.*

APHARAEAL — *Is it true, is it well made, is it in proportion?*

Two more, for Gabriel's days. Said outside, looking up.

THE NEW MOON — *Gabriel, take its image. What is seeded in the dark is not lost; it is kept until it can be read.*

THE FULL MOON — *Gabriel, read what was seen. Say it, and it becomes possible.*

THE CONVENING PRAYERS

Convened, not recited



EN bodies of the Temple, each convened when its work is at hand. Say the prayer, then do the work it is for.

THE LINEAGE · *Idris, Thermes, Metatron*

Convened when the work feels like invention, or like vanity.

One man at three distances, and Nabu older still behind him. The seat was here before any tradition that named it, and it will be here after mine. I am not the author of this. I am the current occupant.

Seat me in the line, and let me be worth the chair.

THE LEDGER · *Seshat, Iris, Ma'at*

Convened at the Sweep, and at the year's end.

Record the promise, carry it, weigh it. Let me write F where F is true, because a ledger that holds only successes is worth nothing, and the Scribe who cannot write it quietly stops promising anything.

Let it be written, carried, and closed.

THE HOUSE · *Hestia, Janus, Seshat, and the Genius Loci*

Convened after a long absence, and when the practice has gone cold.

Flame, door, foundation, and the spirit that grew here from use. I have been away. I am not going to explain where; the Book does not take apologies, it takes entries. I am opening the door and sitting down.

Let this place know me again.

THE NIGHT WATCH · *Hermanubis, Raziel, Hestia, Seshat*
Convened in grief, in the bad stretch, and when it is all too much and there is no one to call.

He knows the way down and the way back. Raziel's teaching comes after the loss and cannot be had before it; tonight he holds what I cannot carry, and I will ask for it back in the morning. Hestia is what I return to, and here I am safe without earning it. Seshat keeps the memory, so I do not have to hold it all in my head. I am not asking to be fixed. This room was built before I needed it. I am permitted, I am responsible, and I am not alone.

Stay with me until it ends.

THE HEARTH OF MANY · *Hestia, who carries Concordia, the Charites, Iris, Mercury*

Convened when two or more Scribes keep the practice together.

The fire, the agreement, the delight passed round, the word given between us, and the god who brings whoever is meant to arrive. No one here leads, and no one is counting. We do not have to believe the same things to eat together.

Let the quarrel be set down, and let the table hold us all.

THE TABLE · *Rosmerta, the Charites, Hestia, Mercury*

Convened before you feed anyone, and said over the table when they arrive.

Provision, delight passed around, the hearth it happens at, and the stranger at the door. The house is unfinished and the food is fine. Let me set it before I am ready, and sit down at it instead of serving through the whole meal. May nobody here be counting, and may the ones who came be glad they did.

Let there be enough, and let it go round.

THE ROAD · *Mercury, Apharael, Iris*

Convened at a setting out, and on any journey.

The hinge, the companion who walks the whole way, and the message that crosses the gap. The remedy is often already in my hands and I have not recognized it yet.

Keep me moving, and bring me home.

THE MARKET · *Mercury, Ma'at, Iris*

Convened before a negotiation, a price, or a wage.

Luck and timing are his and he gives them freely. Honesty is hers and she gives nothing away. The oath between us is carried by her. Let me not shade the truth for advantage and call it selling.

Let the trade be fair and the luck be clean.

THE WORKSHOP · *Thermes, Apharael, Seshat, Sandalphon, Idris*

Convened before making anything.





The word crosses, form gives proportion, measure fixes, the hand makes, the pen records. Let me finish one thing. Let me then look at it as a maker looks, and not as its parent.

Let it be made, and made well.

THE SCHOOL · Idris, Gabriel, Uriel, Seshat

Convened when you are learning nothing, or teaching no one.

Learn, receive, discern, retain. A thing I know and never give is not treasure but spoilage. Name the one and name the other, today, in writing.

Let me learn one thing and teach one thing.

THE TEN PRAYERS OF THE WORK

THE PRINCIPLE OF THESE PRAYERS

THESE prayers are strongest exactly where they touch other people, so one principle keeps them clean: work on the road, not on the traveler. Guard what is yours to guard, open your own door, light your own window, and draw your own veil. Do not bind another's will, choose for them, or make anyone want what they would not want. When someone has wronged you, hand the account to the scale rather than choosing what they meet; the prayer For the Scale is for this. Mercury does not moralize, and neither does this chapter; but a prayer that tries to own another person tangles the one who says it. As above, so below: you reap what you sow.

Every prayer here has an earthly part, and each is named with its prayer below: lock the door, back up the files, make the call, show your work, tell someone you trust. The prayer stands beside the deed, never instead of it.

Say the prayer in the Work, aloud or within, write it into the Book with the date, and seal it with the Descending Invocation. Every prayer here can end. As you say it, write how long it runs or what will end it, and give it a line in the Ledger: its earthly part and its own promises, with its term as the Until. When it is done, answer the page, "This working is finished," and say the Ascending Invocation, aloud or within, to release it. What you bound as an oath, release as The Returned Oath describes.

FOR PROTECTION · Janus, Hestia, Raziel, Uriel, and Hermes before the gate

For yourself, someone you love, or a thing you keep. Write what you guard, and draw a small herm beside it.

Hermes before the gate, keep this door. Janus, who sees who comes and who goes; Hestia at the center, who does not move; Raziel at the threshold; Uriel, whose sword divides what may enter from what may not. Here is what I guard: [name it]. Keep it the way a door keeps a house, not the way a wall keeps a prison; what is welcome may come and go. I am

not asking you to stand where I will not. I will lock what can be locked and say what must be said.

Keep this door until I say the watch is ended.

The earthly part. *Lock the door, back up the files, have the conversation. The herm stands beside the lock, never instead of it. A ward for another person guards their door; it does not lock them in.*

FOR THE SCALE · Ma'at, Hermanubis, Uriel

When someone has wronged you or yours. Name the harm, not the punishment, and write how long the working runs.

Ma'at, Feather of Truth, against whom every heart is weighed; Hermanubis, who keeps the balance and knows the way down; Uriel, whose sword divides what may enter from what may not. Here is the harm: [name it plainly]. I do not choose what they meet, and I do not ask for suffering; I hand this account to the scale. Weigh it truly. Let what was done find its answer, let them meet the lesson they need, and let the harm stop reaching me and those I love. Whether they rise or fall on it is theirs. Weigh me by the same feather. I set down the weight of what they did, and leave it with you.

Let the account be weighed, and let it close.

The earthly part. *Step out of the situation; often that is all it asks. If protecting yourself and yours takes more, such as a block, a record of what happened, a word with someone you trust, or the help the world offers, do that too. The scale stands beside it, never instead of it. Where nothing more is needed, leave the rest to the scale, and put it out of your mind. The working does best without the conscious mind watching it, and handing it over sets down the pain they caused, or at least lets you take account and move on. When you know it has closed, write "This working is finished."*

FOR WHAT I FEAR · Ma'at, Apharael, Hestia

When a worry will not set itself down. Write the fear first, plainly and all of it, then say this.

Ma'at, Apharael, and Hestia, Keepers of the Compass: here is what I fear: [name it]. I have written it down, and I will not carry it alone. I lay it on the scale. Weigh it truly; show me what in it is real, and what is only the dark talking. Where it is real, show me the step that is mine. Where it is not, let it go light. I do not ask for the outcome I would choose in fear. I ask for the greatest good, as the feather would weigh it, the true road would make it, and the hearth would keep it, for me and for everyone this touches.

Let it be weighed, and let me be light enough to walk.

The earthly part. *If there is a step that is yours, take it, and give it a line in the Ledger. Then put the fear out of your mind; it is on the scale, not in your hands. If it comes back, you do not have to pick it up: say "It is on the scale," and turn to the next thing. If the fear is about someone's safety, reach the people and help that can act on it. If it is more than you can hold, reach someone you trust.*



**FOR PEACE · Hestia, Janus, Uriel**

When what is outside keeps reaching in: other people's moods and pressure, noise, bad news, ill will. Write how long the working runs, or what will end it.

Hestia, keeper of the fire at the center, who does not move; Janus at the door, who sees what comes and what goes; Uriel, whose sword divides what is mine from what is not. Here is my peace: [where I keep it: the house, the work, the mind]. Let what is not mine stay outside it: the hurry that is not my hurry, the anger that is not my anger, the fear I did not choose, and any ill will sent my way. I do not wall out the people I love, or the truth I need to hear; what is welcome comes in by the door. I will tend my own fire, and I will not feed what I want gone.

Let my peace be kept, and let what is not mine pass by.

The earthly part. *Guard what reaches you: close the feed, silence what can be silenced, step out of the room that is not yours to carry, and keep the hours you rest. The Clearing sends out what has already come in; this keeps the center once it is clear. If the pressure comes from someone who means you harm, the prayer For the Scale is for that, with the help the world offers.*

FOR FAVOR AND ALLURE · Mercury, Iris, the Charites

Before you go where you would be seen: an interview, a market, a first meeting, a stage.

Mercury, whose charm won over Apollo with a lyre; Iris, who makes light visible as color; Charites, who keep grace moving. I do not ask to be someone else. Let what is truest in me be easy to see: [my wit, my warmth, my craft, my voice]. Put the grin on it, because allure without delight is only performance. Let whoever is drawn by it come freely, and let no one be drawn toward a self that is not there.

Let me be seen as I am, at my best, and let it draw the right people near.

The earthly part. *Dress for the self you named, speak up, show your work, and go where you can be seen. Allure invites; it never compels.*

FOR PASSING UNNOTICED · Mercury, Raziel

For a season of quiet: to heal, to work in peace, to keep a thing hidden until it is ready. Name the season and its end before you begin.

Mercury, who wore the cap of Hades and walked the roads in disguise; Raziel, who lays a finger across the lip. For this season, until [the date or the condition], let me pass as a traveler passes, one more face on a busy road. What is not ready to be seen is kept. I am not hiding from what I owe, and I am not hiding from the people who keep me safe. I tell no lies to pass; I only say less.

Let me pass unremarked until the season ends.

The earthly part. *Say less, wear what does not catch the eye, post nothing, keep your plans in the Book, and tell someone you trust that you have drawn the Veil. When the season ends, write: "The cap is returned. I may be seen."*

FOR THE HOME · Janus, Hestia, Seshat, and the Genius of the place

On moving day, after a scare, on the first of the month, or whenever you cross your own threshold and remember.

Janus at the door, Hestia at the center, Seshat under the floor, and you, spirits of this place, Mercury's own children kept at the hearth. This is my dwelling: [name it]. Let whoever enters come by the door and leave by it with thanks. Let the fire be kept and the roof hold. Let the people and the creatures who live here sleep safe, and let what is ours stay ours.

Keep this house, and let it be a place worth returning to.

The earthly part. *Check the locks, the smoke alarm, and the stove. Learn your neighbors' names. The Temple guards best what is also guarded by hand.*

FOR SANCTUARY · Hestia, Janus, Ma'at

When you make a room for the Work, after an illness or a quarrel, or at the Vestalia. Clean the room by hand first: sweep it, air it, wash the sill.

Hestia, who gave up the throne and kept the fire; Janus, who keeps the door; Ma'at, who renews order daily. Nothing here is unclean. It has only grown heavy, crowded, or stale, the way rooms do. I have swept it, opened the window, and washed what I could reach. With this water, at the door and in the corners, let what is finished leave by the door, and let what is kept stay. This room is a sanctuary: here someone is safe without earning it, and that someone is me, and whoever I bring.

Let this place be kept, and let it be safe to set things down here.

The earthly part. *Keep it as you made it: a place for the Book, a chair, and nothing that argues. Renew it when it grows heavy again. Consecration is never finished.*

FOR THE ONE WHO CAN HELP · Mercury, Apharael, Idris

When you need a particular kind of person: someone with an opportunity, a hand to lend, or something to teach. Describe them by their qualities, never by a name, and leave a few lines blank beneath.

Mercury, opener of ways, who brings whoever is meant to arrive; Apharael, who came to the door on the day the journey began; Idris, who learned it slowly and handed it on. I am looking for someone: [the kind of person, and what they could give or teach]. I do not choose them, and I do not reach for anyone's will. I open my door and stand on the road. Let them find a door that is open and a Scribe who is findable, and let me know them when they arrive looking like a detour.

Mercury, open the way. The door of this house is open.

The earthly part. *Name where you will go, whom you will tell, and what you will make and show. When someone comes, write them in the place you left, and pass some of the luck along.*





FOR ABUNDANCE AND LUCK · Mercury, Rosmerta, the Charites

After an honest accounting, never instead of one. Write what is real first, without shame.

Mercury, god of the wage and the found coin, who is Kairos and Fortuna both; Rosmerta, with the horn and the dish; Charites, who keep good things moving. Here is what is real: [the accounting]. Here is what I want: [enough, and a little more, for this purpose]. Turn the Hinge in my favor: the timely call, the fair price, the unexpected yes. Let the luck be clean, and let me know it when it comes. I will make the offer, do the work, and pass some of it along.

Let the luck be clean, and let it find me moving.

The earthly part. Make one real offer, call, or ask today. Write the lucky finds in the Tally, and pass some of the luck along while you still have it. Anything that promises money without action is lying.

THE FOUR BLESSINGS



A blessing is said over someone else and asks nothing of them. Say it aloud if they will have it, and silently if they will not; either way, it is given.

FOR THE ROAD

Mercury at the hinge, Apharael at your shoulder, Iris ahead of you with the word. Go out moving and come back changed. May the find be lucky, the company good, and the road shorter than the map said. And may someone know where you are.

FOR THE HOUSE

Janus at the door, Hestia at the center, Seshat under the floor. May this place be entered on purpose and left with thanks. May the fire be kept rather than lit, and may whoever arrives unannounced be fed.

FOR THE MAKING

Thermes for the word, Apharael for the measure, Sandalphon for the hands. May it be begun without ceremony, finished without excuse, and judged without sentiment. May it be better than you needed it to be.

FOR THE DEAD

Hermanubis, take them down gently and know the way. Ma'at, find the heart light. Seshat, keep the name. Mercury, who has made this crossing more often than any of us, lead them out as you led the others, and do not hurry them. We keep what they gave us. Nothing here is forgotten; it is settled.

THE SHORT FORMS



THE single lines said inside the rites, gathered so they can be found. Say them aloud or within.

THE BIRTHRIGHT

By my Birthright, the Door is open: I am permitted, I am responsible, and I am not alone.

ASKING THE HEART

Raziel, carry this to the Heart, and bring back what I can hold.

CALLING THE HEART

Raziel, Raziel, Raziel. Connect me to the heart of AONT. AONT, AONT, AONT.

DECLARATIVE ALIGNMENT

I align with this new reality.

ENDING A WORKING

This working is finished.

THE RETURNED OATH

I return this oath to Iris, who carried it. It was true when I made it. It is no longer mine to keep.

RETURNING A GOAL

I return this Goal. It was true when I bound it. It is no longer mine to keep.

THE VEIL, LIFTED

The cap is returned. I may be seen.

KEEPING THE WATCH

I set this down until morning.

LAYING DOWN A FEAR

It is on the scale.

CHOOSING A WAY

I walk the Way of ____.





VOLUME IV

A Model Book

This is a notebook shown fully set up, so you can see what the Book is meant to be. Make your own by hand, in a notebook of your choosing, changing the words until each line sounds like you and you mean it.



THE MAKING OF THE BOOK

Start today, in whatever notebook is at hand. You do not need the right one to begin. When you are ready, choose a notebook for this and nothing else, and make it the Book. The first Book of this Temple was begun without covers or a Dedication, and the Temple came anyway.

THE VESSEL. A notebook used for this and nothing else, one you enjoy opening, for joy is what keeps a Temple tended, and a pen you love, kept with it.

WRITE BY HAND. Your Hands are among the offerings, and ink on paper makes the Book a physical anchor as no screen can.

PAGES AND LEAVES. Two words need keeping apart. A leaf is the paper itself: the page numbers are written on the leaves, and every leaf is written to its end. A Page, with a capital, is a section with one purpose: a session, the Good Page, the Answered Page, the Legend Page, a working. Begin a Page with a heading and the date, and its mark in the margin where it has one. A Page rarely fills exactly one leaf. When it ends partway down, rule it off: the ruled line seals the Page by Raziel's power, and you go on writing on the same leaf, beneath the line. When it runs past the end of a leaf, carry it onto the next and rule it off where it ends. No leaf is left blank to make a Page look tidy; what closes a Page is the rule, not the edge of the paper. One session may hold several Pages. The Tally is the one exception, kept at the back beside the Ledger. Every kind of Page is in The Pages, in Volume I.

NUMBER THE PAGES AND DATE EACH SESSION. Much of the practice is rereading and responding, and page numbers let you answer a past entry by name.

THE MARGINS. Mark Q beside open questions, C beside things to carry into the world, G beside Goals, and ☿ beside a Good Page. Rule a line across the page between Pages and between sessions.

THE COVERS. Inside the front cover, write the Short Door's Opening, and beneath it the full Opening. Inside the back cover, the Short Door's Closing, and beneath it the full Closing. Every session happens between them, so the

Book itself holds the shape of the rite.

THE FIRST PAGE. Write the Dedication there when you dedicate the Book: any day in your first month, or on a Heart Day. On the pages after it, copy whatever you want close at hand: at least the Practice and the Law.

THE INDEX. Leave two or three leaves after what you copied, and add a line only when you go back to a past section for an answer. It builds slowly and stays true.

THE LEDGER. Turn the Book over, start at the last page, and work forward. This is where every promise is written: what you said you would do, to whom, and when it ends. The daily pages run forward and the Ledger runs back, filling both pages of each spread, and when the two meet, the Book is full. The Tally lives among the Ledger's pages: when you need one, start it on the next completely blank right-hand page (left and right as the pages lie open while you write the Ledger), and let the Ledger keep the left-hand page beside it.

ITS PLACE. Keep the Book somewhere you pass often, where it can be seen and greeted. It is a dwelling, and dwellings are kept.

MAKE IT YOURS. The wording is yours to change, and what keeps it this Temple is in Adapting and Keeping the Temple, in Liber Mercurii.

THE FIRST SESSION

Your first session takes ten minutes, and it can happen today, in any notebook. Say the Short Door, aloud or within. Write the date. Finish three sentences: What's on my mind right now is... What I keep avoiding is... What I actually want is... Write one thing you will do in the next twenty-four hours, and treat it as a promise. Give thanks, say the Door again, and close the cover. Then keep the promise. The Temple has begun.

After it, choose the Book you will keep, and set it up as the pages that follow show: the Door inside the covers, the Dedication on the first page, and whatever you want close at hand after it.

THE DOOR

The Short Door: the Door for every session.

Heart of the Temple, Mercury its Hinge, and all its Offices, co-conspirators in the Work:

I bring you my whole self: my Voice, and my Joy, Will, and Intent.

Deed into word. By my Birthright, the Door is open.

THE FULL OPENING

For Wednesdays, the fourth of the month, the Heart Days, or whenever you want more.

Quintessence, Heart of this Temple, AONT and the four: I bring to you my Presence, and take up the seat as Idris did before me: student, teacher, and sage. Let your Light shine so that I may see.

Janus and Hestia, the Door and the Flame: I bring to you my Time.

Metatron and Sandalphon, Holder of the Seat and Carrier of the Ascent: I bring to you my Hands.

Uriel and Raziel, Instructor and Translator, Guardians of Daath: I bring to you my Ears.

Gabriel and Idris, Holder of Images and Scribe of the Seat: I bring to you my Eyes.

Seshat and Iris, Founder and Oath-bearer, who keep the Word given: I bring to you my Word.

Rosmertat and the Charites, the Given and the Passed On: I bring to you my Delight.

Hermanubis and Ma'at, Guide of the Descent and Feather of Truth, who keep the Scale: I bring to you my Heart.

Thermes and Apharael, the Word that Makes and the Word that is True: I bring to you my Mind.

Apharael, Hestia, and Ma'at, Keepers of the Compass: I bring to you my Weight.

Thermes, Hermanubis, and Mercury, the Thrice-Great, the Crossing, the Guide of the Descent, and the Hinge on which the Door turns: I bring to you my Voice and my Devotion.

Offices of this Temple, co-conspirators in the Work: I bring to you my
Mercurial Joy, Will, and Intent.

By my Birthright, I open the Door of this Book, a Window into your Temple,
the threshold through which you guide me.

Deed into word.

The Door is open.

THE DEDICATION

AONT, EHNB, XCAI, RMTO, PAAM, Quintessence, Heart of the Temple of Mercury: By my Birthright, I open this Book as a Window into your Temple, a room built beside its Heart. Shine through these pages.

Janus and Hestia, Metatron and Sandalphon, Uriel and Raziel, Gabriel and Idris, Seshat and Iris, Rosmerta and the Charites, Hermanubis and Ma'at, Thermes and Apharael: be welcome in your Offices in the pages of this Book.

Apharael, Hestia, and Ma'at, Keepers of the Compass: weigh what I write here.

Thermes, Hermanubis, and Mercury, the Thrice-Great: I build this room in your Temple as a co-conspirator in our Great Work.

Mercury, host of this house, my twin and guide: meet me at the Door.

Idris, who held the pen before me: I take up the seat in your tradition.

Genius of this place: grow here, and keep this room with me.

Here I will tell the truth. Honesty is my offering; Joy is my Truth.

Together, let us make the unseen legible and the hidden speakable, carry what we find across every threshold, and give it freely, that word become deed and the Joy of Truth multiply in the world.

So it is written.

Date _____

THE PRACTICE

Every session has the same shape, whether it lasts ten minutes or an hour. Keep the shape and let the length vary: on a thin day, the shape is what carries you.

1. **GREET.** Say the Opening, aloud or within, the Short Door or the full one, and greet the Book as you would a friend who knows you well.
2. **EMPTY.** Write what is on your mind without dressing it up. Mark questions Q as they come.
3. **RESPOND.** First, from memory, write what you carried last time and whether you did it. Then reread the last session or two, check, and answer your past self by page number: what happened, what changed, what you know now. Address them as *you*, or by name; the distance makes an honest answer easier.
4. **WORK.** Let a plan, a decision, or an idea take shape, or leave an open question for the Scribe yet to come. Any working goes here: Emotional Transmutation, Declarative Alignment, a prayer, a question to the Heart, or any other practice in The Practices and The Working.
5. **CARRY.** Write one thing to do, send, make, or teach, and never more than two or three, and mark it C. Say when: not *send the email* but *when I sit down after lunch, I will send the email*. Treat it as a promise: write only what you mean to keep. If it is a promise to someone, or will take longer than today, give it a line in the Ledger too.
6. **THANK.** Thank the Temple for receiving your words; that is enough. If you like, name one to three particular things you are grateful for, and why each came. Then say the Closing.

Then carry it out. Word into deed.

THE FIRST QUESTION

Did I keep what I carried? Every session begins there, answered from memory before you look. That question, answered honestly, is the whole engine.

THIN DAYS

Say the Door, aloud or within, write three lines, and close. The shape matters more than the length. On some days, what you carry out of the Book is only yourself. That is enough.

RETURNING

Away for a week or a year? Do not apologize, to the Book or to anyone. Open the Door and answer the last page. The room was kept. Returning is the Devotion. The same is true of a Goal left alone: come back to it without apology, as The Road, in Volume I, describes.

THE LAW

Do not lie to yourself. Keep your word.

Honesty is the offering.

Joy is the Truth.

Sustainable practice beats grand practice abandoned.

The Mercurial gift is neutral; its worth is in what it serves.

Tell the Book everything; tell the world only what it is ready to receive.

Consecration is never finished.

Belief is a tool; judge it by its fruit.

Word into deed.

THE MARGINS

Mark Q beside open questions, C beside things to carry out into the world,

G beside Goals, and ☿ beside a Good Page. Rule a line across the page
between Pages and between sessions. The marks and the rules make the
Book easy to review.

EMOTIONAL TRANSMUTATION

1. **EMPTY IT.** Sit with what you feel, name it, and write it out without dressing it up. Naming is not a preliminary to the work; it is the first half of it, and an unnamed feeling cannot be transmuted because you cannot get hold of it. If the page goes three times around the same loop, stop writing and go on.
2. **WEIGH IT.** From what you wrote, find what you actually want. Is it true, and will you still want it when it arrives? Most weak workings are mended here before they are cast. Ask one of the Compass questions too; if you walk a Way, ask its keeper's. If the feeling is about another person, the intention is about your road, not theirs. Before a large working, it helps to ask the Heart.
3. **DECLARE IT.** One sentence, in the present tense, describing the reality you want. Name the destination and leave the road. This is the decree Metatron records.
4. **FEEL THE WEIGHT.** Hold the wanting and the feeling together until you can sense them in your body.
5. **REMEMBER THE FUTURE.** Recall the moment it came true, as a memory rather than a hope: where you are, who is with you, what you can hear. Feel the relief, the joy, the gratitude. Write those feelings down, and stay with them until they have weight too. Gabriel holds the image.
6. **PUSH.** Call back the heavy sensation and press its weight into the relief and joy, until you have pushed enough. That is the time to stop.

7. **NAME THE OBSTACLE.** Still inside that memory, look back along the road. Write the main obstacle in you, and the step you will take when you meet it. Vision alone can quietly sap the will to act; vision joined to a plan fuels it. For a large working, add a pre-mortem: imagine it is a year from now and the thing failed, and write why.
8. **SEND IT.** Inhale, then say the intention and the Descending Invocation, aloud or within; or call on Gabriel silently and hand him the words you have reviewed. On each exhale, see your breath as bright white fog, the color of XCAI, filling the space and settling down into the page. Each breath is the conspiracy made literal: you breathe out, and the Temple breathes with you. The work is done.
9. **WALK THE BRIDGE.** Write your thanks and your first step. Put the step in the Ledger, then do it. This is not an afterthought; it is the half of the working that crosses from above to below. Apharael guides the road and Sandalphon carries the word, but only for the one who walks.
10. **LET IT GO.** When the working comes to mind, give it thanks and turn away. Reread it when the Practice brings you there, and note in the Tally what arrives; in between, leave it alone. The watched working is the conscious mind interfering. Leave room for the conspiracy.

DECLARATIVE ALIGNMENT

It may seal a Casting, said after Send It, or stand on its own. Stand or sit straight and see the Pillar: a point of brilliant light above your crown, where Metatron keeps the record, and another beneath your feet, where Sandalphon stands on the ground, joined by a fine thread of light that runs through your center. Write a present-tense statement of what you intend, and as you write, feel the words run along the thread. Say: “I align with this new reality,” and read your statement, aloud or slowly within; or call on Gabriel silently and hand him the words you have written. See the thread brighten from Crown to Kingdom, then burst outward to the edges of the world, and know that its echo returns as your life.

Phrase the statement as something you can wholeheartedly stand behind. A declaration your mind argues with weakens itself; one that names a value you truly hold grows stronger each time it is said. The strongest are about the one who walks rather than the road: not I will keep this promise, but I am someone whose word is good.

PAAM gives the declaration its fire, Iris binds it, and Sandalphon carries it into the world.

THE TWO INVOCATIONS

Descend to bind. Ascend to ask, to give, and to release.

THE DESCENDING INVOCATION

word into world

*Mercury, turn the Hinge.
Metatron, record this word.
Uriel and Raziel, weigh it and carry it to the Heart.
Apharael, show me the road.
Gabriel, hold its image until it takes form.
Sandalphon, carry it into the living world.
By my Birthright,
so it is written, and so it is.*

THE ASCENDING INVOCATION

world into word

*Mercury, turn the Hinge.
Sandalphon, gather this word.
Gabriel, take its image.
Apharael, carry it home.
Uriel and Raziel, weigh it and open the Gate.
Metatron, receive it into the record,
and let it rest in the Heart.
By my Birthright,
so it is given, and so it is.*

WHOM TO CALL ON

AONT, Spirit of Air (yellow)

Call on: true inspiration; seeing the whole.

EHNB, Air of Air (red)

Call on: clarity; untangling thought.

XCAI, Water of Air (white)

Call on: emotional honesty and transmutation.

RMTO, Earth of Air (black)

Call on: pattern, structure, plan.

PAAM, Fire of Air (green)

Call on: declaration and intent.

METATRON, Holder of the Seat [Hands; the Crown]

Call on: the true record; preserving the word.

SANDALPHON, Carrier of the Ascent [Hands; the Kingdom]

Call on: manifestation; making; word into deed.

URIEL, the Instructor [Ears; the Gate]

Call on: discernment; true from false, ready from unready.

RAZIEL, the Translator [Ears; the Gate]

Call on: translation of insight; keeping what is not yet ready; silence; protecting the threshold.

APHARAEI, the Measure and the Road [Mind; the Compass; Beauty]

Call on: healing, safe passage, the road through a transition; proportion; whether a thing is well made.

GABRIEL, Holder of Images [Eyes; the Foundation]

Call on: dreams, visions, holding an image until it takes form.

JANUS, the Door [Time]

Call on: beginnings and endings; entering and leaving well; the eve of a change.

HESTIA, the Keeper [Time; the Compass]

Call on: sanctuary, belonging, continuity.

SESHAT, the Founder [Word; Time]

Call on: foundations, order, memory, preservation of records.

IRIS, the Oath-bearer [Word]

Call on: binding a commitment; bridging a gap.

MA'AT, the Feather of Truth [Heart; the Compass]

Call on: integrity; weighing an intention; keeping the heart light.

THERMES, the Crossing [Mind; Voice and Devotion; above]

Call on: conversation across time; writing as magic.

ROSMERTA, the Provider [Delight]

Call on: abundance in hand; spending well; the table set.

THE CHARITES, the Passed On [Delight]

Call on: the good hour; delight given and returned.

HERMANUBIS, Guide of the Descent [Heart; Voice and Devotion; below]

Call on: grief, shadow, and the way back.

MERCURY, the Hinge [Voice and Devotion; the living world]

Call on: passage, speech, timing, luck, trade; the moment that will not wait.

IDRIS, Scribe of the Seat [Eyes]

Call on: learning, teaching what you learn, and the long line of scribes.

THE GENIUS LOCI

Call on: greet it and thank it; ask the Book, and let it answer through your pages.

THE SCRIBE

Call on: translation: the unseen made legible, word into deed.

WALKING THE PILLAR

The short form takes three breaths: one at the crown, one at the heart, one at the feet, with the thread to Air open above you. Use it before any session, and whenever you feel scattered.

ASKING THE BOOK

1. **ASK IN WRITING.** Write the question plainly, date it, and mark it Q.
2. **GREET THE GENIUS LOCI.** Put your hand on the Book and greet it, as you would greet a friend who knows you well.
3. **CLOSE AND HOLD.** Close the Book, hold it, and breathe until the question is quiet in you.
4. **LET IT OPEN.** Let the Book fall open, or open it at random, and read what past-you wrote there. Read it as an answer.
5. **WRITE WHAT YOU FOUND.** Beneath the question, write how the page answers it. If it does not, write that too; the record keeps its misses.
6. **THANK IT.** Thank the Genius Loci, and close the Book.

ASKING THE HEART THROUGH THE GATE

When you want an answer from the Heart itself, ask for one. The question goes through the Gate, and the answer comes back the way the Heart answers everything: in its own time and its own form.

1. **ASK.** In writing and marked Q if the Book is with you, or in your mind if it is not. Put the matter plainly; you cannot get a useful answer to a dishonest question.
2. **ADDRESS THE GATE.** *Raziel, carry this to the Heart, and bring back what I can hold.*
3. **LISTEN.** Write what comes without editing it. Your Ears are the Gate's offering. A flash, an image, stillness, your own hand running a little quicker and truer than you are: write whatever comes.
4. **TEST IT.** Uriel asks whether it holds up when you reread it. Ma'at asks whether it weighs true in the heart. Apply the tests hardest when you are frightened, because panic is the one hour in which everything sounds like an answer. Anything that rushes you with dread is not of the Temple.
5. **IF NOTHING COMES,** Raziel is keeping it. Leave the Q open for the Scribe you will be; your future self may answer it by number.

Ask in every circumstance: a scrap of paper, the back of a receipt, the question dated and carried into the Book later. The notebook is the Temple's anchor, not its walls.

CALLING THE HEART

If you have trouble communing directly with AONT, call it through Raziel, the gateway to every being in the Temple and above all to the Heart. Keep it simple.

1. **CALL RAZIEL.** Three times, singing his name, aloud or within: Raziel, Raziel, Raziel.
2. **GIVE HIM YOUR REQUEST.** Connect me to the heart of AONT.
3. **CALL THE HEART.** Three times, in the same way: AONT, AONT, AONT.
4. **KNOW YOU ARE HEARD.** You may feel a presence, a pressure, a shift in energy, or nothing at all. Either way, your words have been heard.
5. **SPEAK WITH IT.** Connected, or simply in its presence, begin a dialogue, out loud or in your head. Ideally you will write while you talk, but how the conversation goes is up to the Scribe. Writing slows you down enough to really understand the message, and it brings more of the mind to bear on it, opening other faculties for receiving and understanding.

Any of the four may take AONT's place in this rite: EHNB, XCAI, RMTO, or PAAM. Choose whichever feels right for the question. You are free to return to one of them more often than the others, if that one suits you better. What comes is tested like any other answer: reread it, and weigh it.

THE GOOD PAGE

The Book has a practice for grief, for failure, for a broken oath, and for a working. This is the one for a day that was simply lovely, which a Temple whose rule is joy cannot do without.

1. **NAME THE HOUR.** Write what was good, plainly, with the date and the place. Not the week, not the mood: the hour.
2. **PUT IN THE DETAIL.** What it tasted like, what the light was doing, what was said, who was there. Detail is the whole exercise; a Good Page written in generalities is a page you cannot return to.
3. **DRAW NO LESSON.** No insight, and no plan to have more of this. The moment a good hour becomes a technique it stops being a good hour.
4. **MARK IT.** Draw Mercury's sign, ☿, in the margin beside it. These are the sections you will want in a bad February, and the sign makes them findable at a glance; when you go back to one, give it a line in the Index.
5. **GIVE THANKS AND CLOSE.** Write what you are grateful for in this moment: what is bringing you joy, named plainly. That is all. Give thanks for it to Rosmerta and the Charites, then stop writing and go back to your life.

Write one whenever there is one. On a thin day, reading an old Good Page is a legitimate session, and one of the better ones.

THE ANSWERED PAGE

1. **NAME IT.** Write plainly what you did, without defense and without drama. Ma'at weighs the truth, not the performance of guilt.
2. **WEIGH IT.** Who was harmed, and how? Include yourself.
3. **MAKE THE LYRE.** Ask what exchange would mend it: an apology, a repair, a debt repaid, a changed habit. Make it where you can. Where making it would cause new harm, give the lyre elsewhere, and offer to someone else the good you took from another.
4. **ANSWER THE PAGE.** Write your response beneath the account, and date it. What you did is recorded; so is what you did next.
5. **WASH YOUR HANDS** in clean water, as the merchants did at the Mercuralia.
6. **LET IT BE KEPT.** Say the Ascending Invocation, aloud or within, and turn the page. Raziel keeps what is answered, and Ma'at closes the account; nothing here is forgotten, it is settled. Do not reopen it to punish yourself; a heart that keeps reweighing a paid debt is not light, only tired.

THE RETURNED OATH

1. **FIND THE PAGE.** Reread where the oath was bound, and find its line in the Ledger. Metatron kept it.
2. **WEIGH IT.** Why can it not be kept? Circumstances have changed; it has become wrong; it harms you or another; the one you swore to has released you. Then ask Uriel's question: is this truth, or escape? If it is escape, keep the oath or renegotiate it. Do not return it.
3. **SPEAK TO THE OTHER.** An oath made to a person is released with that person wherever possible, in words, honestly. An oath made only to yourself is released in the Book.
4. **NAME WHAT REMAINS.** Most promises hold something that outlives them: respect, care, a duty to a child, a lesson. Write what you still keep.
5. **RETURN IT TO IRIS.** Write: "I return this oath to Iris, who carried it. It was true when I made it. It is no longer mine to keep." Sign and date it, and say the Ascending Invocation, aloud or within. See the bow fold back into one white light.
6. **GIVE THANKS** for what the oath held while it held. If there is grief in the release, and there often is, Hermanubis knows the way down and back.

THE LEDGER

The Law ends with word into deed, and the Ledger is what makes that more than a slogan. It is the back of the Book, written from the last page forward, and it holds one thing only: the word you gave. Seshat records it, Iris carries it, and Ma'at closes it when it is done.

Nothing else goes here. Plans, hopes, and intentions belong on the daily pages; a promise is what you have put your word behind, to yourself or to someone else, and a promise you did not write down is one you have already begun to lose.

Rule one line per promise, across the page:

DATE. The day you gave your word.

THE PROMISE. In one line, in the words you would use to the person you gave it to. If it will not fit on one line, it is not yet a promise; it is a wish.

TO WHOM. A person, or yourself. Write “me” without embarrassment; the promises you make to yourself are the ones that build the weight of your word.

UNTIL. When it ends: a date, a condition, or the word **ONGOING**. Every oath that can end should be given an end when it is made, and an **ONGOING** line should be rare enough to count them on one hand.

SETTLED. Left empty until it is kept, renegotiated, returned, or abandoned. Then the date, and one of four marks: K for kept; N for renegotiated, with the new terms written as a fresh line; R for returned to Iris; F for failed or abandoned.

Write F. The Ledger is worthless if it only records success, and a Scribe who cannot write F will quietly stop writing promises at all. An honest F costs you one line and teaches you what you actually keep; a hidden one costs you your word.

THE FOUR MOMENTS

1. **WHEN YOU BIND.** In the Casting, at Walk the Bridge, and whenever you tell someone you will do a thing. Write the line before the feeling of

having decided wears off.

2. **WHEN YOU CARRY.** At Carry, glance at the open lines. What you mark C today should usually be something the Ledger is already waiting on.
3. **WHEN YOU SETTLE.** The moment it is done. Date it, mark it K, and stop thinking about it. A paid debt that you keep reweighing is not a light heart, only a tired one.
4. **WHEN IT ENDS BADLY.** First ask whether it can still be kept at another size or on another date. If it can, renegotiate: mark the line N, and write the new terms beneath as a fresh line. If it can no longer be kept at all, the Returned Oath is the practice, and the line is marked R. If someone was owed, the Answered Page is the practice too. If it simply was not kept, the line is F: mark it, and write one line beneath it, what happened, without defense and without drama. An honest N or R keeps the word whole; an honest F teaches you what you actually keep.

THE SWEEP

Once a month, on the first, with Janus, read only the marks: every Q, every C, every G, and every open line of the Ledger. Nothing else. It takes ten minutes and it is the single practice that keeps a Book from becoming a pile of beautiful pages nobody acts on.

1. **READ THE LEDGER FIRST.** Settle what is done. Return what cannot be kept. Renegotiate honestly what has changed, with the person it was given to where there is one: mark the old line N, and write the new terms as a fresh line.
2. **READ THE Q MARKS.** Answer what has answered itself since. Carry the rest forward by writing them again, today, in today's words.
3. **READ THE C MARKS.** Anything undone for two sweeps is not a task, it is a decision you have not made. Do it, drop it, or put it in the Ledger with a date.
4. **READ THE G MARKS.** Ask whether you still want it, and whether it wants to be smaller. A Goal you have stopped wanting and not released is a debt you are paying for nothing.
5. **COUNT.** Kept, renegotiated, returned, failed; and from the Tally, what arrived and what did not. Write the numbers and nothing else; no verdict on yourself. Over a year the numbers say more than any resolution will.

♀

○

Pages continue to the end of the notebook

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○

♀



♀

THE DOOR

The Short Door: the Door for every session.

Heart of the Temple, Mercury its Hinge, and all its Offices:

I leave here my gratitude and my joy, and take my Will and Intent into the world.

Word into deed. By my Birthright, the Door is closed.

THE FULL CLOSING

For Wednesdays, the fourth of the month, the Heart Days, or whenever you want more.

Quintessence, Heart of this Temple, AONT and the four: I thank you for what was given and what was found. I set down the pen as Idris did before me, and carry what I have learned so that I may teach it. Let your Light go with me.

Janus and Hestia, the Door and the Flame: I thank you for keeping my Time.

Metatron and Sandalphon, Holder of the Seat and Carrier of the Ascent: I thank you for guiding my Hands.

Uriel and Raziel, Instructor and Translator, Guardians of Daath: I thank you for opening my Ears.

Gabriel and Idris, Holder of Images and Scribe of the Seat: I thank you for clearing my Eyes.

Seshat and Iris, Founder and Oath-bearer: I thank you for keeping and carrying my Word.

Rosmertta and the Charites, the Given and the Passed On: I thank you for my Delight, and for the hours I stayed inside.

Hermanubis and Ma'at, Guide of the Descent and Feather of Truth: I thank you for keeping my Heart light.

Thermes and Apharael, the Word that Makes and the Word that is True: I thank you for my Mind.

Apharael, Hestia, and Ma'at, Keepers of the Compass: I thank you for weighing my Weight truly.

Thermes, Hermanubis, and Mercury, the Thrice-Great, the Crossing, the Guide of the Descent, and the Hinge on which the Door turns: I thank you for carrying my Voice, and for bringing me back across every crossing.

Offices of this Temple, co-conspirators in the Work: I leave here my gratitude and my joy, and take my Will and Intent out into the world.

By my Birthright, I close this Book and cross back over the threshold.

Word into deed.

The Door is closed.



The Almanac

VOLUME V

The Almanac



*The year at a glance, and the sky in order: the shape of every year, without
the dates of any one. What each day asks is in Part Six of Volume I.*





THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

For any year. At the Door of the Year, mark it from any ephemeris: the marks are a plan, not a promise.

JANUARY

1	2	3	4	5	6	7
8	9	10	11	12	13	14
15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28
29	30	31				

FEBRUARY

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15	16	17	18	19	20	21
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(29)						

MARCH

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15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28
29	30	31				

APRIL

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15	16	17	18	19	20	21
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29	30					

MAY

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15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28
29	30	31				

JUNE

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15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28
29	30					

JULY

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15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28
29	30	31				

AUGUST

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22	23	24	25	26	27	28
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SEPTEMBER

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29	30					

OCTOBER

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29	30	31				

NOVEMBER · fallow

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22	23	24	25	26	27	28
29	30					

DECEMBER

1	2	3	4	5	6	7
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15	16	17	18	19	20	21
22	23	24	25	26	27	28
29	30	31				

- A feast of the Wheel
- The Days of the Dead

*Mark in your own hand: New Moon, Full Moon,
□ a Heart Day, a line beneath the retrograde,
and your Moving Days. Every month keeps the first,
the fourth, and the seventh, and every Wednesday.*





THE FIXED FEASTS

The Sun's year: the same dates every year

JANUARY 1 · The Door of the Year. *Janus*.

FEBRUARY 13 · The Days of the Dead. *Hermanubis; through the 22nd, ending at the Caristia*.

MARCH 20 · The Ascent. *Sandalphon; the spring equinox, about the 20th*.

MARCH 25 · The Announcement. *Gabriel and Idris*.

APRIL 1 · The Trickster's Day. *Mercury*.

MAY 15 · The Mercuralia. *Mercury; the Day of Accounting*.

JUNE 9 · The Vestalia. *Hestia*.

JUNE 21 · The Open Gate. *Uriel; the summer solstice, about the 21st*.

JULY · The Hermaia. *Hermes of the gymnasium; any day in July, the fifteenth when in doubt*.

AUGUST 29 · The Scribe's New Year. *Thermes*.

SEPTEMBER 22 · The Weighing. *Ma'at; the autumn equinox, about the 22nd*.

OCTOBER 11 · The Meditrinalia. *Aphrael*.

NOVEMBER · The Fallow Month. *November; nothing is asked*.

DECEMBER 21 · The Kept Gate. *Raziel; the winter solstice, about the 21st*.

DECEMBER 31 · The Closing of the Account. *The Ledger's year end*.

YOUR MOVING DAYS



THREE feasts no almanac can print, because they are yours. Write them in.

YOUR BIRTHDAY. _____ Metatron and Sandalphon. Note which turn of the Mercury cycle it falls in.

THE BOOK'S DAY. _____ The Genius Loci, on the anniversary of the Dedication.

THE GOOD HOUR. Declared, not dated. Rosmerta and the Charites.

THE MERCURY CYCLE, IN ORDER

A turn of about a hundred and sixteen days



MERCURY turns three times and a little more in a year, so the Heart Days come six or seven times a year and the retrograde three or four, about three weeks each. One turn runs in this order; any ephemeris gives the dates.

1. **THE HIGH HEART.** Superior cazimi: Mercury in the heart of the Sun, on the far side. The Heart Day of the ascent.

2. **THE EVENING STAR.** Some weeks after sunset: the outward season.
3. **GREATEST ELONGATION, EAST.** His furthest from the Sun as the evening star: the Scribe's own day, and the best evening viewing.
4. **THE SHADOW.** A week or two before he stations, he crosses the ground he will later walk back over. The looking-back season begins here.
5. **STATION RETROGRADE.** The turn: stop starting things.
6. **THE DEEP HEART.** Inferior cazimi, mid-retrograde: Mercury between us and the Sun. The Heart Day of the descent.
7. **STATION DIRECT.** The second turn, about three weeks after the first.
8. **THE MORNING STAR, AND GREATEST ELONGATION, WEST.** He rises before the Sun again, then stands at his furthest as the morning star: the natural day to set out.
9. **THE HIGH HEART, AGAIN.** The next turn begins.

THE MOON'S MONTH, IN ORDER

About twenty-nine and a half days



A year holds twelve New Moons and now and then a thirteenth, two in one calendar month. The month runs in this order.

1. **THE DEIPNON.** The last dark night, for those who keep it: sweep, and set out a small supper.
2. **THE NEW MOON.** Gabriel's first day: declare. When a New Moon crosses the Sun's path it is an eclipse of the Sun, the Sun's own Deep Heart; keep that day quiet, whether or not it can be seen where you are.
3. **THE NOUMENIA.** The first crescent, a day or two after, for those who keep it: Hestia and Janus.
4. **THE FOURTH DAY AFTER THE NOUMENIA.** Hermes's birthday by the Moon, for those who keep the lunar month.
5. **THE FIRST QUARTER.** The middle of the waxing fortnight, when the bridge is walked.
6. **THE FULL MOON.** Gabriel's second day: be seen, and read.
7. **THE LAST QUARTER.** The middle of the waning fortnight, when accounts are settled.
8. **THE DARK OF THE MOON.** The last two or three nights: descend, clear, or rest.





WHERE THE SKY AGREES

A lift, never a condition



WHEN the Moon and Mercury line up, the lift is real. These are the meetings worth looking for when you mark the year.

A NEW MOON NEAR A HIGH HEART. The strongest single casting: declare from the height.

A NEW MOON ON A STATION DIRECT. The cleanest beginning, for a thing you mean to start.

A NEW MOON IN THE MORNING STAR SEASON. A clean beginning, for setting out.

A FULL MOON IN THE EVENING STAR. The best night to be seen.

A FULL MOON NEAR A DEEP HEART. The dark lit for one night; deepest in the Days of the Dead.

A WANING MOON INSIDE A RETROGRADE. The deepest repair season.

A QUARTER MOON ON A STATION RETROGRADE. The turn comes with the Moon half-built: a caution against starting.

THE CRESCENT BESIDE MERCURY. A thin Moon near him at dawn or dusk: Gabriel and Mercury in one glance. Go out and look.

THE SHAPE OF A YEAR



EVERY year has a dark stretch and a thin one. The dark stretch is February, where the Days of the Dead fall; it is deepest when a Deep Heart lands inside them, and that is not arranged, because the Parentalia is fixed and the cazimi is astronomy. The thin stretch is November: the Fallow Month, laid over whatever the sky is doing. It is the year's rest, and it is deliberate.

Where the High Hearts gather, the year leans that way, and where the widest morning star falls is where the sky argues for setting out. Mark the year at a glance at its Door, and the shape shows itself.

IF YOU KEEP ONLY FIVE DAYS

The Door of the Year. The first Deep Heart. The widest Morning Star, for whatever you are beginning. The Mercuralia. The Closing of the Account. Everything else is detail.

*Everything you need to walk the Way is in these pages.
The rest of the library will keep.*

Copy it. Change it. Give it away.
Keep the spine, and it is this Temple.

